

# 删不掉的光 I

## 日子里的恩典

The Light They Could Not Erase, Vol. 1  
Grace in Ordinary Days

张崇助 Chongzhu (Paul) Zhang



# 删不掉的光 I：日子里的恩典

## The Light They Could Not Erase, Vol. 1: Grace in Ordinary Days

作者：张崇助

# 作者简介 · Author Bio

张崇助（Chongzhu “Paul” Zhang），牧师、作者、神学研究者。

早年毕业于上海华东神学院，获神学本科与圣乐本科。随后赴美深造，就读于美国 Ozark Christian College 旗下林肯神学院（Lincoln Seminary），获道学硕士（Master of Divinity）学位，主修圣经研究与教牧领导（Biblical Studies and Pastoral Leadership）。

现就读于美国亚斯埋神学院（Asbury Theological Seminary）教牧学博士（Doctor of Ministry, D.Min.）项目，研究方向为 Preaching and Leading（讲道与领导）。

自 2001 年开始全职牧会，长期从事讲道、教导、门徒训练与教会牧养工作。曾在中国多地服事，现任美国印第安纳州印城第一华人循理会（First Chinese Free Methodist Church of Indianapolis）主任牧师。

除了牧会与教学之外，张崇助热爱写作，长期通过网络平台分享关于信仰、人生、家庭、苦难、盼望与跨文化经历的思考。《删不掉的光》（The Light They Could Not Erase）系列，收录其近年来发表于微信公众号的大量原创随笔与灵修文章，记录一个普通牧者在人生旅程中所经历的恩典、反思与成长。

他深信：真正改变生命的，往往不是轰轰烈烈的时刻，而是那些隐藏在平凡日子里的恩典之光。

Chongzhu “Paul” Zhang is a pastor, author, and theological researcher.

He graduated from East China Theological Seminary in Shanghai, earning undergraduate degrees in Theology and Sacred Music. He later pursued advanced theological studies in the United States at Lincoln Seminary of Ozark Christian College, where he received a Master of Divinity (M.Div.) with a concentration in Biblical Studies and Pastoral Leadership.

He is currently pursuing a Doctor of Ministry (D.Min.) degree at Asbury Theological Seminary, with a focus on Preaching and Leading.

Since entering full-time ministry in 2001, Pastor Zhang has devoted himself to preaching, teaching, discipleship, and pastoral leadership. After years of ministry in China, he now serves as Senior Pastor of the First Chinese Free Methodist Church of Indianapolis, Indiana.

In addition to ministry, he is a passionate writer who regularly reflects on faith, life, family, suffering, hope, and cross-cultural experiences. The Light They Could Not Erase series is a collection of essays and devotional reflections originally published through his online writing ministry, preserving stories of grace, perseverance, and spiritual growth.

He believes that:

The moments that shape our lives most deeply are often not the extraordinary ones, but the quiet lights of grace found in ordinary days.

# 献词 Dedication

谨以此书献给我的妻子：

张素川（Sue Zhang）

感谢你多年来的陪伴与支持。

在顺境中，你与我一同感恩；在艰难中，你与我一同承担。

当道路平坦的时候，你从不居功；当风雨来临的时候，你从未离开。

从中国到美国，从牧会到求学，从熟悉到陌生，从欢笑到眼泪，我们一起走过许多难忘的岁月。

感谢你为家庭的付出，感谢你为教会的摆上，感谢你在许多无人看见的地方默默服事。

许多时候，人们看见的是讲台上的牧者，却没有看见背后那位默默支持、代祷、鼓励和陪伴的人。

而你，正是那样的人。

这些年来，无论是在教会的事奉中，还是在人生的旅程里，你始终是上帝赐给我的恩典之一。

特别是在那些最艰难的日子里，当我们共同经历失去与等待，经历眼泪与沉默，你用信心扶持我，也用爱陪伴我继续前行。

这本书所记录的许多故事，都有你的身影；这本书所见证的许多恩典，也都有你的参与。

愿上帝纪念你的劳苦，赐福你的生命，并让我们继续携手同行，在未来的岁月里，一同见证那永不熄灭的光。

献给我深爱的妻子，Sue。

张崇助

To my beloved wife, Sue Zhang

Thank you for your faithful love, unwavering support, and steadfast companionship throughout our journey together.

Through seasons of joy and sorrow, through ministry and study, through familiar places and unfamiliar lands, you have walked beside me with grace and courage.

Many people see the pastor standing in front, but few see the faithful partner standing behind.

Your prayers, encouragement, sacrifices, and quiet acts of service have sustained both our family and our ministry in countless ways.

This book carries many stories from our journey, and your presence is woven through them all.

In moments of celebration, you rejoiced with me.

In moments of hardship, you remained beside me.

In seasons of loss, you shared my tears.

In seasons of hope, you strengthened my faith.

Thank you for being one of God's greatest gifts in my life.

May the Lord continue to bless you, strengthen you, and fill your days with His peace and joy.

With love and gratitude,

Chongzhu (Paul) Zhang

# 书名说明 Title Description

## 我为什么把这套书命名为《删不掉的光》

很多朋友问我：为什么这套书要取名为《删不掉的光》？

这个名字，其实来自我过去一年多经营微信公众号的真实经历。

2024 年开始，我陆续把自己的一些文章发表在微信公众号上。刚开始的时候，我写得很直接。内容大多是圣经分享、神学思考、教会牧养、信仰见证，以及一些属灵反思。

然而，让我意想不到的是，许多文章发表之后不久便被下架。有时候三篇文章里面会有两篇被删除；有时候一连几天发表的内容，最后只剩下一两篇能够保留下来。

起初，我感到困惑。后来渐渐明白，其中许多内容触及了一些平台所关注的敏感词汇或表达方式。

那些被删除的文章，有些是关于信仰的思考，有些是关于人生价值的讨论，也有一些是关于教会牧养和属灵成长的分享。

每当收到“文章已被删除”的通知时，心里总会有一些失落。因为每一篇文章背后，都有时间的投入，也有生命的经历。

然而，随着时间推移，我开始意识到，这未必完全是一件坏事。它反而成为一种学习，一种训练，一种重新思考如何表达的机会。

我开始学习用更加含蓄的语言表达更深刻的内容，学习用生活故事讲述信仰，用人生经历承载神学思考，用普通日子的记录传递生命的信息。

渐渐地，我发现，许多原本需要用直接方式表达的内容，其实也可以通过更加温柔、更有文学性的方式呈现出来。而且有时候，这样的表达反而更容易进入人的内心。

于是，我的写作开始发生改变。

文章不再只是单纯的神学论述，而更多成为生活观察、生命反思、家庭故事、异乡经历和日常感悟。

在这些平凡的故事背后，我仍然努力保留那些最重要的价值与信念。

慢慢地，被删除的次数减少了。如今，我平均每周会发表四五篇文章。偶尔仍然会有文章被下架，但相比最初的阶段，已经少了许多。

然而，在这个过程中，我越来越深刻地意识到一件事：

文字可能被删除。

文章可能被下架。

平台可能会改变。

甚至有一天，整个账号都可能不再存在。

但是，那些曾经照亮过生命的东西，并不会因此消失。

一篇文章或许不见了，但它曾带给某个人的安慰还在。

一句话或许被删除了，但它曾带来的思考还在。

一个故事或许无法继续传播，但它所点燃的希望还在。

真正有力量的，从来不是文字本身，而是文字背后的光。

正因为如此，当我开始整理这些公众号文章，准备出版成书的时候，《删不掉的光》这个名字便自然浮现在我的心里。

因为我相信：有些文章会消失，有些文字会被遗忘，有些记录会被尘封，但那些真正照亮生命的恩典、盼望、真理与爱，永远删不掉。

这套书所要保存的，不仅仅是文字。

更是那些曾经照亮我，也曾经照亮他人的光。

而这，正是《删不掉的光》这个书名背后的故事。

## Why I Named This Series The Light They Could Not Erase

Many readers have asked me why I chose the title The Light They Could Not Erase.

The answer comes from a very personal experience.

Beginning in 2024, I started publishing articles regularly through my WeChat public account. At first, my writing was quite direct. Most of the articles focused on Scripture, theology, pastoral ministry, faith, testimony, and spiritual reflection.

To my surprise, many of those articles disappeared shortly after publication.

Sometimes two out of three articles would be removed. Sometimes, after several days of writing and posting, only one or two articles remained visible.

At first, I felt confused. Over time, I gradually came to understand that some of the content had touched words or expressions that the platform regarded as sensitive.

Those removed articles included reflections on faith, discussions of life values, and writings on pastoral ministry and spiritual growth.

Every time I received a notice that an article had been removed, I felt a quiet sense of loss. Each article represented time, thought, prayer, and lived experience.

Yet as time passed, I began to see that this was not entirely a bad thing. It became a kind of learning, a kind of training, and an opportunity to rethink how I expressed what mattered most.

I began to learn how to express deeper truths with quieter language, how to speak of faith through everyday stories, how to carry theological reflection through lived experience, and how to communicate life through ordinary days.

Gradually, I discovered that some truths did not always need to be stated directly. They could also be carried through gentler, more literary forms of expression. Sometimes, such writing entered the heart more deeply.

My writing began to change.

It was no longer only theological reflection. It became more and more a record of ordinary life, family stories, personal reflection, cross-cultural experience, and the lessons hidden in daily living.

Yet beneath those ordinary stories, I still tried to preserve the convictions and values that mattered most.

Over time, fewer articles were removed. Today, I continue to write several articles each week. Occasionally, one is still taken down, but far less often than in the beginning.

Through this process, however, I came to realize something important:

Words can disappear.

Articles can be removed.

Platforms can change.

Even an entire account may one day no longer exist.

But the things that once brought light to a life do not disappear so easily.

An article may vanish, but the comfort it brought to a reader remains.

A sentence may be deleted, but the thought it awakened may continue.

A story may no longer be visible online, but the hope it kindled may remain.

The most powerful thing is not the words themselves.

It is the light behind the words.

That is why, when I began gathering these public-account articles into book form, the title *The Light They Could Not Erase* naturally came to mind.



I believe some articles may disappear, some words may be forgotten, and some records may be buried by time. But the grace, hope, truth, and love that truly illuminate a life cannot be erased.

This series is not merely preserving words.

It is preserving the light that once shone upon me and, I hope, upon others as well.

That is the story behind the title *The Light They Could Not Erase*.

# 作者自序 Author's Preface

删不掉的光

如果有人问我，这本书是从什么时候开始写的？

我大概会说，它并不是从某一天开始写的。

它是从一个又一个平凡的日子里，慢慢长出来的。

2024 年，我开始认真经营自己的微信公众号。起初并没有宏大的计划，也没有想到要出版一本书。我只是想把一路走来的思考、感动、挣扎、学习和领受记录下来。

有时候，是一段生活感悟。

有时候，是一篇灵修默想。

有时候，是一次探访后的反思。

有时候，是一场风雨过后的记录。

更多的时候，只是在忙碌生活的缝隙里，为自己留下一点安静思考的空间。

于是，一篇、两篇、十篇、五十篇、一百篇……

不知不觉之间，公众号已经陪伴我走过一年多的时间。

当我重新翻看这些文章的时候，忽然发现，它们虽然写于不同的季节、不同的处境，却都在讲述同一个主题：

在人生最真实的日子，总有一些光，是删不掉的。

时代会过去。

平台会改变。

文章可能被遗忘。

账号甚至可能消失。

但那些曾经照亮过生命的恩典，那些在人生幽暗时刻给予力量的亮光，却不会轻易消失。

它们留在记忆里。

留在生命里。

也留在一个人继续前行的脚步里。

于是，我决定把这些散落在网络世界里的文字，重新整理、编辑、修订，汇集成册。

这套书，便有了一个名字：

《删不掉的光》。

因为我深深相信，真正重要的东西，不会因为时间而消失，也不会因为环境而被抹去。

## 为什么从“日子里的恩典”开始

很多人以为，一个人的生命最重要的是那些轰轰烈烈的大事。

然而，随着年龄增长，我越来越发现，人生真正发生的地方，其实是在日常。

不是高峰，而是平地。

不是掌声，而是安静。

不是传奇，而是日子。

我们记得毕业典礼，却常常忘记那些熬夜读书的夜晚。

我们记得成功的时刻，却忽略了无数默默坚持的过程。

我们记得生命中的转折点，却忘记了那些平凡日子对我们的塑造。

事实上，一个人的品格是在日常中形成的。

信心是在等待中成长的。

爱是在陪伴中学习的。

盼望是在黑夜中坚持的。

恩典也是如此。

它往往不是惊天动地的奇迹，而是一顿热饭、一句安慰、一位朋友、一条短信、一段陪伴、一扇重新打开的门。

因此，《删不掉的光》的第一册，我选择从“日子里的恩典”开始。

因为所有伟大的故事，都始于普通的日子。

而所有真实的生命，也都活在普通的日子。

## 为什么采用中英文双语

这本书采用中英文双语形式，并不是单纯为了翻译。

而是因为我的生命本身，已经同时生活在两种语言之中。

我出生在中国。

在那里成长、学习、牧会，经历人生的喜乐与苦难。

后来，我来到美国。

在陌生的语言和文化中重新开始学习，重新适应，也重新认识自己。

这些年，我越来越深刻地体会到：

语言不仅是一种工具，更是一座桥梁。

中文承载着我的过去。

英文连接着我的现在。

中文记录了我生命的根。

英文见证着我生命的路。

因此，我希望这些文字能够跨越语言的边界。

让华人的下一代能够读懂父母和祖父母的故事。

让不同文化背景的人能够彼此理解。

让生命中的信心、盼望与爱，可以被更多的人阅读与分享。

如果有一天，一位年轻人读英文版的时候，能够理解上一代华人走过的道路；如果有一天，一位英文读者透过这些文字，能够看见华人基督徒真实的人生故事，那么这本书的使命便已经实现了一部分。

## 写给正在阅读这本书的你

也许你正处在人生顺境。

也许你正在经历低谷。

也许你身在故乡。

也许你漂泊异乡。

也许你正在寻找答案。

也许你已经疲惫不堪。

无论你是谁，我都希望这本书能够成为一位安静同行的朋友。

它不会告诉你人生一定会一帆风顺。

它也不会假装所有问题都有简单答案。

但它愿意陪伴你一起相信：

在最普通的日子，恩典依然存在。

在最黑暗的夜晚，光依然存在。

在最艰难的道路上，希望依然存在。

因为我自己的生命，就是这样一路走过来的。

我曾经历失去。

也曾经历等待。

曾面对风雨。

也曾看见彩虹。

我知道人生并不容易。

但我也知道，在许多以为走不下去的时候，总有一只看不见的手托住我们继续前行。

回首这些年，我越来越相信：

真正改变一个人的，不是惊天动地的时刻，而是那些持续不断临到生命中的恩典。

而这些恩典，就像夜空里的星光。

也许微弱，却从未熄灭。

也许遥远，却始终存在。

这正是《删不掉的光》想要讲述的故事。

愿这本书陪伴你走过一段路。

愿你在这些文字里，看见自己的影子。

也愿你在自己的生命里，发现那些从未被删除、从未被熄灭、始终照亮前路的光。

张崇助

于美国印第安纳州印第安纳波利斯

2026 年



# The Light They Could Not Erase

If someone were to ask me when this book began, I would probably say that it did not begin on a single day.

It grew slowly out of one ordinary day after another.

In 2024, I began writing more intentionally on my WeChat public account. At first, I had no grand plan and no thought of publishing a book. I simply wanted to record the reflections, movements of the heart, struggles, lessons, and spiritual insights that came along the way.

Sometimes it was a reflection on daily life.

Sometimes it was a devotional meditation.

Sometimes it was a response after visiting someone.

Sometimes it was a record after a storm had passed.

More often, it was simply a way to create a small space of quiet thought in the middle of a busy life.

One article became two. Then ten. Then fifty. Then a hundred.

Almost without realizing it, this public account had accompanied me for more than a year.

When I later looked back through these writings, I suddenly realized that although they were written in different seasons and under different circumstances, they were all telling the same story:

In the most real days of life, there is always some light that cannot be erased.

Times will pass.

Platforms will change.

Articles may be forgotten.

Accounts may even disappear.

But the grace that once illumined a life, and the light that gave strength in dark moments, do not easily vanish.

They remain in memory.

They remain in life.

They remain in the steps by which a person continues forward.

So I decided to gather these scattered writings from the digital world, edit and revise them, and bring them together in book form.

This series was given the title:

The Light They Could Not Erase.

Because I deeply believe that what truly matters will not disappear with time, nor will it be erased by changing circumstances.

Why Begin With “Grace in Ordinary Days”

Many people assume that the most important parts of life are the dramatic moments.

But as I grow older, I increasingly realize that real life happens in the ordinary.

Not on the mountaintop, but on level ground.

Not in applause, but in quietness.

Not in legend, but in daily life.

We remember graduation ceremonies, but often forget the late nights of study.

We remember moments of success, but overlook the countless quiet acts of perseverance that led there.

We remember turning points, but forget how ordinary days shaped us.

In truth, character is formed in daily life.

Faith grows in waiting.

Love is learned through companionship.

Hope is strengthened in the night.

Grace is much the same.

It often does not come as a dramatic miracle, but as a warm meal, a comforting word, a friend, a message, a season of companionship, or a door that opens again.

That is why I chose to begin the first volume of The Light They Could Not Erase with “Grace in Ordinary Days.”

Every great story begins in ordinary days.

And every real life is lived there.

Why This Book Is Bilingual

This book is bilingual not merely for the sake of translation.

It is bilingual because my life now lives in two languages.

I was born in China.

There I grew up, studied, served in ministry, and experienced both joy and sorrow.

Later, I came to the United States.

In an unfamiliar language and culture, I had to learn again, adapt again, and understand myself again.

Over the years, I have come to feel more deeply that language is not only a tool. It is also a bridge.

Chinese carries my past.

English connects my present.

Chinese records the roots of my life.

English bears witness to the road I am now walking.

For this reason, I hope these writings can cross the boundaries of language.

I hope the next generation of Chinese families can understand the stories of their parents and grandparents.

I hope people from different cultural backgrounds can understand one another more deeply.

I hope the faith, hope, and love found in these ordinary stories can be read and shared by more people.

If one day a young person reading the English version can better understand the road walked by an earlier generation of Chinese believers, or if an English-speaking reader can glimpse the real life of a Chinese Christian through these pages, then part of this book's mission will already have been fulfilled.

To the Reader

Perhaps you are in a season of blessing.

Perhaps you are walking through a valley.

Perhaps you are living in your homeland.

Perhaps you are far from home.

Perhaps you are searching for answers.

Perhaps you are already weary.

Whoever you are, I hope this book can become a quiet companion on your journey.

It will not tell you that life will always be smooth.

It will not pretend that every problem has a simple answer.

But it is willing to walk with you and believe:

In the most ordinary days, grace still exists.

In the darkest nights, light still exists.

On the hardest roads, hope still exists.

My own life has been carried in this way.

I have known loss.

I have known waiting.

I have faced storms.

I have also seen rainbows.

I know life is not easy.

But I also know that in many moments when I thought I could not go on, an unseen hand was still holding me and helping me move forward.

Looking back, I believe more and more that what truly changes a person is not one dramatic moment, but grace that keeps coming to us again and again.

Such grace is like starlight in the night sky.

It may be faint, yet it has never gone out.

It may seem far away, yet it is still there.

This is the story *The Light They Could Not Erase* seeks to tell.

May this book accompany you for part of your journey.

May you see something of yourself in these pages.

And may you discover, in your own life, the light that has never been deleted, never been extinguished, and never stopped shining on the road ahead.

Chongzhu (Paul) Zhang

Indianapolis, Indiana, USA

2026

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# 第一辑： 日子里的恩典 Grace in Ordinary Days

## 1. 慧眼识珠 Seeing Beyond the Shine

真正的眼光，不是看得贵，而是看得深

有时候，一个人的眼光，不是从他说了什么大道理看出来，而是从他第一眼看见了什么，看出来。

听过这样一个故事。

一个年轻女孩把新买的 iPhone 放在钢琴上。有人看见了，立刻说：“你是不是在炫耀？”

女孩回答：“我每天弹着八十万的钢琴，你却只看见六千块钱的手机。”

这句话听起来像玩笑，却很有分量。

同一幅画面，有人看见手机，有人看见钢琴；有人看见价钱，有人看见价值；有人看见表面的闪光，有人看见背后的积累。

人所看见的，常常暴露人里面所在的位置。

眼光浅的时候，人容易被最亮、最近、最容易比较的东西吸引。

眼光深的时候，人会往后看：这件事背后是什么？这个人背后经历了什么？这个拥有背后是谁的付出？

所以，慧眼识珠，不只是看见贵重的东西，而是看见真正有分量的东西。

一、你看到的，暴露你的层次

那个同学看见手机，觉得那是炫耀；女孩却提醒他，真正更贵重的，是他没有看见的钢琴。

但故事若继续往下想，还可以更深。

如果妈妈在旁边，她也许会说：“你只看见八十万的钢琴，却没看见千万的房子。”

如果爸爸在旁边，他也许会说：“你只看见房子，却没看见我愿意陪你学琴的时间。”



如果神在旁边，祂也许会提醒人：“你只看见这些拥有，却忘了是谁赐下生命、气息和一切。”

人若只看见物，就容易陷在比较里。

人若看见人，就开始懂得感恩。

人若看见神，就开始有敬畏。

圣经说：“人在尊贵中而不醒悟，就如死亡的畜类一样。”（诗篇 49:20，和合本）

人可以拥有很多，却没有真正醒悟；也可以看见许多，却没有真正明白。

真正的眼光，不是停在物质的表面，而是穿过表面，看见价值、关系、恩典与源头。

二、只看见“物”，是许多冲突的源头

许多关系里的误会，其实都从“看错重点”开始。

别人买了一样东西，我们看见的是炫耀。

别人取得一点成就，我们看见的是虚荣。

别人拥有一些资源，我们看见的是不公平。

于是，心里开始不平，话语开始带刺，关系开始变味。

但很多时候，我们并不知道那件东西背后的故事。

也许那是多年努力后的一个奖励。

也许那是家人爱的表达。

也许那是别人辛苦忍耐后终于拥有的一点安慰。

当一个人只看见“物”，却看不见“人”，他就容易冷漠。

当一个人只看见“价格”，却看不见“代价”，他就容易轻慢。

当一个人只看见“拥有”，却看不见“恩典”，他就容易嫉妒。

眼光若不被更新，心就很难保持清明。

三、慧眼识珠，是看见背后的恩典

真正有眼光的人，不是只会判断东西贵不贵，而是能看见一个人生命中真正宝贵的部分。

他看见一个孩子学琴，不只看见钢琴多少钱，也看见父母的陪伴、孩子的坚持和一段段练习中的眼泪。

他看见一个家庭住进新房，不只看见房子大小，也看见多年节省、劳苦、等待和神一路的供应。

他看见一个人有一点成就，不只看见掌声，也看见失败、孤独、熬夜和不被人理解的日子。

这样的人，不轻易论断。

因为他知道，每一个结果背后，都有别人看不见的过程。

他也不轻易嫉妒。

因为他知道，别人身上的祝福，不会减少神给自己的恩典。

慧眼识珠，就是在普通的生活里，看见不普通的恩典。

#### 四、世界容易让人失焦

今天的世界太擅长制造比较。

谁的手机更新，谁的房子更大，谁的孩子更优秀，谁的事业更成功，谁的生活更体面。

我们的眼睛不断被训练去看“外面”：外表、价格、数据、规模、流量、评价。

看久了，人就容易失焦。

我们忘记了，真正重要的东西，往往不是最醒目的东西。

一个安稳的家，比一件昂贵的物品更宝贵。

一个愿意陪你的人，比一套华丽的房子更难得。

一颗敬畏神的心，比所有外在拥有都更有重量。

世界教人看闪光的东西。

信仰教人看永恒的东西。

世界问：“你拥有什么？”

信仰问：“你成为什么样的人？”

世界问：“别人怎么看你？”

信仰问：“神怎么看你？”

当人的眼光被神调整，人生的次序也会慢慢被调整。

#### 五、你若看对了，人生就对了一半

人这一生，很多痛苦并不是因为缺少，而是因为看错。

看错了，就会把小事看得太大，把大事看得太小。

看错了，就会为一部手机争执，却忘记一段关系。

看错了，就会追逐掌声，却忽略真实的成长。

看错了，就会拥有许多，却依然不满足。

但一个人若看对了，心就会慢慢安稳。

他会看见，财物只是托付，不是身份。

他会看见，成就只是过程，不是救主。

他会看见，人间一切可见的祝福，背后都有那位不可见的赐福者。

这样的人，才是真正有福的人。

他不是没有追求，而是不再被比较牵着走。

他不是没有拥有，而是不再被拥有定义。

他不是看不见世界，而是看见世界之后，还能看见神。

结语：愿我们有一双被恩典照亮的眼睛

慧眼识珠，不是练就一双识别奢侈品的眼睛，而是拥有一颗能分辨真正价值的心。

愿我们看见手机时，也能看见钢琴。

看见钢琴时，也能看见父母。

看见父母时，也能看见恩典。

看见一切恩典时，也能看见那位赐恩典的神。

一个人若只看见物，他会活在比较里。

一个人若看见人，他会活在感恩里。

一个人若看见神，他会活在敬畏里。

愿我们都有这样的眼光：不被表面的闪光迷惑，不被短暂的价格捆绑，而是在每一个普通的日子，看见真正值得珍惜的珍珠。

# Seeing Beyond the Shine

## True Discernment Is About Depth, Not Price

Sometimes a person's vision is not revealed by the great truths he speaks, but by what he notices first.

I once heard a story about a young woman who placed her new iPhone on a piano. A classmate saw it and said, "Are you trying to show off?"

The young woman replied, "I play an \$80,000 piano every day, and all you noticed was a \$600 phone."

It sounds like a clever reply, but it carries a deeper lesson.

In the same scene, one person saw a phone; another saw a piano. One saw price; another saw value. One noticed what was bright and near; another noticed what carried greater weight.

What we notice often reveals where we stand inwardly.

When our vision is shallow, we are easily captured by what is obvious, shiny, and easy to compare.

When our vision is deeper, we ask better questions: What stands behind this? What has this person walked through? Whose sacrifice made this possible?

True discernment is not merely the ability to recognize expensive things. It is the ability to recognize what truly matters.

### 1. What You See Reveals Your Level of Vision

The classmate saw the phone and called it showing off. The young woman pointed to the piano, something far more valuable that he had failed to notice.

But the story can go even deeper.

If her mother were standing there, she might say, "You see the piano, but you do not see the house that shelters it."

If her father were standing there, he might say, "You see the house, but you do not see the years of labor, provision, and companionship behind it."

If God were speaking, He might say, "You see these possessions, but have you remembered the One who gives life, breath, and everything else?"

When people see only objects, they easily fall into comparison.

When they see people, they begin to learn gratitude.

When they see God, they begin to learn reverence.

Scripture says, "People who have wealth but lack understanding are like the beasts that perish." (Psalm 49:20, NIV)

A person may possess much and still remain unaware. A person may see many things and still fail to understand.

True vision does not stop at the surface of material things. It sees through the surface to value, relationship, grace, and source.

## 2. Seeing Only Things Creates Many Conflicts

Many misunderstandings in relationships begin with misplaced attention.

Someone buys something, and we call it showing off.

Someone achieves something, and we assume it is vanity.

Someone receives a blessing, and we feel life is unfair.

Then resentment grows, our words become sharp, and relationships begin to change.

But often we do not know the story behind what we see.

Perhaps it is a small reward after years of hard work.

Perhaps it is an expression of love from family.

Perhaps it is a quiet comfort after long endurance.

When a person sees only the object and not the person, his heart becomes cold.

When a person sees only the price and not the cost, he becomes dismissive.

When a person sees only possession and not grace, he becomes envious.

If our vision is not renewed, our hearts will not remain clear.

## 3. Discernment Sees Grace Behind the Surface

A person with true vision does not merely evaluate whether something is expensive. He recognizes what is precious in a life.

When he sees a child learning piano, he does not only see the instrument. He sees parents who accompany, a child who perseveres, and hours of practice hidden from public view.

When he sees a family move into a new home, he does not only see the house. He sees years of saving, labor, waiting, and God's provision.

When he sees another person's achievement, he does not only see applause. He sees failure, loneliness, sleepless nights, and misunderstood seasons.

Such a person is slow to judge.

He knows that behind every visible result, there is an invisible process.

He is also slow to envy.

He knows that another person's blessing does not reduce God's grace toward him.

To see beyond the shine is to notice extraordinary grace in ordinary life.

#### 4. The World Trains Us to Lose Focus

The world is skilled at producing comparison.

Who has the newest phone?

Whose house is larger?

Whose children are more impressive?

Whose career is more successful?

Whose life looks more respectable?

Our eyes are constantly trained to look outward: appearance, price, numbers, scale, influence, and public opinion.

After a while, we lose focus.

We forget that the most important things are often not the most visible things.

A peaceful home is more precious than an expensive object.

Someone willing to walk with you is more valuable than a beautiful house.

A heart that fears God carries more weight than all external possessions.

The world teaches us to look at what shines.

Faith teaches us to look at what lasts.

The world asks, "What do you have?"

Faith asks, "Who are you becoming?"

The world asks, "How do others see you?"

Faith asks, "How does God see you?"

When God renews our vision, the order of our lives begins to change.

#### 5. If You See Rightly, Half of Life Is Already Reordered

Much of human pain does not come from lack, but from misplaced vision.

When we see wrongly, we make small things too large and large things too small.

We argue over a phone and forget the relationship.

We chase applause and neglect real growth.

We possess much and still remain restless.

But when a person sees rightly, the heart slowly becomes steady.

He recognizes that possessions are stewardship, not identity.

He recognizes that achievement is a process, not a savior.

He recognizes that behind every visible blessing stands the invisible Giver.

Such a person is truly blessed.

He still pursues, but he is no longer driven by comparison.

He may possess, but he is no longer defined by possession.

He does not ignore the world, but after seeing the world, he still sees God.

Conclusion: Eyes Lit by Grace

Seeing beyond the shine does not mean having an eye for luxury. It means having a heart that can discern true value.

May we see the phone and also see the piano.

May we see the piano and also see the parents.

May we see the parents and also see grace.

And when we see grace, may we see the God who gives it.

If a person sees only things, he lives in comparison.

If he sees people, he lives in gratitude.

If he sees God, he lives in reverence.

May we have this kind of vision: not deceived by surface brightness, not bound by temporary price, but able to recognize true pearls in ordinary days.



## 2. 冲出重围 Breaking Through the Encirclement

出路不一定在正前方

人生总有一些时刻，让人觉得自己被困住了。

前面没有路，后面没有退路，左右都是压力。

你明明还在呼吸，却觉得空间越来越窄；你明明还在往前走，却觉得每一步都像撞在墙上。

中国人有一个词，叫“四面楚歌”。

这个词背后，是楚霸王项羽在垓下被围的故事。夜里四面响起楚歌，他忽然意识到：人心已散，大势已去。

那是一种极深的孤立感。

周围都是声音，却没有一个声音真正站在你这边。

四面都有路，却每一条都像死路。

很多人在人生中也会走到这样的时刻。

家庭里，关系紧张。

工作上，压力沉重。

服事中，进退两难。

经济上，捉襟见肘。

身体上，疲惫不堪。

内心里，更是一片混乱。

这时，人最容易下一个结论：我完了。

但信仰常常在这里给人另一种眼光。

一、四面受敌，却不被困住

使徒保罗也曾经历“四面受敌”的处境。

他不是活在温室里的人。他被误解，被逼迫，被攻击，也常常处在危险之中。

但他说：“我们四面受敌，却不被困住；心里作难，却不至失望；遭逼迫，却不被丢弃；打倒了，却不至死亡。”（哥林多后书 4:8-9，和合本）



这段话很奇妙。

保罗没有否认压力。

他说，确实四面受敌。

他也没有假装轻松。

他说，心里确实作难。

但他拒绝让处境给生命下最后的定义。

四面受敌，不等于被困住。

心里作难，不等于绝望。

被打倒，不等于生命结束。

这就是信心与绝望之间最关键的区别。

绝望看见的是围困。

信心看见的是出路。

绝望说：“我没有路了。”

信心说：“我还没有看见路，但神没有被困住。”

二、真正困住人的，常常不是环境，而是解释

同样的环境，不同的人会有完全不同的反应。

有人遇到困难，就说：“这是终点。”

有人遇到困难，却说：“这可能是转弯。”

有人看见压力，就觉得自己被压垮。

有人看见压力，却知道自己正在被塑造。

很多时候，真正困住我们的，不只是环境本身，而是我们对环境的解释。

如果你把所有困难都解释为“神离开了我”，你的心就会越来越沉。

但如果你开始相信，即使在困境中神仍然掌权，你就不会轻易被绝望吞没。

信心不是否认现实。

信心是承认现实以后，仍然相信现实不是最终答案。

三、出路常常从看不见的地方打开

圣经里有许多“无路可走”的画面。

以色列人来到红海边，前面是海，后面是追兵。按人的判断，已经没有路。

但神使海分开。

以色列人走到约旦河边，河水涨过两岸。按人的判断，应该等待水退。

但当祭司的脚踏入水中，水就停住。

旷野没有食物，神赐下吗哪。

沙漠没有水，神使磐石出水。

这些故事不是告诉我们，人不用面对困难；而是告诉我们，神开路的方式常常超出人的想象。

有时候，路不是早就摆在那里，等你去发现。

有时候，路是在你顺服前行的时候，被神一步一步打开。

#### 四、不要让围困定义你

当人被围住的时候，最危险的不是外面的压力，而是里面开始接受一个错误身份。

“我就是失败的人。”

“我就是没有出路的人。”

“我就是被神忘记的人。”

这些话一旦在心里扎根，人就会先在里面投降。

但信仰提醒我们：你不是由眼前的困境定义的。

你是由神的恩典定义的。

你是祂所造的人，是祂所爱的人，也是祂仍然可以带领的人。

今天的困境，不是你生命的全部。

眼前的围困，也不是神故事的结局。

#### 五、抬头，是冲出重围的开始

诗人说：“我要向山举目；我的帮助从何而来？我的帮助从造天地的耶和华而来。”（诗篇 121:1-2，和合本）

这句话不是浪漫的诗意，而是困境中的选择。

当人四面受敌时，最自然的反应是低头：看问题，看损失，看压力，看人的评价。

但信心的动作，是抬头。

抬头，不是逃避现实，而是重新确认帮助的来源。

抬头，不是问题立刻消失，而是心不再被问题完全吞没。

抬头，是告诉自己：我的帮助不是从环境来，也不是从人的掌声来，而是从造天地的耶和华而来。

很多时候，冲出重围的第一步，不是环境改变，而是眼光改变。

你开始从神那里重新看自己，重新看处境，重新看未来。

结语：神没有被你的困境困住

如果你正处在四面受敌的时刻，请不要急着给自己下结论。

你看见的是围困，神看见的可能是训练。

你看见的是尽头，神看见的可能是转弯。

你看见的是无路，神却能在旷野开道路，在沙漠开江河。

四面楚歌，不一定是结局。

四面受敌，也不等于被困住。

只要神还在，故事就还没有结束。

所以，不要让恐惧替你解释人生。

不要让压力替你决定方向。

不要让暂时的围困夺走你里面的盼望。

抬起头来。

继续往前。

也许你还没有看见路。

但那位开路的神，已经在路上。

# Breaking Through the Encirclement

## The Way Out May Not Come From the Direction You Expected

There are moments in life when we feel trapped.

There seems to be no road ahead, no way back, and pressure on every side.

You are still breathing, but the space around you feels smaller. You are still moving forward, but every step seems to hit a wall.

In Chinese, there is an expression: surrounded by songs from all sides.

It comes from the story of Xiang Yu, the king of Chu, who found himself surrounded at Gaixia. At night, he heard the songs of Chu coming from every direction and realized that the hearts of his people had scattered and that the tide had turned against him.

It is an image of deep isolation.

There are voices all around, but none seem to stand with you.

There are roads in every direction, but each one feels like a dead end.

Many people eventually come to such a place in life.

At home, relationships become tense.

At work, pressure becomes heavy.

In ministry, every direction feels difficult.

Financially, resources are stretched.

Physically, exhaustion sets in.

Inwardly, the heart becomes confused.

At such moments, people are tempted to conclude: It is over.

But faith often gives us another way to see.

### 1. Hard Pressed, but Not Crushed

The apostle Paul also knew what it meant to be pressed on every side.

He did not live in comfort. He was misunderstood, persecuted, attacked, and often in danger.

Yet he wrote, “We are hard pressed on every side, but not crushed.” (2 Corinthians 4:8, NIV)

That sentence is powerful.

Paul did not deny the pressure.

He admitted that he was hard pressed on every side.

He did not pretend that life was easy.

He also acknowledged distress and trouble.

But he refused to let circumstances give the final definition to his life.

Being pressed on every side does not mean being crushed.

Being perplexed does not mean being in despair.

Being struck down does not mean being destroyed.

This is the key difference between faith and despair.

Despair sees only the encirclement.

Faith looks for the way of God.

Despair says, "There is no road."

Faith says, "I do not yet see the road, but God is not trapped."

## 2. What Traps Us Is Often Not the Situation, but the Interpretation

The same situation can produce very different responses in different people.

One person faces difficulty and says, "This is the end."

Another person faces difficulty and says, "This may be a turning point."

One person sees pressure and feels crushed by it.

Another person sees pressure and recognizes that he is being shaped.

Often what traps us is not only the situation itself, but the way we interpret it.

If we interpret every difficulty as evidence that God has left us, our hearts will sink deeper and deeper.

But if we believe that God remains sovereign even in difficulty, despair will not easily swallow us.

Faith does not deny reality.

Faith acknowledges reality and still believes that reality is not the final answer.

## 3. The Way Out Often Opens From an Unseen Direction

Scripture contains many scenes where no way seemed possible.

Israel stood before the Red Sea. The sea was in front of them, and the Egyptian army was behind them. Humanly speaking, there was no way.

But God parted the sea.

Israel came to the Jordan River when it was at flood stage. Humanly speaking, they should have waited for the water to recede.

But when the priests stepped into the river, the waters stopped.

In the wilderness there was no food, and God gave manna.

In the desert there was no water, and God brought water from the rock.

These stories do not tell us that we will never face difficulty. They tell us that God's way of making a way often exceeds human imagination.

Sometimes the road is not already visible, waiting for us to discover it.

Sometimes the road opens step by step as we obey and move forward.

#### 4. Do Not Let the Encirclement Define You

When people feel surrounded, the greatest danger is not only the pressure outside them. It is the false identity that begins to form within them.

"I am a failure."

"I have no way out."

"God has forgotten me."

Once these words take root in the heart, a person may surrender inwardly before anything has truly ended.

But faith reminds us: you are not defined by your present difficulty.

You are defined by the grace of God.

You are someone He created, someone He loves, and someone He is still able to lead.

Today's trouble is not the whole story of your life.

The present encirclement is not the end of God's story.

#### 5. Lifting Your Eyes Is the Beginning of Breakthrough

The psalmist says, "My help comes from the LORD, the Maker of heaven and earth." (Psalm 121:2, NIV)

This is not sentimental poetry. It is a choice made in difficulty.

When people are pressed on every side, the natural reaction is to look down: at the problem, the loss, the pressure, and the opinions of others.

But the movement of faith is to lift the eyes.

To lift your eyes is not to escape reality. It is to remember the source of your help.

To lift your eyes does not mean the problem disappears immediately. It means the heart is no longer completely swallowed by the problem.

To lift your eyes is to say: my help does not come from my circumstances or from human approval. My help comes from the Lord, the Maker of heaven and earth.

Often the first step in breaking through an encirclement is not a changed environment, but a changed vision.

You begin to see yourself, your situation, and your future again from God's perspective.

Conclusion: God Is Not Trapped by Your Trouble

If you are facing a season of pressure on every side, do not rush to draw final conclusions about your life.

You may see encirclement, but God may see training.

You may see an ending, but God may see a turning.

You may see no road, but God can make a way in the wilderness and streams in the desert.

Being surrounded is not necessarily the end.

Being hard pressed does not mean being crushed.

As long as God is present, the story is not over.

So do not let fear interpret your life for you.

Do not let pressure decide your direction.

Do not let a temporary encirclement steal the hope within you.

Lift your eyes.

Keep moving.

You may not yet see the road.

But the God who makes a way is already at work.



# 3. 一次惊吓 A Frightening Afternoon

## 平安从来不是理所当然

昨天下午，妻子忽然对我说：“我有点喘不过气。”

这是一句很短的话，却一下子打破了一个普通下午的平静。

说实话，这并不是第一次。过去两个星期，她已经有过几次类似的情况。但这一次看起来不太一样：呼吸更费力，脸色也不太好，声音里带着一种让我立刻紧张起来的急迫。

那一刻，我心里真的有些害怕。

人总是习惯以为，明天还会照常来到。

我们安排日程，计划未来，想着接下来要做什么，也习惯性地认为身边所爱的人会一直都在。

可是生活常常只需要一个很小的意外，就会提醒我们：生命其实比我们想象的脆弱。

我扶着妻子，尽量让自己保持镇定。我们先去了家庭医生那里，希望能马上看诊。因为没有预约，诊所无法立刻安排检查；但听到她的症状后，医护人员建议我们直接去急诊，并为她安排了救护车。

看着救护车开来的那一刻，我心里有一种说不出的无力。

过去我也见过很多救护车在路上呼啸而过。那时总觉得，那是别人的故事。

可当救护车是为你所爱的人而来时，它就突然变成了你的故事。

一切感觉都不一样了。

救护车载着妻子先走，我开车跟在后面。

路程其实不长，却觉得格外漫长。

我脑子里不断冒出各种问题：

会不会是心脏？

会不会是肺？

会不会很严重？



会不会有危险？

以后会不会受影响？

人在未知面前，最容易把事情往最坏的方向想。

那一路上，我再次体会到：让人害怕的，很多时候不是已经知道的事实，而是不知道的可能。

到了医院，急诊很快开始检查。

心电图。

验血。

胸片。

心率、血氧和各项指标的持续监测。

然后，就是等待。

等待，是最难的功课之一。

医生每进来一次，我都会站起来。

护士每经过一次，我都想知道有没有新的消息。

每一分钟，都像被拉长了。

我平时常常安慰别人，陪伴别人面对疾病、损失和不确定。可是当事情发生在自己家人身上时，感觉完全不同。

很多道理突然变小。

很多答案突然不够用。

眼前最重要的，只剩下那个你所爱的人。

感谢神，后来一个个让人担心的可能性被排除。

心脏看起来正常。

肺部看起来正常。

血氧正常。

甲状腺功能指标也正常。

医生没有发现明显的心肺急症。后续主要需要继续检查颈部和喉咙附近的情况，确认是否与甲状腺或其他局部问题有关。

当这些结果陆续出来时，我觉得肩上的重担一点一点放下来。

松一口气，是一种很特别的感觉。

它不一定轰轰烈烈。

没有掌声，也没有烟火。

只是心里深深吸了一口气，然后生出感恩。

那天晚上离开医院时，天色已经暗下来。坐进车里，我没有马上发动。

我开始想：这一次惊吓，到底在教我什么？

一、健康是礼物，不是权利

我们太容易把健康当作理所当然。

早上醒来，可以自由呼吸。

下床走路，不需要人扶。

一日三餐，可以正常吃饭。

这些事平常到几乎不会被注意。

可是一次身体的警讯，就能让人立刻明白：原来呼吸不是理所当然，平安不是理所当然，明天也不是理所当然。

人常常等到身体出状况，才想起健康的宝贵。

也常常等到医院的灯光照在脸上，才明白普通日子的可贵。

二、婚姻到后来，更多是陪伴

这次经历也让我重新思想婚姻。

结婚多年以后，爱和年轻时很不一样。

年轻时，总觉得爱是浪漫，是心动，是美好的回忆。

年纪渐长以后才明白，爱更是一种牵挂，一种责任，一种“我愿意和你一起面对”的承诺。

爱是坐在医院病床旁边。

爱是等待检查结果。

爱是在不知道下一步会怎样的时候，仍然握着对方的手。

真正的爱，不只是热烈地表达，而是忠心地同在。

人这一生，真正能够陪伴彼此的时间，其实没有想象中那么长。

如果明天无法保证，那么今天就更值得珍惜。

### 三、软弱并不可耻

这件事也让我更深地看见自己的有限。

平时在服事中，我常常安慰别人，鼓励别人，陪人走过困难。

但当危机临到自己家里，我才发现，原来自己也会害怕，也会紧张，也会在深夜里焦虑。

这种软弱并不可耻。

它只是提醒我：人终究不是万能的。

我们无法掌控所有事情，无法预知所有风险，也无法保证明天一定按照自己的计划展开。

正因为如此，人需要谦卑。

需要感恩。

需要珍惜。

需要善待身边的人。

### 四、惊吓若带来醒悟，就不只是惊吓

有些经历，我们并不愿意遇见。

但既然经历了，就不应该白白过去。

如果一次惊吓过去以后，我们什么都没有改变，那么它只是一场惊吓。

但如果它让我们更加珍惜健康，更加珍惜家人，更加珍惜今天，那么它就成为一次成长。

人生不会因为一次检查结果正常，就从此再也没有风浪。

但人生可以因为一次经历，而拥有新的眼光。

那天晚上回到家，看着妻子安静地坐在沙发上，我忽然觉得特别感恩。

不是因为所有问题都已经彻底解决。

而是因为我们依然能够一起面对未来。

这或许就是生命很真实的意义。

不是永远没有风浪。

而是在风浪来临的时候，仍然懂得珍惜彼此；在未知面前，仍然学会相信；在脆弱之中，仍然发现生命的宝贵。

结语：今天比明天更值得珍惜

感谢这一次惊吓。

它让我重新认识生命，重新认识婚姻，也重新认识自己。

有些课程，书本教不会。

有些成长，道理讲不出来。

只有亲身经历以后，人才会真正明白。

这一次，我学到最重要的一课是：

平安，从来不是理所当然。

家人，永远比事情重要。

今天，永远比明天更值得珍惜。

# A Frightening Afternoon

## Peace Is Never Something to Take for Granted

Yesterday afternoon, my wife suddenly looked at me and said, “I’m having trouble breathing.”

They were simple words, yet they instantly broke the peace of an ordinary day.

To be honest, this was not the first time it had happened. During the previous two weeks, she had experienced similar episodes several times. But this time felt different. Her breathing seemed more labored, her face looked pale, and there was an urgency in her voice that immediately made me anxious.

In that moment, fear entered my heart.

Life often gives us the illusion that tomorrow is guaranteed.

We make plans, arrange schedules, pursue goals, and assume that the people we love will always be beside us.

But sometimes one small unexpected event is enough to remind us how fragile life really is.

I held my wife and tried to remain calm. We first went to our family doctor’s office, hoping she could be seen immediately. Because we did not have an appointment, they were unable to examine her right away. After hearing her symptoms, however, the medical staff advised us to go directly to the emergency room and arranged for an ambulance.

As I watched the ambulance arrive, I felt a deep sense of helplessness.

For years, I had seen ambulances rushing down roads with flashing lights and sirens. They always seemed to belong to someone else’s story.

But when an ambulance comes for someone you love, it suddenly becomes your story.

Everything changes.

The ambulance left with my wife inside. I followed behind in my own car.

The drive was not long, but it felt endless.

My mind raced with questions.

Was it her heart?

Was it her lungs?

Was it something serious?

Could it be dangerous?

Would this affect her life from now on?

When faced with uncertainty, the human mind easily imagines the worst.

During that drive, I learned again that fear is often fueled not by what we know, but by what we do not know.

When I arrived at the hospital, the emergency department quickly began evaluating her condition.

An EKG.

Blood tests.

A chest X-ray.

Continuous monitoring of her heart rate, oxygen level, and other vital signs.

Then came the waiting.

Waiting is one of the hardest things a person can do.

Every time a doctor entered the room, I stood up.

Every time a nurse walked by, I wondered whether there was news.

Every minute seemed longer than sixty seconds.

I have spent much of my life encouraging others through illness, loss, uncertainty, and fear. Yet when the crisis touches your own family, everything feels different.

Suddenly, many answers seem smaller.

Many theories become less useful.

And all that matters is the person you love.

By God's grace, one concern after another began to be ruled out.

Her heart appeared normal.

Her lungs appeared normal.

Her oxygen level was normal.

Her thyroid function was normal.

The doctors did not find evidence of an obvious heart or lung emergency. The main concern that remained was the need for further evaluation of her neck and throat area, including whether anything related to the thyroid or nearby structures might be involved.

As the results came back, I felt the burden on my shoulders slowly lift.

Relief is a strange emotion.

It does not always arrive dramatically.

There are no fireworks and no applause.

There is only a deep breath and a grateful heart.

When we left the hospital that evening, the sky had already grown dark. I sat in the car for a few moments before starting the engine.

I began to ask myself: What was this frightening afternoon teaching me?

### 1. Health Is a Gift, Not a Right

We take health for granted far too easily.

We wake up and breathe without thinking.

We get out of bed and walk without needing help.

We eat our meals as if these abilities naturally belong to us.

But one warning from the body can remind us immediately: breath is not guaranteed, peace is not guaranteed, and tomorrow is not guaranteed.

Often we remember the value of health only when something goes wrong.

Often we understand the preciousness of ordinary days only under the lights of a hospital room.

### 2. In Marriage, Love Becomes Presence

This experience also made me think again about marriage.

After many years together, love looks different than it did in the beginning.

When we are young, we often think of love as romance, excitement, and beautiful memories.

As the years pass, love becomes concern, responsibility, and the commitment to face life together.

Love is sitting beside a hospital bed.

Love is waiting for test results.

Love is holding someone's hand when neither of you knows what comes next.

True love is not measured only by passionate expression.

It is measured by faithful presence.

The time we truly have to accompany one another in this life is not as long as we imagine.

If tomorrow is not guaranteed, then today is even more worth cherishing.

### 3. Vulnerability Is Not Shameful



This experience also revealed my own limitations.

In ministry, I often comfort others, encourage others, and walk with people through difficult seasons.

But when fear entered my own home, I realized that I too can be afraid. I too can become anxious. I too can feel small in the middle of the night.

This vulnerability is not shameful.

It simply reminds me that human beings are not all-powerful.

We cannot control everything, foresee every risk, or guarantee that tomorrow will unfold according to our plans.

That is why we need humility.

We need gratitude.

We need to cherish life.

We need to treat the people beside us with tenderness.

#### 4. If Fear Awakens Us, It Becomes More Than Fear

Some experiences are not ones we would choose.

But once they come, we should not let them pass in vain.

If a frightening experience ends and nothing changes in us, then it remains only a fright.

But if it teaches us to treasure health, family, and today more deeply, then it becomes a moment of growth.

Life will not become free from storms simply because one set of test results comes back reassuring.

But one experience can give us new eyes.

That evening, after we returned home, I watched my wife sitting quietly on the sofa. I felt deeply grateful.

Not because every problem had been completely resolved.

But because we were still able to face the future together.

Perhaps this is one of life's most honest meanings.

Not that there will never be storms.

But that when storms come, we still learn to cherish one another; in uncertainty, we still learn to trust; and in weakness, we still discover the preciousness of life.

Conclusion: Today Is Worth Cherishing



I am grateful for that frightening afternoon.

It helped me see life again, marriage again, and myself again.

Some lessons cannot be taught by books.

Some growth cannot be explained by principles alone.

Only after we pass through certain experiences do we truly understand.

The most important lesson I learned that day was this:

Peace is never something to take for granted.

Family is always more important than tasks.

Today is always more worth cherishing than tomorrow.

# 4. 我和我的邻居 Me and My Neighbors

## 一次搬家风波中的温暖与理解

那天，对于我们教会来说，是一个特别忙碌、也特别难忘的日子。

因为教会搬迁，我们需要把许多物品临时搬离原来的聚会地点。桌椅、音响、钢琴、书籍、器具，一车装不下，我们连续搬了两趟，而且都是大型货车。

于是，在一个原本平静的小区里，忽然出现了许多人进进出出、大车停靠、搬运家具的场景。

邻居们自然注意到了。

后来，有邻居在小区群里发信息，担心我们是不是要在家里开教会，担心以后会不会有很多人来聚会，影响社区的安静、停车和生活秩序。

说实话，看到这条信息的时候，我心里是能够理解的。

因为站在邻居的角度，他们关心的并不只是“搬东西”这件事，而是未来会不会发生变化。

人很多时候不是讨厌别人，而是害怕未知。

未知，会让人紧张。

紧张，就容易产生误会。

所以，我很快在群里做了说明：这些家具只是暂时存放在我家的车库里，我们不会在家里举行聚会。教会目前暂时借用别的教堂聚会，同时也在寻找和购买新的聚会场所。

后来，我又简单介绍自己。我告诉大家，我是一位牧师，很珍惜能够住在这个社区，也希望与邻居们保持良好的关系。

让我感动的是，接下来发生的事。

群里不少邻居开始主动表达理解和善意。

有人说，别人没有必要解释这么多。

有人说，欢迎来到这个社区。

也有人送上祝福，愿上帝祝福我们和教会。

看到这些留言时，我心里有很深的触动。

原来，无论是在中国还是在美国，人心深处对善意、真诚和尊重的感受，都是相通的。

语言可以不同。

文化可以不同。

肤色和背景可以不同。

但人与人之间最基本的善良和理解，并没有那么远。

中国有句老话：“远亲不如近邻。”

小时候听这句话，只觉得是一句生活经验；这些年在海外生活、牧会以后，才越来越发现，这句话里其实有很深的人生智慧。

亲人再亲，也不一定天天能见到。

邻居却是每天抬头低头都会遇见的人。

你深夜车坏了，也许第一个帮你推车的是邻居。

冬天下雪，也许旁边默默帮你一起清理车道的是邻居。

家里突然遇到状况，第一个借你工具、问你需不需要帮忙的，也可能是邻居。

所以，一个人的修养，不只是会不会说大道理，而是能不能在最真实的生活里，与身边的人和平相处。

这也是信仰中很重要的教导。

主耶稣说：“要爱人如己。”（马太福音 22:39，和合本）

这个“人”，很多时候不是远方抽象的人，而是你身边具体的人。

是你的家人。

是你的同事。

也是你的邻舍。

真正的信仰，不只是礼拜天在教堂里显得属灵。

真正的信仰也在停车时有没有考虑别人，在说话时有没有尊重别人，在被误解时有没有温柔解释。

我越来越觉得，一个人最有力量的见证，往往不是口号，而是生活。

不是你说了多少，而是别人从你身上看见了什么。

那天的小插曲，也让我再次学习一件事：当别人误会你的时候，不一定非要争辩。

但真诚的沟通，常常能够化解很多不必要的隔阂。

有时候，人们并不是故意敌对，只是缺少了解。

而一句温和的解释，一个尊重的态度，就可能让气氛完全不同。

我也特别感恩教会弟兄姊妹在搬家过程中的配搭。大家没有混乱，没有抱怨，安安静静地做事，把物品整整齐齐地搬进车库，也把原来的地方收拾干净。

这种秩序、配搭和彼此承担，本身就是一种见证。

教会不只是一个聚会的地方。

教会真正的样子，是一群愿意彼此相爱、彼此服事、彼此承担的人。

而这种爱，不应该只停留在教会里面，也应该流露到社区、邻里和日常生活之中。

回头看，这次小插曲也许并不是坏事。

它让我更真实地认识了我的邻居，也让我意识到：人与人之间最重要的，不是身份，而是态度；不是立场，而是善意。

在这个越来越容易对立、越来越容易误解的时代，如果我们还能彼此耐心一点、温柔一点、真诚一点，其实就已经很宝贵。

愿我们都能成为让邻舍安心的人。

愿我们的信仰，不只是挂在墙上的十字架，也成为别人眼中真实的温暖。

# Me and My Neighbors

## Warmth and Understanding in the Middle of a Church Move

That day was both busy and unforgettable for our church.

Because our church was relocating, we needed to move many items out of our former worship space temporarily. Chairs, sound equipment, a piano, books, tables, and various ministry supplies had to be transported and stored. One truck was not enough, so we made two trips with large moving trucks.

Naturally, this attracted attention in our quiet neighborhood.

Soon afterward, someone in the neighborhood group posted a concern. They wondered whether a church was being set up in my home, since so many chairs, speakers, and even a piano had been moved into the garage. They worried that many people might begin gathering there regularly, affecting the quietness, parking, and rhythm of the community.

Honestly, when I saw the message, I understood the concern.

From a neighbor's perspective, they were not merely seeing furniture being moved. They were wondering whether their neighborhood was about to change.

Often, people are not against others personally.

They are simply uneasy about the unknown.

The unknown creates anxiety.

Anxiety easily creates misunderstanding.

So I quickly responded and explained the situation. I shared that the furniture was only being stored temporarily in my garage. We would not be holding worship services in our home. At the moment, our congregation was borrowing another church facility while continuing to search for and purchase a future church building.

Later, I introduced myself briefly as a pastor. I expressed that I truly appreciated living in this community and hoped to build good relationships with the neighbors around us.

What happened next deeply touched me.

Several neighbors began responding with kindness and support.

Some said that I did not owe anyone such a detailed explanation.

Others welcomed us to the neighborhood.

Some even offered blessings, asking God to bless us and the church.

As I read those messages, I felt something deeply.

Whether in China or in America, human hearts still recognize sincerity, respect, and kindness.

Languages may differ.

Cultures may differ.

Backgrounds may differ.

But basic goodness and understanding are not as far apart as we sometimes imagine.

There is an old Chinese saying: "Distant relatives are not as valuable as close neighbors."

When I was young, I thought it was merely practical wisdom. But after living and ministering overseas, I have come to see how profound it really is.

Relatives may love you deeply, but they are often far away.

Neighbors are the people you meet in ordinary life.

If your car breaks down late at night, a neighbor may be the first to help.

When snow covers the driveway in winter, a neighbor may quietly shovel alongside you.

When something unexpected happens at home, a neighbor may be the first to lend a tool or ask whether you need help.

True character is not measured only by grand ideas. It is measured by whether we can live peacefully, respectfully, and graciously with the people near us.

This is also deeply biblical.

Jesus said, "Love your neighbor as yourself." (Matthew 22:39, NIV)

That neighbor is often not an abstract person far away. It is the real person nearby.

Your family.

Your coworker.

The person next door.

Real faith is not demonstrated only in church on Sunday morning.

Real faith is also seen in how we park, how we speak, how we respect others, and how we respond when we are misunderstood.

I have increasingly realized that the strongest witness of a Christian life is not found in slogans, but in daily conduct.

Not merely in what we say, but in what others see through us.

This small incident reminded me again that when people misunderstand us, we do not always need to become defensive.

Sincere communication can dissolve many unnecessary tensions.

Sometimes people are not hostile. They simply lack information.

And often, one gentle explanation and a respectful attitude can change the whole atmosphere.

I was also deeply grateful for our church members during the move. Despite the hard work, there was no chaos and no complaining. Everyone quietly worked together, packed carefully, stored things neatly, and cleaned the former space well.

That spirit of cooperation, humility, and service is itself a testimony.

A church is not merely a building or a service.

A church is a people willing to love, serve, and carry burdens together.

And that love should not remain inside church walls. It should flow into neighborhoods, communities, and daily life.

Looking back, perhaps this small incident was not a bad thing after all.

It helped me know my neighbors more honestly, and it reminded me that what matters most between people is not identity, but attitude; not position, but goodwill.

In a world that becomes divided so quickly, patience, gentleness, and sincerity are already precious.

May we become the kind of neighbors who bring peace to those around us.

And may our faith become more than a cross on the wall. May it become a living warmth that others can truly feel.



# 5. 爱心的激励 The Inspiration of Love

## 一个人的慷慨，如何点燃一群人的心

有时候，一个人的出现，真的会改变一群人的心。

这两天，我们这个小小的群体，就被一位姊妹深深感动。

其实，在此之前，我们并不熟悉她。

没有一起吃过饭，没有深入交流过，甚至连真正意义上的见面都很少。我们之间主要的联系，不过是每天清晨在线上一起学习、唱诗、分享生活中的点滴。

隔着屏幕，隔着距离，彼此鼓励，彼此问候。

仅此而已。

但很多时候，人与人之间最真实的连接，并不一定来自频繁见面，反而可能来自心灵深处那份真实的共鸣。

这段时间，我们正计划购置一处房产，作为未来学习、聚会、交流与传播使用的空间。

对我们来说，这不仅是一个房子，更像是一个新的起点，一个承载梦想与盼望的地方。

许多人都知道，这样的事情并不容易。

需要资金，需要时间，需要信心，更需要大家同心同行。

就在大家不断讨论、计划、担忧的时候，她来了。

那一天，非常普通。

她没有耀眼的穿着，没有精致的打扮。背着一个简单的布包，穿着也十分朴素，看起来就像街头随处可见的一位普通妇人。

如果在人群里，可能没有人会特别注意她。

但真正有力量的人，往往不靠外表吸引人。

她安安静静地来到我们中间，没有太多客套的话语，也没有刻意强调自己做了什么。可就在交流过程中，她默默献上了一份非常慷慨的奉献。

那一刻，我们很多人都愣住了。

因为这远远超出了我们的想象。

更让人震撼的，并不是金额本身，而是她那份发自内心的爱。



她不是为了得到称赞。

也不是为了让别人记住她。

她甚至低调得让人几乎感觉不到她的存在。

但正因为如此，那份爱反而显得更加真实。

这几天，群体里很多人都在谈论这件事。

有人感叹，看不出来她竟然这样有爱心。

也有人说，原本以为自己已经很愿意付出了，但与她相比，才发现自己的心还有许多可以被扩张的地方。

还有人被深深激励。

因为很多时候，人不是没有能力，而是缺少那一步跨出去的勇气。

不是没有资源，而是缺少愿意分享的心。

她没有讲很多大道理，却用行动给大家上了一课。

她让人看见，爱不是停留在感动里，而是会变成行动。

后来，在分享中，她也谈到自己一路走来的经历，谈到如何教育儿女，如何在平凡生活中学习付出、感恩和善待别人。

她的话语并不华丽。

但每一句都很真实。

真正打动人的，从来不是技巧，而是真诚。

有时候，一个人的生命会像一盏灯。

灯本身并不喧哗，却能够照亮别人。

我们忽然发现，真正能够激励人的，不是口号，不是热闹，而是一个人真实活出来的样子。

因为爱，是会传递的。

一个愿意付出的人，会让更多人开始愿意付出。

一个愿意关心别人的人，也会慢慢唤醒别人心中的温柔。

这几天，我们看见很多人开始主动分享、主动参与、主动表达关心。

有人说：“我也想尽一点力量。”

有人说：“虽然我能力有限，但我愿意参与。”

也有人说：“原来人与人之间，真的可以因为爱而彼此靠近。”

这份影响，远远超过了一次简单的帮助。

它像一颗种子，被撒进许多人心里。

也许未来某一天，这颗种子会继续发芽，继续影响更多人。

我常常觉得，在这个时代，真正稀缺的并不是聪明的人，而是有温度的人。

聪明可以让人成功。

但爱，能够让人彼此扶持。

很多人外表光鲜，内心却越来越冷漠。

很多人拥有许多，却越来越不愿分享。

所以，当我们看见这样一份真实而朴素的爱时，心里自然会被触动。

也许，这就是爱的力量。

它不一定轰轰烈烈，却能够悄悄改变人的内心。

它不一定惊天动地，却能够在人最疲惫的时候，给人重新站起来的力量。

我们真的非常感恩。

感恩上帝把这样一位充满爱心的人带到我们当中。

她没有高谈阔论，却用最简单的方式提醒我们：

一个人真正的价值，不在于拥有多少，而在于愿意给予多少。

愿这样的爱，继续激励我们。

也愿我们每一个人，都能成为别人生命中的一点光、一份温暖、一种力量。

因为很多时候，真正改变世界的，从来不是宏大的声音，而是一颗愿意去爱的心。

# The Inspiration of Love

## How One Person's Generosity Can Awaken Many Hearts

Sometimes, the presence of one person can quietly change the hearts of many.

Over the past few days, our small community has been deeply moved by one sister.

To be honest, we did not know her well before.

We had not shared meals together, nor spent much time face to face. Our main connection came through early morning online gatherings where we studied, sang, encouraged one another, and shared small moments of life.

Separated by screens and distance, we greeted one another and encouraged one another.

That was all.

Yet sometimes, the deepest human connections are not built through frequent meetings, but through sincere hearts that resonate with one another.

Recently, we have been preparing to purchase a property that could serve as a place for learning, gathering, communication, and ministry.

For us, it is not merely a building. It represents a new beginning, a space filled with hope and future possibilities.

Projects like this are never easy.

They require resources, time, faith, and unity.

While everyone was still discussing plans, calculating costs, and wondering how things would move forward, she came.

The day looked completely ordinary.

She wore simple clothes and carried a plain fabric bag. There was nothing flashy about her appearance. If she had walked through a crowded street, almost nobody would have paid special attention to her.

But often, people with the greatest inner strength are the ones who appear most ordinary.

She came quietly, spoke gently, and did not try to draw attention to herself. Yet during our conversation, she unexpectedly offered a very generous gift.

At that moment, many of us were stunned.

Not merely because of the amount, but because of the sincerity behind it.

She was not seeking recognition.

She was not trying to impress anyone.

In fact, she was so humble that one could almost overlook her presence entirely.

And perhaps that is why her love felt even more genuine.

Over the past few days, many people in our group continued talking about this experience.

Some said they never would have guessed that she had such a generous heart.

Others admitted that they thought they were already willing to give, but after seeing her example, they realized their own hearts still had room to grow.

Many were deeply inspired.

Often, people do not lack ability; they lack the courage to step forward.

They do not lack resources; they lack the willingness to share.

Without preaching grand speeches, she taught all of us an unforgettable lesson through her actions.

She showed us that love does not remain only as emotion. It becomes action.

Later, during our conversations, she shared stories about her own journey, about how she raised her children, and about how she learned to live with gratitude, kindness, and generosity in ordinary daily life.

Her words were not polished or dramatic.

But every sentence felt deeply authentic.

What truly moves people is not eloquence, but sincerity.

Sometimes, a person's life becomes like a lamp.

The lamp itself does not make noise, yet it quietly brings light to others.

We suddenly realized that the most powerful inspiration does not come from slogans or emotional speeches, but from seeing someone genuinely live out love.

Because love spreads.

A generous person inspires others to become generous.

A caring person awakens compassion in the hearts of others.

In recent days, we have seen people become more willing to participate, share, and support one another.

Some said, "I want to contribute too."

Others said, "Even if my ability is limited, I still want to help."

Some quietly reflected, "Perhaps people really can draw closer to one another through love."

The impact of her kindness went far beyond one act of giving.

It planted a seed in many hearts.

Perhaps one day, that seed will continue to grow and influence even more lives.

I often feel that in today's world, what is truly rare is not intelligence, but warmth.

Intelligence may help people succeed.

Love helps people support one another.

Many people appear successful outwardly, yet inwardly become colder and more distant.

Many possess much, yet become less willing to share.

That is why genuine love feels so powerful when we encounter it.

Perhaps this is the true strength of love.

It does not always arrive loudly, yet it quietly transforms hearts.

It may not shake the world dramatically, yet it can give weary people the strength to rise again.

We are deeply thankful.

Thankful that God brought such a loving person into our midst.

Without many words, she reminded us of something important:

A person's true value is not measured by how much they possess, but by how willing they are to give.

May this kind of love continue to inspire us.

And may each of us become a small light, a source of warmth, and a quiet strength in the lives of others.

Because in the end, what truly changes the world is not a loud voice or a grand achievement, but a heart willing to love.

# 6. 愛的力量 The Power of Love

## 真正改变人的爱，从来不把荣耀停在人身上

这几天，因为一位姊妹的举动，我们许多人都被深深感动。

她并不高调，也没有特别耀眼的外表。第一次来到我们中间的时候，她穿着朴素，背着简单的布包，说话轻声细语，看起来就像人群中很普通的一位姊妹。

可正是这样一位普通的人，用一种安静而真实的方式，让许多人重新思考一个问题：

什么是真正的爱？

之前，我写了一篇《爱心的激励》，分享自己被她爱心触动的经历。

没想到，后来她却很认真地提醒我：

“不要把荣耀归给人。真正的爱，不是从人自己来的。”

这句话，让我安静了很久。

因为她提醒的，不只是谦卑，更是一种很深的生命认识。

我们这个时代，其实很喜欢把焦点放在人身上。

看到一个人有爱心，就容易把他高举。

看到一个人善良，就容易把他变成榜样，甚至变成被崇拜的对象。

但真正成熟的人，反而知道：自己不过是一个传递者。

真正的光，并不属于自己。

真正有爱的人，也往往最谦卑。

因为他知道，若不是自己先经历过爱，人其实很难真正去爱别人。

这些年，我越来越发现，人的爱其实非常有限。

顺利的时候，我们容易温柔。

疲惫的时候，我们就容易冷淡。

别人理解我们时，我们愿意付出。

别人误解我们时，我们就容易后退。

很多时候，人不是不想爱，而是爱到最后，发现自己越来越累。

因为人的爱，本来就像一口井。

如果没有源头，再深的井，也终究会干。

所以，有些人年轻时很热情，中年以后却越来越冷。

不是因为经历太少，恰恰是因为经历太多。

受过伤的人，会开始保护自己。

被辜负过的人，会慢慢封闭内心。

长期付出却没有回应的人，也容易失去温柔。

于是，人开始学会计算。

我付出多少？

别人会不会回报？

这样做值不值得？

慢慢地，人与人之间的关系也越来越像交易。

有价值，就靠近。

没有价值，就离开。

所以这个时代最稀缺的，往往不是聪明，而是真正的温暖。

很多人拥有能力，却失去了柔软。

很多人拥有资源，却越来越不会爱。

可奇妙的是，即使世界越来越现实，人内心深处仍然渴望真正的爱。

因为爱，是人灵魂最深的需要之一。

一个人最痛苦的时候，真正能够让他重新站起来的，往往不是大道理，而是有人愿意理解他、接纳他、陪伴他。

真正的爱，从来不只是情绪。

真正的爱，是一种愿意付代价的能力。

愿意在别人软弱的时候不离开。

愿意在别人失败的时候不轻看。

愿意在别人跌倒的时候仍然伸出手。



这样的爱，并不属于人的天然本性。

人的本能更倾向于先保护自己。

而真正的爱，总是带着一种舍己的味道。

这也是为什么，历史上最伟大的爱，往往都伴随着牺牲。

不是站在高处讲道理，而是愿意走进别人的痛苦里。

不是只停留在口头，而是真实地承担代价。

所以后来我越来越明白：真正的爱，并不是人努力表演出来的。

真正的爱，是一个人先被爱触摸，然后才开始学会去爱。

一个真正经历过饶恕的人，会更容易饶恕别人。

一个真正经历过接纳的人，会更容易接纳别人。

一个真正知道自己也不完全的人，也更容易对别人温柔。

因为他知道，自己并不比别人更高尚。

只是曾经在黑暗里，被光照亮过。

所以，一个真正有爱的人，通常不会骄傲。

他知道，爱不是自己的功劳，而是一份被托付、被传递的温暖。

就像月亮不会夸耀自己的光。

因为月亮知道，真正的光源不属于自己。

那位姊妹让我们感动的，不只是她的奉献，更是她的态度。

她没有希望别人高举她，也没有希望别人记念她。

她反而提醒我们：不要停留在人身上。

因为人的爱会有限，人的热情也会过去。

但真正能够持续改变人的那份爱，却来自更高、更深、更永恒的源头。

这种爱，会让骄傲的人变谦卑，让冷漠的人重新柔软，让失望的人重新有盼望。

它不是宗教口号，而是真实能够改变生命的力量。

很多时候，人以为世界靠能力推动。

后来才发现，真正推动世界向前的，往往是那些默默付出的人。



一个愿意原谅的人，能够修复关系。

一个愿意承担的人，能够带来平安。

一个愿意牺牲自己的人，能够温暖许多人。

而这一切爱的背后，都在说明：人并不是爱的源头。

我们只是爱的回应者。

因为先有人把爱给了我们，我们才慢慢学会如何去爱。

这几天，我们真正被触动的，也正是这一点。

不是因为看见了一个伟大的人，而是透过一个普通人的生命，重新看见世界上仍然存在一种不求回报的爱。

一种不是为了名声、利益、掌声而存在的爱。

一种即使没有人知道，仍然愿意默默付出的爱。

这样的爱，很安静。

却很有力量。

像冬天里的一盆火，也像黑夜中的一盏灯。

不会一下子改变整个世界，却能够慢慢改变人的心。

也许，人这一生最重要的，不是证明自己多成功。

而是当别人遇见你的时候，能够感受到一点温暖、一点理解、一点希望。

因为最后真正留在人心里的，从来不是财富、地位和荣耀。

而是爱。

# The Power of Love

## Love That Truly Changes People Does Not Keep the Glory for Itself

Over the past few days, many of us have been deeply moved by the actions of one sister.

She was not flashy or attention-seeking. When she first came among us, she dressed simply, carried an ordinary cloth bag, and spoke softly. Outwardly, she looked like an ordinary person.

Yet through her quiet and sincere actions, she caused many of us to reconsider an important question:

What is real love?

Earlier, I wrote an article sharing how her love had inspired me.

Later, however, she said something that stayed deeply in my heart:

“Do not give the glory to people. Real love does not come from us.”

Her words carried more than humility.

They revealed a deep understanding of life itself.

Our world today loves to place the spotlight on human beings.

When someone does something good, we quickly praise the individual.

When someone shows kindness, we easily turn that person into an example to admire, sometimes even an object of admiration beyond what is healthy.

But truly mature people understand something different: they are only carriers.

They are not the source of the light.

And perhaps that is why genuinely loving people are often deeply humble.

They know that if they themselves had never experienced love, they would not know how to love others well.

The longer I live, the more I realize something difficult but true:

Human love is limited.

When life goes smoothly, we are gentle.

When we become exhausted, we grow colder.

When people understand us, we are willing to give.

When people misunderstand us, we withdraw.

Many people do want to love.

But eventually they become tired.

Human love by itself is like a well without an endless spring.

No matter how deep the well may seem, eventually it runs dry.

That is why some people begin life full of warmth but grow colder over time.

Not because they experienced too little pain, but because they experienced too much.

People who were hurt begin protecting themselves.

People who were betrayed close their hearts.

People who gave without response lose tenderness.

Slowly, love becomes calculation.

How much should I give?

What will I receive in return?

Is this worth it?

Relationships become transactional.

People stay close while there is benefit, and quietly leave when there is none.

That is why what this world lacks most is often not intelligence, but warmth.

Many people possess talent yet lose compassion.

Many possess resources yet forget how to love.

And yet, despite all the coldness in the world, human beings still deeply long for genuine love.

Love is one of the deepest needs of the human soul.

When people suffer most, what restores them is often not advice or success, but the experience of being understood, accepted, and accompanied.

True love is not merely emotion.

It is the willingness to carry cost.

The willingness not to leave when others are weak.

The willingness not to despise people when they fail.

The willingness to extend a hand when others fall.

This kind of love does not naturally come from human instinct.

Human instinct says: protect yourself first.

But true love always carries the fragrance of self-giving.

That is why the greatest love in history has always involved sacrifice.

Not standing far away giving lectures, but entering into another person's suffering.

Not merely speaking, but carrying burdens personally.

Over time, I have realized that real love is never something people successfully perform.

True love grows out of first being loved.

A person who has experienced forgiveness becomes more forgiving.

A person who has experienced acceptance becomes more accepting.

A person who understands his own weakness becomes gentler toward others.

Because he understands that he is not morally superior to everyone else.

He was simply once touched by light in his own darkness.

That is why genuinely loving people are rarely arrogant.

They know love is not their personal achievement. It is something entrusted to them and passed through them.

The moon does not boast about its brightness.

The moon knows that the light does not originate from itself.

What moved us most about this sister was not merely her generosity. It was her attitude.

She did not want admiration.

She did not want people to praise her.

Instead, she reminded us not to stop at human beings.

Human love is limited, and human passion eventually fades.

But the love that truly changes people comes from a deeper and eternal source.

This love softens pride.

It restores tenderness.

It gives hope to disappointed hearts.

It is not merely a religious slogan.

It is a real power capable of transforming lives.

For a long time, people have believed that the world moves forward through strength and ability.

But eventually we realize that those who truly move the world are often quiet people who sacrifice for others.

A forgiving person restores relationships.

A responsible person brings peace.

A sacrificial person warms many hearts.

And behind all true love lies one reality:

Human beings are not the source of love.

We are responders to it.

Because someone first loved us, we slowly learn how to love others.

That is what moved us most in these days.

Not the greatness of one person, but the reminder that genuine selfless love still exists in this world.

A love that does not seek applause.

A love that expects no reward.

A love willing to give quietly even when nobody notices.

Such love is quiet.

Yet incredibly powerful.

Like warmth in winter.

Like light in darkness.

It may not instantly change the entire world.

But slowly, it changes human hearts.

Perhaps the deepest meaning of life is not proving how successful we are, but allowing others to feel warmth, understanding, and hope because we existed.

Because in the end, what truly remains in human hearts is never wealth, status, or fame.

It is love.

# 7. 病中反思 Reflections in Illness

## 当身体慢下来，心才终于追上来

有些提醒，不靠闹钟，也不靠良心，而是靠喉咙、鼻子和那一声不太配合的咳嗽。

事情是从一个再普通不过的主日开始的。

礼拜天做完礼拜，回到家，喉咙有点隐隐作痛。我的第一反应并不是“要生病了”，而是一个很“专业”的判断：

大概是台上讲话太用力，用气不够科学。

毕竟，站在台上说话，若只靠嗓子，很容易透支。

我甚至还在心里安慰自己：这是“职业损耗”，算不上什么大事。

到了礼拜一，咳嗽轻轻敲门。

不急，不慌，老规矩：多喝水，维 C 安排上。

心里还很笃定：这种小状况，最多两天，身体自己就会解决。

可人生往往就是这样：你越笃定，它越要给你一点意外。

礼拜二早上，坐下来灵修，还没读几行，鼻子先开始“灵修”了。

堵住，放行，再堵住，顺带附赠源源不断的流动感。

那一刻，我终于承认一件事：

原来不是我在管理身体，而是身体在提醒我。

一、身体的病痛，是人有限的标点符号

人最容易忘记自己有限的时候，通常是在一切运转正常的时候。

嗓子好用的时候，以为声音是理所当然的。

呼吸顺畅的时候，不会意识到每一口气都是恩典。

鼻子通畅的时候，也从不感谢它安静地站岗。

直到有一天，身体在句子中间，给你打了一个逗号。



你才意识到：哦，这段话，不能一口气说完。

病痛从来不一定是人生的终结符号。

更多时候，它只是一个温柔却坚定的暂停键。

它不吼你，也不训你。

它只是用最朴素的方式告诉你：

你不是无限的。

二、病中反思，是为了重新校准

我有一个可能不太科学、但对我很真实的习惯。

每一次身体不舒服，我都会问自己一个问题：

是不是哪里失衡了？

不是为了自责，而是为了校准。

头痛的时候，我会问：最近是不是想得太多，却想得不够清明、不够良善？

牙痛的时候，我会反省：是不是说了不该说的话，或者该说的，却选择了沉默？

落枕的时候，我会提醒自己：是不是太固执，坚持某个姿势太久，连转头都不肯？

当然，我并不认为所有病痛都能一一对应。

但我知道一件事：

身体常常比嘴诚实。

它会替心里没来得及说出口的疲惫，替灵里尚未整理好的混乱，先举手示意。

三、生病这件事，让“快”显得有点可笑

一生病，很多“重要的事”突然就没有那么重要了。

回复慢一点，好像也没塌天。

事情晚一点做，世界依然转。

效率低一点，反而更真实地活着。



你会发现，真正重要的，从来不是你完成了多少，而是你有没有听见自己正在消耗。

病中的节奏，很慢。

慢到你不得不坐下来，慢慢喝水，慢慢呼吸，慢慢承认：

原来我也需要被照顾。

四、反思不是定罪，而是重新对齐

我不把病中反思，当作一种自我惩罚。

它更像一次内部对话。

不是问：“我哪里错了？”

而是问：“我哪里偏了？”

偏离休息。

偏离节制。

偏离倾听。

当身体替你按下暂停，其实是在给你一个重新对齐的机会。

五、病中所得的一点小结

这次小小的不适，没有什么戏剧性，却很真实。

它让我记住几件事：

人是有限的，不需要假装无限。

身体是提醒，不是敌人。

慢下来，不等于失败。

反思，是为了更温柔地继续前行。

如果有一天你也在病中，不妨别急着“恢复正常”。

先听一听：

你的身体，正在对你说什么。

# Reflections in Illness

## When the Body Slows Down, the Heart Finally Catches Up

Some reminders do not come from alarms or conscience, but from a sore throat, a blocked nose, and a cough that refuses to cooperate.

It began on an ordinary Sunday.

After the service, I returned home with a slight soreness in my throat. My first thought was not “I am getting sick,” but a very professional conclusion:

I probably spoke too forcefully and did not manage my breath well.

After all, when you speak publicly and rely too much on your throat, it is easy to overdraw your voice.

I even comforted myself: this is occupational wear and tear. Nothing serious.

By Monday, a mild cough appeared.

No panic.

More water, some vitamin C, the usual routine.

I was still confident that my body would resolve it within a day or two.

But life often surprises those who are too confident.

On Tuesday morning, during my quiet devotion time, before I had read more than a few lines, my nose began its own “spiritual exercise.”

Blocked, released, blocked again, with a generous flow included.

That was the moment I admitted the truth:

I was not managing my body. My body was reminding me.

### 1. Illness Is a Punctuation Mark of Human Limits

We forget our limits most easily when everything is working well.

When the voice is strong, we assume it will always be there.

When breathing is easy, we forget that every breath is grace.

When the nose is clear, we never thank it for quietly doing its job.

Until one day, the body inserts a comma into the middle of our sentence.

Then we realize: this life cannot be spoken in one breath.

Illness is not always a full stop.

More often, it is a pause button: gentle, firm, and unavoidable.

It does not shout.

It does not accuse.

It simply reminds us:

You are not infinite.

## 2. Reflection in Illness Is Realignment

I have a habit that may not be very scientific, but it is honest for me.

Whenever I feel unwell, I ask myself:

Where might I be out of balance?

Not to blame myself, but to realign.

When I have a headache, I ask: Have my thoughts been too restless, and not clear or kind enough?

When my teeth ache, I reflect: Have I spoken carelessly, or avoided words that needed to be said?

When my neck stiffens, I wonder: Have I been too stubborn, holding one posture for too long and refusing to turn?

Of course, I do not believe every symptom has a direct spiritual meaning.

But I do believe this:

The body is often more honest than the mouth.

It raises its hand before the heart has found the words to name its exhaustion, and before the soul has sorted out its confusion.

## 3. Illness Makes Speed Look Ridiculous

When we are sick, many “urgent” things suddenly lose their urgency.

Replies can wait.

Tasks can slow down.

The world does not collapse.

We begin to realize that what truly matters is not how much we accomplish, but whether we notice how much we are spending.

Illness enforces a slower rhythm.

Slow enough to sit down, drink water slowly, breathe deliberately, and admit:

I also need care.

#### 4. Reflection Is Not Condemnation, but Realignment

I do not treat reflection during illness as punishment.

It is more like an inner conversation.

Not “What did I do wrong?”

But “Where have I drifted?”

Away from rest.

Away from moderation.

Away from listening.

When the body presses pause, it may be offering us a chance to realign.

#### 5. A Small Conclusion From a Minor Illness

This discomfort was not dramatic.

But it was honest.

It reminded me of several things:

Human beings are limited, and we do not need to pretend otherwise.

The body is a messenger, not an enemy.

Slowing down is not failure.

Reflection helps us continue more gently.

If one day you find yourself ill, do not rush back to “normal” too quickly.

Pause and listen:

Your body may be saying something your heart has been waiting to hear.

# 8. 过年了 When the New Year Comes

## 年味里的童年记忆

每逢过年，空气里还没飘起鞭炮味，记忆就先响了。

有人说，年是时间的门；对我而言，年更像一把钥匙。一转动，童年的画面就哗啦啦落下来。

小时候，别的孩子盼过年，是盼新衣服、盼压岁钱、盼热闹。

新衣服一穿，腰板都挺直了。

红包一拿，连走路都带风。

而我，对过年却有另一种心情。

不是不喜欢热闹，而是心里知道：年关，是一道“关”。

有些人过年，是团圆。

有些人过年，是过“账”。

在许多家庭里，年前是收拾屋子、买年货；在我们家，年前常常是另一番景象：有人上门讨债。

门外的脚步声，比爆竹更清晰。

父母的叹气声，比年歌更真实。

年，对别人是加法。

对我们，是清算。

### 一、年关与债主

那时的我还小，不懂“经济结构”，也不懂“现金流压力”，只知道门一响，气氛就紧张。

童年里，父母曾在极度困难中听从旁人的建议，有两次几乎要把我送给别人。当然，最后都没有真正发生。

今天回头看，那是贫困时代里一种极端的选择，是无奈，是绝望边缘的挣扎。

我不怨父母。

因为成年后我才明白，一个人若不是走到尽头，绝不会把自己的孩子放在天平上。

有些人过年，是换新手机。

有些人过年，是想办法不让孩子知道家里缺钱。

那两次经历，没有成为事实，却成了我心里很深的印记。

它没有让我恨谁，却让我学会看见：

看见笑容背后的紧张。

看见团圆饭背后的压力。

看见许多人沉默里背着重量。

## 二、蜜罐与裂缝

说实话，比起父母和哥哥，我的童年仍算是在“蜜罐”里长大的。

至少我读了书，穿得整洁，也没有真正被送走。

但蜜罐若有裂缝，甜里也会渗出一点酸。

童年的记忆，并没有让我变得苦毒，反而让我成年后更容易体谅别人。

当我看见有人年底焦虑，我知道那不一定是“信心不够”。

当我听见有人为钱发愁，我知道那不一定是“爱钱如命”。

有些人，不是不爱神，是怕亏欠家人。

有些人，不是不努力，是背着旧账。

年，是一面镜子。

它照出喜乐，也照出负担。

## 三、年，不只是团圆

随着年纪渐长，我慢慢明白，真正的过年，不只是有没有新衣服，也不是红包厚不厚。

年，是提醒：

一年走到尽头，我们是否还在彼此相爱？

一年忙到岁尾，我们是否还愿意彼此体谅？

在服事中，我常常问自己：

今年教会里，有没有人怕过年？

有没有人因为经济压力，不敢回家？

有没有人在热闹中反而更孤单？

过年，对某些人是节日。

对另一些人，是考验。

所以我越来越觉得，过年也是一个牧养的时刻。

不是讲大道理，而是多一点理解。

不是急着问别人做了多少，而是先问一句：“你还好吗？”

#### 四、从债务到祝福

如果童年没有那些经历，也许我会把年看得太轻。

如今我知道，能安心吃一顿年夜饭，是恩典。

能在年关里心里平安，是更大的恩典。

年教会我一件事：

不要轻看别人背后的重量。

当我们说“新年快乐”时，愿我们也有一颗柔软的心。

看见那些还在偿还旧账的人。

拥抱那些还在努力生活的人。

真正的祝福，不是口号，而是愿意成为别人的安慰。

结语：怜悯比日历走得更远

过年，不只是烟花、年夜饭和团圆。

它也是记忆回来敲门的时候。

也是我们重新学习体谅、感恩与祝福的时候。

愿我们在新的一年里，不只拥有热闹，也拥有温柔。

不只收到祝福，也成为祝福。

因为到最后，最深的年味，不是财富，不是烟火，甚至不只是团圆。

而是知道：我们并不孤单。

也知道：怜悯，比日历走得更远。



# When the New Year Comes

## Every New Year, Childhood Returns

Every year as the Lunar New Year approaches, memories sound before the fireworks do.

Some people say the New Year is a door of time. For me, it is more like a key. Once it turns, scenes from childhood fall open all at once.

When I was young, other children looked forward to the New Year because of new clothes, red envelopes, and celebration.

New clothes made them stand taller.

Red envelopes made their steps feel lighter.

But for me, the New Year carried another feeling.

It was not that I disliked celebration. I simply knew that the end of the year was also a threshold.

For some people, New Year meant reunion.

For others, it meant reckoning.

In many homes, the days before the New Year were filled with cleaning, shopping, and preparing festive food. In our home, those days often carried another sound: creditors knocking at the door.

The footsteps outside the door were clearer than firecrackers.

My parents' sighs were more real than holiday songs.

For others, the New Year felt like addition.

For us, it felt like accounting.

### 1. The New Year and the Knock at the Door

I was too young then to understand economic structure or cash flow pressure. I only knew that when someone knocked, the atmosphere changed.

During my childhood, under desperate circumstances and influenced by advice from others, my parents twice considered giving me away. Of course, it never actually happened.

Looking back now, I see it as an extreme thought born out of poverty, helplessness, and the edge of despair.

I do not resent my parents.

As an adult, I understand that unless people have reached the end of themselves, they would never place their own child on such a scale.

For some people, New Year means buying a new phone.

For others, it means trying not to let their children know the family has no money.



Those two moments never became reality, but they left a deep mark in my heart.

They did not teach me to hate anyone. They taught me to see.

To see the anxiety behind smiles.

To see the pressure behind reunion meals.

To see the weight many people silently carry.

## 2. A Honey Jar With Cracks

To be honest, compared with my parents and my older brother, my childhood was still relatively protected.

I was able to study. I was clothed. I was never truly taken away.

In many ways, I grew up inside a honey jar.

But if a honey jar has cracks, even sweetness carries a trace of sourness.

Those childhood memories did not make me bitter. Instead, they made me more able to understand others as an adult.

When I see people anxious at year-end, I know it is not necessarily because they lack faith.

When I hear people worry about money, I know it is not necessarily because they love money too much.

Some people are not failing to love God. They are afraid of failing their families.

Some people are not lazy. They are carrying old debts.

The New Year is a mirror.

It reflects joy, but it also reflects burdens.

## 3. The New Year Is More Than Reunion

As I grow older, I slowly understand that the New Year is not mainly about new clothes or thick red envelopes.

It asks deeper questions:

At the end of another year, are we still loving one another?

After a year of busyness, are we still willing to understand one another?

In ministry, I often ask myself:

Is there anyone in our church who dreads the holidays?

Is there anyone who feels unable to go home because of financial pressure?

Is there anyone who feels even more alone in the middle of celebration?

For some people, New Year is a festival.

For others, it is a test.

That is why I increasingly see the New Year as a pastoral moment.

Not a time for grand lectures, but for deeper understanding.

Not a time to ask first how much someone has done, but to ask gently: “Are you all right?”

#### 4. From Debt to Blessing

If my childhood had not included those experiences, perhaps I would have taken the New Year too lightly.

Now I know that being able to eat a New Year’s Eve dinner in peace is grace.

Having peace in the heart at year’s end is an even greater grace.

The New Year has taught me this:

Do not underestimate the weight others carry.

When we say “Happy New Year,” may we say it with a tender heart.

May we see those still repaying yesterday’s debts.

May we embrace those who are still trying hard to live.

True blessing is not a slogan. It is the willingness to become someone else’s comfort.

#### Conclusion: Compassion Outlives the Calendar

The New Year is not only fireworks, reunion dinners, and celebration.

It is also a time when memory knocks again.

It is a time to learn compassion, gratitude, and blessing again.

May we have not only noise in the new year, but tenderness.

May we not only receive blessing, but become a blessing.

Because in the end, the deepest celebration is not wealth, nor fireworks, nor even reunion.

It is knowing that we are not alone.

And it is knowing that compassion outlives the calendar.

# 9. 以茶会友 Meeting Friends Over Tea

慢下来，好让心追上灵魂

今天家里突然多了一箱茶。

不是顺手带两包的那种，而是结结实实、层层包装、红盒绿盒一字排开的那种。足以让一个喝茶的人，在心里默默算一笔账：够我喝一阵子了。

这已经是我第二次收到“成箱”的茶。

第一次，是一位来自家乡的家人来美国探访，知道我平日喜欢喝茶，特地在行李箱里腾出位置，塞进一整袋茶叶。那一刻，我深刻体会到什么叫“行李箱的属灵优先级”。

茶并不轻。

但情义更重。

你会发现，茶很少是一个人的炫耀品，却常常是人与人之间的媒介。

酒，容易让人高声；咖啡，适合效率；唯独茶，天然带着一种邀请：你坐下来，我们慢慢来。

洗杯、温壶、投茶、注水。没有一个步骤是必须赶时间的。你若急，它就不好喝；你若慢，它反而回甘。

所以，中国人说“以茶会友”，从来不只是喝一口饮料，而是为彼此腾出时间与空间。

那天，看着桌上摆起来的茶罐、礼盒、茶具，我忽然意识到：这些茶，其实都在等一件事。

等人来。

近些年，在华人基督徒群体中，茶与灵修的结合，发展得异常自然。

它不像“禅茶一味”那样有成体系的千年传统，却更像一种当代的、生活化的信仰表达：借用茶的节奏，帮助人亲近神。

这不是把信仰泡进茶里，而是让人慢下来，好让心追上灵魂。

茶特别适合灵修，至少有几个原因。

第一，茶教人等候。

等水温，等茶叶舒展，等滋味浮现。这与等候神、安静在主面前、默想经文，几乎是同一门功课。

第二，茶调动五感。

眼睛看茶汤颜色，鼻子闻香，舌头尝苦与甘，双手感受杯子的温度。而心，终于不再分散。

很多人的信仰卡在头脑层面，而茶恰好把人带回全人参与的状态。

第三，茶懂得苦后回甘。

好茶多半先苦，随后回甜，且甘得很久。这让人自然想到：人生的苦，并不总是结局；十字架之后，才是复活。

第四，茶本质上是分享。

主人多做一步，客人少操一分心。这与彼此服事的精神，不谋而合。

更不用说那四散的香气，正如经上所说，我们是基督的馨香之气。

在当代华人教会中，茶早已不只是附属文化，也可以成为真实的灵修载体。

有人用福音茶道，把洗尘、坦呈、放下等步骤，对应生命的认罪、敞开与交托。

有人以茶席团契的方式，几个人围坐，不急着说话，先泡茶，再读经，最后才分享。结果常常是话不多，却更真。

也有人在清晨一壶茶、一段经文中，开始一天的祷告。独处时，茶帮助人回到安静。

茶叶在水中展开，像人在恩典中被更新。

水太烫，茶会被伤，正如操之过急的属灵操练，反而压垮人。

茶渣留下，却成全了那一杯好茶。身体渐老，灵里却可以更新。

那天晚上，我把新收到的茶泡开。

没有急着评价贵不贵，也没有研究产区年份，只是把杯子递给家人，说了一句：“来，喝点茶。”

我们坐下来。

话题不大，却很真。

我忽然明白：以茶会友，最终不是会茶，而是会人；不是喝懂茶，而是慢慢学会如何与人，也与神相遇。

# Meeting Friends Over Tea

## Slowing Down So the Heart Can Catch Up With the Soul

Today, a full box of tea arrived at my home.

Not a casual gift of one or two packets, but a carefully packed box, with red and green packages lined up in order. The kind that makes a tea lover quietly calculate in his heart: this will last me a while.

This is the second time I have received tea by the box.

The first time was when a family member from my hometown came to visit me in America. Knowing that I enjoy tea, they made room in their suitcase and packed an entire bundle of tea leaves for me. In that moment, I deeply understood what “spiritual priorities in a suitcase” look like.

Tea is not light.

But affection weighs more.

Tea is rarely something one shows off alone. More often, it becomes a bridge between people.

Wine tends to raise voices. Coffee serves efficiency. Tea alone seems to carry a natural invitation: sit down, let us take our time.

Rinsing the cups, warming the pot, adding the leaves, pouring the water. None of these steps should be rushed. If you hurry, the tea disappoints. If you slow down, it rewards you with sweetness.

That is why, in Chinese culture, “meeting over tea” has never meant merely drinking. It means making room for one another.

As I looked at the tins, boxes, and tea ware on the table that day, I suddenly realized that all this tea was waiting for one thing.

It was waiting for people to come.

In recent years, among Chinese Christians, tea and spiritual devotion have come together in a remarkably natural way.

This is not a thousand-year formal tradition like “Zen and tea as one.” It is more like a contemporary, lived expression of faith: using the rhythm of tea to help people draw near to God.

It is not that we pour faith into tea. It is that tea helps us slow down, so the heart can catch up with the soul.

Tea is especially suited for devotion for several reasons.

First, tea teaches waiting.

We wait for the water temperature, wait for the leaves to unfold, and wait for the flavor to appear. This is very close to the discipline of waiting on God, becoming quiet before the Lord, and meditating on Scripture.

Second, tea engages the senses.

The eyes see the color of the tea. The nose receives the fragrance. The tongue tastes bitterness and sweetness. The hands feel the warmth of the cup. And at last, the heart is no longer scattered.

Many people's faith remains trapped in the mind. Tea gently brings the whole person back into participation.

Third, tea understands sweetness after bitterness.

Good tea often begins with bitterness and then returns with sweetness, a sweetness that lingers. This naturally reminds us that suffering is not always the end of the story. After the cross comes resurrection.

Fourth, tea is essentially shared.

The host takes one more step so the guest can worry one step less. This quietly echoes the spirit of serving one another.

And then there is the fragrance that spreads outward, reminding us that we are called to be the aroma of Christ.

In Chinese-speaking churches today, tea is no longer merely cultural decoration. It can become a real vessel for spiritual attention.

Some use a gospel tea ceremony, connecting steps such as cleansing, openness, and surrender with repentance, vulnerability, and trust.

Some gather around a tea table for fellowship. A few people sit together, not rushing to speak. They brew tea, read Scripture, and only then begin to share. Often, there are fewer words, but more truth.

Others begin the morning with a pot of tea and a passage of Scripture. In solitude, tea helps the heart return to stillness.

Tea leaves unfold in water, as lives unfold in grace.

Water that is too hot damages the leaves, just as rushed spiritual practice can wound the soul.

The leaves remain behind, yet they have completed the cup. The body may age, but the spirit can still be renewed.

That evening, I brewed the newly received tea.

I did not rush to judge its price or study its origin and year. I simply handed cups to my family and said, "Come, have some tea."

We sat down.

The conversation was not grand, but it was real.

And I suddenly understood: to meet over tea is not ultimately to understand tea. It is to learn how to meet people. It is to slowly learn how to be present with one another, and with God.

# 10. 我书房的角角落落 The Corners of My Study

## 一个房间里有没有平安，比摆了些什么更重要

春天快过去了。

印第安纳波利斯的春天有时像“假春”，来得迟，走得快。风从带着凉意，慢慢变成有点温热。窗外的树叶越来越浓，阳光照进来的时间也越来越长。

人有时候不是先从天气感受到季节变化，而是从一些很小的细节开始察觉。

比如，书房的角落。

前几天，我忽然发现，我的书房有了一点早夏的味道。

原本这里只是摆着书、电脑、讲章、论文、圣经，还有那些永远写不完的笔记。但最近，不知道从什么时候开始，角落里慢慢多了花，多了绿色，也多了生活本身。

那一束粉红色的小玫瑰，安静地插在花瓶里。

它不像花店里那种隆重的玫瑰，不张扬，也不夸耀，只是在窗边静静开着。有的已经盛开，有的还含着花苞，像人生不同阶段的人。

有的人已经历经风雨，有的人还在等待绽放。

花旁边，是我那一排毛笔。

忽然发现，它们和花放在一起，竟然很像人生。

一边是文字，一边是生命。

一边是理性，一边是温柔。

年轻时总觉得，书房应该像战场：书越多越好，笔记越厚越好，工作越忙越能证明自己有价值。

可是到了现在，慢慢发现，一个真正让人安静下来的空间，不只是要有知识，也需要有呼吸。

于是，角落里开始有植物了。

那盆绿色的小藤蔓，安静地从杯子里伸出来。

它没有开出什么惊艳的花，却一直在长。

有时候清晨灵修结束，看见它的新叶子，我会忽然想到：人的生命其实也是这样。

真正重要的成长，常常不是轰轰烈烈，而是慢慢地活着。



慢慢祷告。

慢慢学习。

慢慢成熟。

慢慢被神改变。

《耶利米哀歌》说：“每早晨，这都是新的；你的诚实极其广大！”（耶利米哀歌 3:23，和合本）

很多时候，生命的更新不是大张旗鼓地发生，而是在一个又一个早晨，一片新叶子，一点新光，一次安静的回转里发生。

书房另一边，那把木吉他也静静靠在墙角。

说实话，我的吉他弹得并不专业。

很多时候，和我的英语一样，都是边学边用。有时弹错，有时忘词，有时节奏也乱。

但年龄越大，反而越不怕丢人了。

因为后来发现，成长本来就是一个不太熟练的过程。

一个人如果永远等到完全准备好才开始，可能一辈子都不会开始。

所以，现在的我，很喜欢书房这种不完美却真实的状态。

有鲜花，有植物，有吉他，有讲章，有论文，有圣经。

也有一颗虽然疲惫，却仍然愿意继续学习的心。

春天快过去了。

早夏已经悄悄来了。

它不像盛夏那样炽热，也不像春天那样浪漫。早夏更像人生的某个阶段：少了一点激情，却多了一点沉静；少了一点喧闹，却多了一点真实。

有时候我坐在书房里，会忽然觉得，一个人的属灵生命也像一个房间。

年轻时，总想把房间塞满。

后来才明白，真正重要的，不是拥有多少东西，而是这个空间里有没有平安。



# The Corners of My Study

## Peace Matters More Than What Fills the Room

Spring is almost over.

In Indianapolis, spring sometimes feels like a “false spring.” It arrives late and leaves quickly. The wind slowly changes from cool to warm. The leaves outside the window grow thicker, and the sunlight stays longer in the room.

Sometimes we do not first notice the change of seasons through the weather. We notice it through small details.

For example, the corners of a study.

A few days ago, I suddenly realized that my study had begun to carry a hint of early summer.

It used to be filled mostly with books, a computer, sermons, papers, the Bible, and notes that never seem to end. But recently, without my noticing exactly when, the corners slowly gained flowers, greenery, and life itself.

A small bouquet of pink roses sits quietly in a vase.

They are not grand like roses in a flower shop. They do not announce themselves or demand attention. They simply bloom quietly near the window. Some have fully opened. Some are still in bud, like people at different stages of life.

Some have already passed through wind and rain. Some are still waiting to bloom.

Beside the flowers is a row of Chinese calligraphy brushes.

Suddenly, I felt that the brushes and the flowers together looked a little like life.

One side is words. The other is life.

One side is reason. The other is tenderness.

When I was younger, I always thought a study should feel like a battlefield: the more books, the better; the thicker the notes, the better; the busier the work, the more valuable I must be.

But now, I am slowly discovering that a space that truly quiets a person needs not only knowledge, but also breath.

So plants began to appear in the corners.

A small green vine stretches quietly from a cup.

It does not have stunning flowers, but it keeps growing.

Sometimes, after morning devotion, I see its new leaves and suddenly think that human life is like this too.

The most important growth is often not dramatic. It is simply living slowly.

Praying slowly.

Learning slowly.

Maturing slowly.

Being changed by God slowly.

Lamentations says, "They are new every morning; great is your faithfulness." (Lamentations 3:23, NIV)

Often, renewal does not arrive with noise. It comes through one morning after another, one new leaf, one bit of light, one quiet turning of the heart.

On the other side of the study, a wooden guitar leans quietly against the wall.

To be honest, I do not play the guitar professionally.

Like my English, it is something I am learning while using. Sometimes I play the wrong chord. Sometimes I forget the words. Sometimes the rhythm is uneven.

But the older I get, the less afraid I am of looking awkward.

Because I have learned that growth is always an imperfect process.

If a person waits until everything is fully ready before beginning, he may never begin at all.

So now I like the imperfect but real condition of my study.

There are flowers, plants, a guitar, sermons, papers, and the Bible.

There is also a tired heart that is still willing to keep learning.

Spring is almost over.

Early summer has quietly arrived.

It is not as burning as midsummer, nor as romantic as spring. Early summer is more like a certain stage of life: less passion, more stillness; less noise, more truth.

Sometimes when I sit in my study, I suddenly feel that a person's spiritual life is also like a room.

When we are young, we want to fill the room with as much as possible.

Later, we understand that what matters most is not how much the room contains, but whether there is peace within it.

# 11. 我们搬走了 We Moved Out

## 告别旧址的那一天

今天，我们终于把旧聚会地点的大堂和餐厅完全清空了。

桌子搬走了，椅子搬走了，钢琴搬走了，书架也搬走了。

墙还在那里，窗户还在那里，阳光依旧从熟悉的位置照进来。

只是，人要离开了。

空荡荡的大堂，忽然变得特别安静。

那种安静，不是没有声音，而是仿佛每一个角落都还留着过去十八年的回音。

这里，我们聚会了十八年。

十八年，足够让一个孩子长大成人，也足够让一群原本陌生的人，成为彼此生命中的家人。

很多人第一次来到美国时，就来到这里。

英语不会说，车不会开，生活充满陌生与不安。

但这里的一顿饭、一句问候、一次陪伴，慢慢让人感受到异乡里的温暖。

有的人在这里恋爱。

有的人在这里结婚。

有的人在这里抱着刚出生的孩子接受祝福。

也有的人在这里流过眼泪，经历过人生最低谷的时刻。

这里见证过笑声，也见证过沉默。

见证过团聚，也见证过离别。

有的人已经搬去别的州，有的人完成学业回国，有的人多年没有再见，甚至也有的人已经离开了这个世界。

可是，他们的故事，仿佛仍然留在这个空间里。

当所有东西被搬空以后，我站在空荡荡的大堂中央，忽然有一种很复杂的感受。

原来，一个地方真正宝贵的，从来不是建筑本身，而是人在这里留下的记忆。

是孩子们奔跑的脚步声。

是聚餐时厨房里的热气。

是冬天门口抖落的雪。

是主日结束后大家舍不得离开的聊天。

是诗歌响起时一起开口的声音。

这些，才是一个地方真正的灵魂。

照片里，大堂是空的，餐厅也是空的。

但我知道，它并不真正空。

因为这里装满了十八年的故事。

有时候，人总以为拥有才是永恒。

后来才慢慢发现，人生其实一直都在搬家。

我们从一个城市搬到另一个城市，从一个阶段进入另一个阶段，从年轻走向年老，从相聚走向离别。

很多东西，我们以为不会改变。

可时间还是会慢慢推动一切向前。

曾经以为这里会一直聚会下去。

可如今，我们还是要离开。

带着很多不舍，也带着很多感谢。

其实，离开一个地方最难的，不是搬东西，而是那些无法打包带走的回忆。

因为有些记忆没有重量，却最沉重。

那天打扫的时候，弟兄姐妹都特别安静。

大家一边收拾，一边这里看看、那里看看。

有人站在窗边发呆。

有人默默拍照。

有人轻轻地说：“以后可能很难再回来了。”

那一刻，我忽然明白：一个地方待久了，真的会成为生命的一部分。

甚至连空气里，都有熟悉的味道。

但人生就是这样。

有结束，才会有新的开始。

一扇门关上，也意味着另一段旅程正在展开。

所以，虽然心里有不舍，但我们没有停留在伤感里。

因为真正重要的，从来不是我们在哪里聚会，而是我们是不是仍然彼此相爱。

建筑会改变，地址会改变，环境会改变。

但爱、陪伴、信心、盼望，仍然会继续往前走。

这十八年的故事，不会因为搬离这里就结束。

它会继续活在很多人的生命里。

也许多年以后，当有人再次路过那里时，会忽然想起：

“我曾经在那里度过一段很重要的岁月。”

那就够了。

愿这个地方继续被好好使用。

愿新的故事，也能在那里展开。

因为每一个空间，都有它自己的使命。

而我们，只是曾经在那里停留过十八年的一群旅人。

我们搬走了。

但那些一起哭过、笑过、奋斗过、陪伴过的日子，不会被搬走。

它们会一直留在我们的生命里。

# We Moved Out

## Saying Goodbye to Our Former Gathering Place

Today, we finally emptied the sanctuary and fellowship hall of our former gathering place.

The tables are gone.

The chairs are gone.

The piano is gone.

The bookshelves are gone.

The walls are still standing. The windows are still there. Sunlight still enters the room from the same familiar place.

But the people are leaving.

The empty sanctuary suddenly feels incredibly quiet.

Not the kind of quiet where there is no sound, but the kind where every corner still seems to echo with memories from the past eighteen years.

We gathered here for eighteen years.

Eighteen years is long enough for a child to grow into adulthood, and long enough for strangers to become family.

Many people first came here shortly after arriving in America.

They could not speak much English. They did not know how to drive. Life felt unfamiliar and uncertain.

But through shared meals, greetings, prayers, and companionship, this place slowly became a source of warmth in a foreign land.

Some people fell in love here.

Some were married here.

Some brought newborn children here for blessing and dedication.

Others came here carrying tears, loneliness, and heavy burdens.

This place witnessed laughter, and it witnessed silence.

It witnessed reunions, and it witnessed farewells.

Some people eventually moved to other states. Some returned to China after finishing school. Some disappeared into the busyness of life.

Some have already left this world.

Yet somehow, their stories still seem to remain in these rooms.

After everything had been moved out, I stood for a moment in the empty sanctuary and felt something complicated rise within me.

What makes a place precious is never merely the building itself.

It is the memories people leave behind.

The footsteps of children running.

The warmth rising from meals shared together.

The snow shaken off at the entrance in winter.

The conversations after Sunday worship, when no one wanted to leave.

The sound of voices singing together.

That is the true soul of a place.

In the photos, the sanctuary is empty. The fellowship hall is empty too.

But I know it is not truly empty.

It is filled with eighteen years of stories.

As we move through life, we slowly discover that life itself is a constant process of moving.

We move from one city to another, from one season into another, from youth toward old age, from meeting toward parting.

We often assume certain things will never change.

But time quietly moves everything forward.

For years, we thought we might continue gathering here indefinitely.

Yet today, we had to leave.

With sadness, but also with gratitude.

The hardest part of leaving a place is never the furniture.

It is the memories that cannot be packed into boxes.

Some memories have no physical weight, yet they feel incredibly heavy.

While cleaning, everyone became unusually quiet.

People paused and looked around the rooms one last time.

Some stood silently near the windows.



Some took photos.

Some softly said, “We may never come back here again.”

In that moment, I understood that when you stay somewhere long enough, it truly becomes part of your life.

Even the air begins to feel familiar.

But life continues moving forward.

Every ending quietly prepares the way for a new beginning.

So although we carry sadness, we are not trapped by it.

What matters most is never where we gather, but whether we continue loving one another.

Buildings change. Addresses change. Circumstances change.

But love, companionship, faith, and hope continue moving forward.

These eighteen years do not end simply because we moved out.

They continue living inside many people.

Perhaps years from now, someone will pass by that place and quietly think:

“I spent an important part of my life there.”

And perhaps that is enough.

May this place continue to be used well.

May new stories begin there too.

Every place has its own purpose.

And we were simply a group of travelers who stayed there for eighteen years.

We moved out.

But the days we shared, with laughter, tears, labor, and companionship, will not be moved away.

They will remain in our lives.



# 12. 牧人夫妻退修会 A Retreat for Pastoral Couples

## 退下来，是为了重新得力

每年一次、两天一夜的牧人夫妻退修会，对我们这些在牧场上服事的人来说，不是一场普通聚会，而是一段刻意退下来的时间。

退下来，不是停止服事，而是进入更深的预备。

不是离开岗位，而是回到源头。

那天早上醒来，我们在一个简单而温暖的早餐中开始这一天。

妻子为我煮了一碗长寿面，那是家乡农历生日的传统食物。很朴素，却带着爱的温度。

在这样一个平凡的清晨，我们收拾行囊，预备出发。

车子一路向南，来到印第安纳一处安静的地方。

那里没有城市的喧嚣，只有连绵起伏的丘陵，宽广的草地，还有让人一呼吸就安静下来的空气。

那是一块绿色的土地，也是一块让心灵沉淀的地方。

白天的信息分享，晚上讲员的教导，都不像平时那样匆忙地听完就走。

在安静的氛围中，那些话一点一点进入人的里面。

妻子戴着翻译耳机，安静地听，专注地记。

我也在信息中被触动，被提醒，甚至被光照。

很多平时在忙碌中被忽略的内心状态，在这样的环境中慢慢浮现出来。

原来，我们习惯了给出去，却很少真正停下来问一问：

我里面，还剩多少？

晚上回到房间，外面很安静，人也终于安静下来。

我坐下来写下这些文字，心里有一个很清楚的感觉：

牧人的退修，是必须的。

就像汽车需要加油，机器需要保养，人的生命更需要被更新。

如果一直运转，却没有补给，再忠心的服事，也会变得干枯。

而这样的时间，正是让我们重新从上面得力，重新对焦，重新被调整的时刻。

这不是奢侈，而是必要。

牧者不是不需要被牧养的人。

服事者也不是永远不会疲惫的人。

越是长期站在人前，越需要定期退到神面前。

越是不断给出，越需要重新领受。

第二天还要继续，也许会有更多领受，更多整理。

等到返程时，我们带回去的，不只是记忆，更是里面被更新的力量。

愿我们再回到牧场的时候，不是带着疲惫，而是带着新的油、新的火，继续走那条被托付的路。

# A Retreat for Pastoral Couples

## Stepping Back in Order to Receive Strength Again

The annual two-day, one-night retreat for pastoral couples is not an ordinary gathering for those of us serving in the field of ministry.

It is an intentional time to step back.

Stepping back does not mean stopping ministry. It means entering deeper preparation.

It is not leaving the place of calling, but returning to the source.

That morning, we began the day with a simple and warm breakfast.

My wife cooked a bowl of birthday noodles for me, a tradition from my hometown for the lunar birthday. It was plain, but it carried the warmth of love.

On that ordinary morning, we packed our bags and prepared to leave.

We drove south to a quiet place in Indiana.

There was no noise of the city there, only rolling hills, open grass, and air that seemed to quiet the soul as soon as one breathed it in.

It was a green place, and also a place where the heart could settle.

The daytime sharing and the evening teaching did not feel like messages we simply heard and left behind.

In that quiet setting, the words slowly entered the heart.

My wife wore translation headphones, listening quietly and taking notes attentively.

I too was touched, reminded, and even illumined by the messages.

Many inner conditions that are easily ignored in the busyness of ordinary ministry slowly surfaced in that environment.

I realized that we have become used to giving out, but we rarely stop to ask:

how much remains within me?

At night, when we returned to the room, everything outside was quiet. At last, my own heart also became quiet.

As I sat down to write these words, one thought became clear:

pastors need retreat.

Cars need fuel. Machines need maintenance. Human lives need renewal even more.

If we keep running without being replenished, even faithful ministry can become dry.

Such a time allows us to receive strength from above again, refocus, and be adjusted.

This is not a luxury. It is a necessity.

Pastors are not people who never need to be shepherded.

Those who serve are not people who never grow tired.

The more a person stands before others, the more regularly he needs to withdraw before God.

The more a person gives, the more deeply he needs to receive.

The next day would continue, perhaps with more to receive and more to process.

When we returned home, we would bring back not only memories, but renewed strength within.

May we return to the field not merely with fatigue, but with fresh oil and fresh fire, continuing on the road entrusted to us.

# 13. 人生最大的保险在哪里？

## Where Is Life's Greatest Insurance?

### 风雨来临时，里面还有没有依靠？

有一天，忽然得知国内一位主内姐妹家中发生了火灾。

听到这个消息的时候，我心里非常沉重。

我甚至不知道该用什么话语去安慰她。

因为有些灾难，不是一句“别难过”就能抚平的。

有些眼泪，也不是几句安慰的话就能止住的。

火灾对于一个普通家庭来说，往往不仅仅是财物损失，更是一种内心深处的惊吓、无助与崩塌。

这样的事情，再次提醒我：人生真的充满太多意外与不确定。

我们永远不知道，明天会发生什么，下一刻会遇见什么。

雅各书说：“其实明天如何，你们还不知道。”（雅各书 4:14，和合本）

人常常以为，人生都在自己的掌控之中。

我们会计划明年怎样，以后怎样，退休怎样，孩子怎样。

但很多时候，一个电话，一次疾病，一场火灾，一次事故，就足以让一个家庭瞬间陷入混乱。

想到这里，我也想起去年圣诞节前后，我们家发生的一场水灾。

那天家里的水管突然爆裂，整个房子被水淹了。

地毯全湿，家具也有些受损，整个家几乎乱成一团。

那时候，心里也很烦，也很无奈。

后来保险公司介入，帮助维修与赔偿，我们也趁着这个机会，把原来的地毯换成了地板。

虽然自己额外贴了一些钱，但事情最终还是得到了处理。

回头想想，那也是一场意外。

只是我们的损失，还有保险可以承担一部分。

但现实中，很多普通人一旦遇见灾难，常常只能自己扛。

更让我感慨的是，这些年也常听见一些关于保险、金融、保障体系的负面消息。

有人买了保险，却得不到真正保障。

有人以为自己很稳妥，最后才发现并没有想象中安全。

这让我开始思想：到底什么，才是人生真正的保险？

金钱吗？

房子吗？

存款吗？

保险公司吗？

这些都重要，却都不是绝对可靠。

因为这个世界上，没有一种外在保障，能够保证人永远不生病，家庭永远不出事，人生永远不遭遇风浪。

人真正的问题，不是会不会遇见灾难。

而是当灾难真的来临时，我们里面还有没有平安。

很多时候，人最大的崩塌，不是外面的损失，而是里面失去了盼望。

所以我越来越觉得，人生最大的保险，不是财富，而是在风浪中，心里仍然有依靠。

这种依靠，最终只能来自上面。

信仰并不能保证我们不会遭遇苦难。

但信仰能让人在苦难中，不至绝望。

真正的平安，不是什么事都不发生。

而是即使事情发生了，里面仍然知道：盼望还在。

人生真的很脆弱。

我们今天拥有的一切，都可能在一瞬间改变。

所以，人真正需要预备的，不只是外在的保险，更是里面的生命。

愿我们都认真思想：

当人生风雨真正来临的时候，我里面到底靠什么站立得住？

# Where Is Life's Greatest Insurance?

## When Storms Come, What Does the Heart Lean On?

One day, I suddenly heard that a sister in Christ back in China had experienced a house fire.

When I heard the news, my heart felt very heavy.

I did not even know what words could comfort her.

Some disasters cannot be healed by simply saying, "Do not be sad."

Some tears cannot be stopped by a few words of comfort.

For an ordinary family, a fire is often not merely a loss of property. It is a deep shock, helplessness, and collapse within the heart.

Such things remind me again that life is filled with accident and uncertainty.

We never know what will happen tomorrow, or what we may face in the next moment.

James says, "Why, you do not even know what will happen tomorrow." (James 4:14, NIV)

People often assume life is under their control.

We plan next year, the future, retirement, and our children.

But many times, one phone call, one illness, one fire, or one accident is enough to throw a family into confusion.

Thinking of this, I also remembered a flood in our own home around Christmas last year.

A water pipe suddenly burst, and the house was flooded.

The carpet was soaked, some furniture was damaged, and the whole home became chaotic.

At that time, I felt frustrated and helpless.

Later, the insurance company became involved and helped with repairs and compensation. We also used the opportunity to replace the carpet with flooring.

Although we still had to pay some extra money ourselves, the matter was eventually handled.

Looking back, that too was an accident.

The difference was that part of our loss could be covered by insurance.

But in reality, many ordinary people, when disaster comes, have to carry everything themselves.

What also makes me reflect is that in recent years, we have often heard negative stories about insurance, finance, and systems of protection.



Some people bought insurance, yet did not receive real protection.

Some thought they were secure, only to discover later that things were not as safe as they imagined.

This made me think: what is the true insurance of life?

Money?

A house?

Savings?

An insurance company?

All these things matter, but none of them is absolutely reliable.

There is no external protection in this world that can guarantee we will never become sick, our families will never face trouble, or our lives will never meet storms.

The real question is not whether disaster will ever come.

The real question is whether, when disaster does come, we still have peace within.

Often, the greatest collapse is not the external loss, but the loss of hope within.

So I increasingly believe that life's greatest insurance is not wealth, but having something to lean on in the storm.

That support can ultimately come only from above.

Faith does not guarantee that we will not suffer.

But faith keeps us from despair in suffering.

True peace does not mean nothing ever happens.

It means that even when something happens, the heart still knows: hope remains.

Life is truly fragile.

Everything we have today can change in a moment.

So what we need to prepare is not only external insurance, but an inner life.

May we all ask seriously:

When the storms of life truly come, what will my heart depend on in order to stand?



# 14. 平平淡淡的日子 An Ordinary Day

## 有人记得你，就是恩典

那天早上起来，厨房已经热起来了。

锅里的油轻轻响着，鸡蛋慢慢成形，旁边的面条也在煮。那是温州人熟悉的长寿面。没有什么特别，不过是一顿很普通的早饭。

我站在厨房门口，看见妻子在忙。她回头看见我，说了一句：“生日快乐。”

我一时有点反应不过来。

不是忘了，而是这些年，我好像越来越不太把生日放在心上。

小时候，我很喜欢过生日，尤其是农历生日。家里那天也不会有多隆重，也许只是多一个鸡蛋，或者吃一碗面，但心里很开心。因为你知道，这一天有人记得你，这一天好像是属于你的。

那时候，长一岁，是一件值得高兴的事。

后来慢慢长大，生日的味道变了。

不是不感恩，也不是不想过，只是时间过得太快了。每多一岁，就更清楚地意识到：又一年过去了。

生日不再只是庆祝，也像是提醒。

它提醒你：这一年已经走完了。

所以我跟妻子说，以后生日就简单一点，不用阳历、农历都过。其实不是不在意，而是心里换了一种看法。

以前是：“我又长一岁了。”

现在更像是：“这一年，我到底怎么过的？”

如果这一年过得匆忙、混乱、疲惫，即使有蛋糕，也未必觉得特别。但如果这一年活得还算踏实，有爱人，有付出，有一点成长，有一点悔改，有一点被神扶持着继续往前走，那就已经很好了。

慢慢地，我也发现，年龄不必抓得太紧。

不是否认年岁，而是不让年岁成为压力。人越是天天计算自己几岁，越容易焦虑；反而把年龄放轻一点，日子会更自在。

重要的不是“我几岁了”，而是“我今天怎样活着”。

不过，有一点仍然很重要：有人记得你。

那天的早餐，不只是早餐。

它是妻子记得这个日子，是她愿意为我做一点什么。那份心意很简单，却很真实。

人活着，很多时候并不是靠大事撑住的，而是靠这些小小的关心继续有力气。

被记得，会让人心里暖一点。

被关心，会让人更有力量。

被爱着，人就不容易慌。

所以后来我想，问题不只是“要不要过生日”，而是人要不要活得明白一点。

记得时间在走，所以要珍惜。

不用太纠结年龄，所以可以轻松一点。

这样，人不会太紧张，也不会太麻木。

就把日子一天一天过好。

吃饭的时候好好吃，跟人说话的时候认真一点，做事情的时候踏实一点。不用想太多，也不用装什么。

就这样过。

那天的早餐很简单，却让我想了很多。

时间在走，这是真的。

但身边还有人，这也是真的。

这样，就够了。

# An Ordinary Day

## To Be Remembered Is Grace

That morning, the kitchen was already warm.

Oil was sizzling softly in the pan. Eggs were slowly taking shape, and noodles were boiling nearby. They were the familiar birthday noodles from my hometown. Nothing grand, nothing dramatic, just an ordinary breakfast.

I stood at the kitchen doorway and watched my wife busy at work. She turned, looked at me, and said, “Happy birthday.”

For a moment, I did not know how to respond.

It was not that I had forgotten. It was that, over the years, I had slowly stopped paying much attention to my birthday.

When I was young, I loved birthdays, especially the lunar one. My family did not celebrate with anything extravagant. Maybe there was one extra egg, or a bowl of noodles. But my heart was happy, because I knew someone remembered. I knew, in some small way, that day belonged to me.

Back then, growing one year older felt like something worth celebrating.

Later, the meaning of birthdays changed.

It is not that I became ungrateful. It is simply that time now feels faster. Every added year reminds me more clearly that another year has passed.

A birthday is no longer only a celebration. It is also a reminder.

It says: this year is gone.

So I told my wife that perhaps we could keep birthdays simpler in the future. We do not need to celebrate both the solar and lunar dates.

It was not because I no longer cared, but because I had begun to see the day differently.

Before, the thought was, “I am one year older.”

Now, it is more like, “How have I lived this year?”

If the year was rushed, confused, and exhausted, even a cake may not feel meaningful. But if the year was lived with some steadiness, some love, some labor, some growth, some repentance, and some quiet help from God, then that is already enough.

I have also learned not to hold age too tightly.

This does not mean denying age. It means refusing to let age become a burden. The more we count our years with anxiety, the more pressure we carry. But when we hold age lightly, life becomes freer.

The most important question is not, “How old am I?”

It is, “How am I living today?”

Still, one thing matters deeply: someone remembers you.

That breakfast was more than breakfast.

It meant my wife remembered the day. It meant she cared enough to do something small. The gesture was simple, but it was real.

Life is often sustained not by great events, but by small acts of care.

To be remembered warms the heart.

To be cared for gives strength.

To be loved steadies the soul.

So in the end, the question is not merely whether to celebrate a birthday. The deeper question is whether we are learning to live with clarity.

Remember that time is passing, so cherish it.

Do not cling too tightly to age, so live more freely.

Then life becomes simpler.

Live each day well.

Eat your meals with attention. Speak to people with sincerity. Do your work with steadiness. There is no need to overthink, and no need to pretend.

Just live.

That breakfast was simple, but it stayed with me.

Time is moving. That is true.

But someone is still beside me. That is also true.

And that is enough.

# 15. 生日与受难日 When Good Friday Falls on My Birthday

## 当十字架遇见蛋糕

那一天很特别。

那天是受难日，也是我的生日。

两个原本不相干的日子，在时间的车轮上悄然重叠。

一边是十字架，一边是生日蛋糕；一边是牺牲与流血，一边是祝福与庆贺。

清晨醒来，我还没有完全领悟这一天的意义，手机里的祝福已经陆续进来。外甥女发来红包，教会弟兄姐妹送来“生日快乐”，妻子也一早起来，为我准备好了蛋糕。

这一切都很真实，也很温暖。

但温暖之中，我心里却生出一种安静的张力：

今天，真的适合庆祝吗？

如果只是生日，我自然会接受祝福，切蛋糕，拍照留念。但这一天也是受难日。它纪念的不是成功，而是牺牲；不是荣耀，而是破碎。

当我看着那个蛋糕时，心里忽然明白：原来庆祝也需要分辨时刻。

不是所有的喜乐都要立刻表达出来。

不是所有的日子都适合高声欢笑。

有些日子，更适合安静。

所以那一天，我没有为自己庆祝。

这不是拒绝爱，而是让爱有一个更深的指向。

我做了一件很简单的事：给母亲转了一点钱。

没有隆重的仪式，也没有特别的话语。但那一刻，我心里非常清楚：如果今天是我的生日，那这一天也该让我纪念她的受难。

因为我的出生，不是从天而降，而是经过一个人的疼痛、忍耐、孤单与付出。

母亲没有在十字架上，却也承受过生产的痛苦。

她没有被钉，却把生命一点一点给了出来。

我们常常庆祝“我来到世界”，却很少记念“是谁让我来到世界”。

受难日让我看见：有一位，为我们舍命。

母亲让我想起：有一个人，为我承受生产之苦。

二者当然不同，却在爱里有一种深处的相通：都是给出，都是为别人而活。

主耶稣说：“这是我的身体，为你们舍的；你们也应当如此行，为的是记念我。”（路加福音 22:19，和合本）

母亲也许没有说过这样的话，但她用一生在表达：这是为你而活的。

十字架，是救赎的记号。

母亲，是生命的起点。

而我，在这一天，同时站在这两个爱的交汇处。

我没有拒绝祝福，也不否认生日的喜悦。但我选择不把焦点放在自己身上。

因为有一种成熟，叫作能够接受爱，却不被爱推到中心；能够被祝福，却仍然知道感恩该流向哪里。

当生日遇到受难日，人会重新思想：我是谁？

我不是一个理所当然被庆祝的中心。

我是一个被爱带到世界的人，也是一个被恩典托住的人。

生日提醒我：我被生出来。

受难日提醒我：我被救出来。

两者合在一起，才让我更完整地认识自己。

那一天，我没有热闹地庆祝生日，但我并不缺少喜乐。相反，我的喜乐更深了。

因为它不只是来自“被祝福”，更来自明白爱的来源。

有些日子，不是为了庆祝，而是为了记念。

那一天，就是其中之一。

# When Good Friday Falls on My Birthday

## When the Cross Meets a Cake

That day was unusual.

It was Good Friday. It was also my birthday.

Two dates that normally have nothing to do with one another quietly overlapped on the calendar.

On one side stood the cross. On the other, a birthday cake. On one side were sacrifice and blood. On the other were blessing and celebration.

When I woke up that morning, I had not yet fully grasped the meaning of the day, but birthday greetings had already begun to arrive. My niece sent me a red envelope. Brothers and sisters from church sent their blessings. My wife had already prepared a cake for me.

All of it was real. All of it was warm.

And yet, beneath that warmth, a quiet tension rose within me.

Was this really a day for celebration?

If it had only been my birthday, I would naturally have received the greetings, cut the cake, and taken pictures. But this was also Good Friday. It is a day that remembers not success, but sacrifice; not glory, but brokenness.

As I looked at the cake, something shifted in my heart. I realized that even celebration requires discernment.

Not every joy needs immediate expression.

Not every day is meant for loud laughter.

Some days are meant to be quiet.

So that day, I chose not to celebrate myself.

It was not a rejection of love. It was a redirection of love.

I did one simple thing: I sent some money to my mother.

There was no ceremony, no grand speech. But in that moment, I knew very clearly that if this was my birthday, it was also a day to remember her suffering.

My life did not arrive out of nowhere. It came through another person's pain, endurance, loneliness, and giving.

My mother was not on a cross, but she did pass through the pain of childbirth.

She was not nailed to wood, but she gave herself, little by little, so that I could live.

We often celebrate that we came into the world. We rarely pause to remember who bore the cost of our coming.



Good Friday shows me the One who gave His life for us.

My mother reminds me of the one who bore pain so that I could begin life.

Of course, the two are not the same. Yet in love, there is a deep connection between them: both are forms of giving; both are lives offered for another.

Jesus said, “This is my body given for you; do this in remembrance of me.” (Luke 22:19, NIV)

My mother may never have spoken those words, but in her own way, her life has said: this is for you.

The cross is the sign of redemption.

A mother is the beginning of life.

And on that day, I stood at the intersection of these two loves.

I did not reject the blessings, and I did not deny the joy of my birthday. But I chose not to put myself at the center.

There is a kind of maturity that can receive love without becoming self-centered, that can be blessed and still know where gratitude should flow.

When a birthday meets Good Friday, a person begins to ask again: Who am I?

I am not the center who deserves celebration as a matter of course.

I am someone brought into the world by love, and someone held by grace.

My birthday reminds me that I was born.

Good Friday reminds me that I was redeemed.

Together, they help me understand myself more fully.

That day, I did not celebrate my birthday loudly. But I was not without joy. In fact, my joy became deeper.

It did not come merely from being blessed. It came from understanding the source of love.

Some days are not mainly for celebration.

They are for remembrance.

That day was one of them.



# 16. 平安就是福 Peace Is a Blessing

## 最好的福，不一定是拥有很多，而是一路平安

人常说，大难不死，是福；化险为夷，是恩典；转危为安，是见证。

这当然是真的。

人在风浪过后，总会更懂得数算恩典，也更容易生出感恩。

但那天一路上的经历，却让我有了另一层体会：原来最大的福，不只是危难中蒙保守，而是平平安安地过每一天。

那天下午开车在路上，手机忽然不断响起警报，提醒附近有龙卷风风险。那声音急促刺耳，一下子把人的心提起来。

不只是手机，沿途街区的警报声也此起彼伏。空气里仿佛都带着风暴来临前的紧张。

抬头看天，乌云压得很低，像要贴近地面。风卷着树枝摇晃，天色忽然暗下来。

那一刻，人会本能地意识到：原来我们以为稳妥的日常，其实如此脆弱。

感恩的是，就在暴雨倾盆之前，我平安到达目的地。刚进屋，窗外的大雨就像倒下来一样。

坐在屋里听风雨拍窗，我心里忽然生出一句话：

平安，就是福。

回程路上，我又看见路边发生车祸，一辆车冲到了草地上。远远看见警车和救护车停在那里，心里一紧。

后来知道人都平安，没有伤亡，只是受了惊吓，我不由得松了一口气，也更觉得平安何其宝贵。

许多时候，我们把“福”想得太大。

以为事业顺利是福，收入增加是福，凡事成功是福。

这些当然可以是祝福，但福不只在那里。

一家人平平安安吃顿饭，是福。

平安出门，平安回家，是福。

身体没有病痛，心里没有惧怕，是福。

日子平淡，却有安宁，也是福。

我们常常在风浪过去之后感谢神，却很少在风平浪静的时候感谢神。

其实，没有风浪，本身就是恩典。

没有事故，本身就是保守。

没有意外，本身就是祝福。

不是等到死里逃生才算见证。许多没有发生的危险，也可能是一双看不见的手在保护。

年轻时，总觉得轰轰烈烈才叫人生。

到了中年，才慢慢懂得：没有波澜的日子，反而最珍贵。

平安不是理所当然。

平安是礼物。

平安是恩典。

平安就是福。

主耶稣说：“我留下平安给你们；我将我的平安赐给你们。”（约翰福音 14:27，和合本）

真正的福气，不只是外面的顺境，更是里面那份安稳。

那天，当风暴警报响起时，我忽然明白：每天醒来，看见阳光，听见鸟鸣，平安赶路，平安回家，这些看似寻常的小事，其实都是恩典堆积起来的幸福。

所以值得感恩的，不只是化险为夷的时候，也包括那些平平淡淡、无惊无险的日子。

因为平安无事，不是平常事。

平安度日，就是大福分。

愿我们学会，不只在危急时感恩，也在寻常中感恩；不只为脱离风暴赞美，也为没有风暴赞美。

人到后来会明白：

最好的福，不一定是拥有很多。

而是一路平安。

# Peace Is a Blessing

## The Best Blessing Is Not Always Having More, but Traveling in Peace

People often say that surviving a disaster is a blessing, that danger turning into safety is grace, and that being delivered from crisis is a testimony.

That is true.

After a storm has passed, people often count grace more carefully and give thanks more sincerely.

But what I experienced that day gave me a deeper realization: the greatest blessing is not only being preserved in danger, but being able to live each ordinary day in peace.

That afternoon, while I was driving, my phone suddenly began sounding repeated alerts about a tornado warning nearby. The sound was sharp and urgent. My heart tightened immediately.

It was not only my phone. Sirens along the streets were also sounding one after another. Even the air seemed heavy with the tension before a storm.

I looked up at the sky. The dark clouds were low, almost pressing toward the ground. The wind shook the branches, and the sky quickly dimmed.

In that moment, I realized instinctively how fragile ordinary life really is.

By grace, I arrived safely just before the heavy rain began. As soon as I entered the house, the rain outside poured down.

Sitting inside and listening to the wind and rain against the windows, one sentence rose in my heart:

Peace is a blessing.

On the way back, I saw an accident by the road. A car had gone off into the grass. From a distance, I saw police cars and an ambulance nearby, and my heart tightened again.

Later, I learned that everyone was safe. No one had been seriously hurt. They had only been frightened. I breathed a quiet sigh of relief and felt again how precious peace truly is.

So often, we imagine blessing in large terms.

We think blessing means a successful career, increased income, and everything going smoothly.

These may indeed be blessings, but blessing is not limited to them.

A family eating a meal together in peace is a blessing.

Leaving home safely and returning home safely is a blessing.

A body without pain and a heart without fear are blessings.

An ordinary day with quietness is also a blessing.

We often thank God after the storm has passed, but we rarely thank Him when no storm comes at all.

Yet the absence of storm is itself grace.

The absence of accident is itself protection.

The absence of tragedy is itself blessing.

Not every testimony requires a dramatic escape from death. Many dangers that never happened may also be evidence of an unseen hand guarding us.

When we are young, we often think life must be dramatic to be meaningful.

But in middle age, we slowly learn that uneventful days may be the most precious of all.

Peace is not automatic.

Peace is a gift.

Peace is grace.

Peace is blessing.

Jesus said, "Peace I leave with you; my peace I give you." (John 14:27, NIV)

True blessing is not only favorable circumstances around us. It is also steadiness within us.

When the storm alerts sounded that day, I suddenly understood that waking up each morning, seeing sunlight, hearing birds, traveling safely, and returning home safely are not small things. They are happiness built out of grace.

So we should give thanks not only when danger is avoided, but also for the ordinary days when nothing frightening happens.

To be safe is not a small matter.

To live a day in peace is a great blessing.

May we learn to give thanks not only in crisis, but also in ordinary life; not only for deliverance from storms, but also for days when no storm comes.

In the end, we come to understand:

The best blessing is not always having much.

It is walking the road in peace.

# 第二辑： 中年重新开始

## 17. 我不完美，但我上线了！ Am Not Perfect, But I Have Shown Up

### 成长从愿意丢脸的那一刻开始

这段时间，你可能在我的公众号、视频号里看到一些内容：有时是我用英文讲几句不太流利的话，有时是我写一篇不太成熟的小文章。

说实话，我自己也会觉得有点“拿不出手”。

甚至我能想象，有人心里会这样想：

“这样的水平，也敢发出来？”

“是不是有点太 low 了？”

是的，这些声音，我不是没听见。

我只是没有停下来。

因为我很清楚一件事：

我不是在展示成果，我是在进行过程。

我从来没有把这些分享当作“我已经会了”的证明。相反，它们更像是我正在学习的痕迹。

有一种学习方式，叫“教学相长”。

当你试图讲给别人听的时候，你才真正开始理解自己所学的内容。

所以，我不是在教你，我是在逼自己成长。

每一次开口说英文，哪怕磕磕巴巴；每一次写文章，哪怕像小学生作文，都是在对抗一个更深的东西：对失败的恐惧，对丢脸的抗拒。

这个时代很擅长制造“完美人设”。

精致的妆容，完美的灯光，剪辑过的人生，每一句话都被打磨，每一个画面都被设计。

但我越来越不想活在那样的世界里。

我更想做一件简单却不容易的事：

做一个前后一致的人。

你在视频里看到的我，和你在街上偶遇的我，应该是同一个人。

没有滤镜，没有剧本，甚至有点普通。

你可能会发现：

我的视频不够专业，我的英文不够标准，我的表达偶尔卡壳，我的文章也没有什么文学大奖的水平。

你说得都对。

但我想问一个问题：

如果一个人一定要“足够好”才可以开始，那他什么时候才能开始？

所以，我选择了一条不太体面的路：

在众人面前，一点一点学习，一步一步进步。

甚至可以说，有一点点丢人现眼。

但如果这种“丢脸”能换来一点真实的成长，我觉得很值得。

我也不想建立一个“完美牧者”的形象。

讲台上的我，和生活中的我，不应该是两个世界。

如果中间有差距，那不是我想维持的距离，而是我正在努力缩短的距离。

所以，如果你看到我的内容，觉得不够好、很普通，甚至有点尴尬，那你其实看到了一个人真实成长的样子。

也许这篇文章本身也不完美。

但它至少是真诚的。

如果它能起到一点点作用，不是让你觉得我有多厉害，而是让你明白一件事：

你不需要等到完美，才可以开始。

因为成长，从来不是在掌声中发生的。

成长，是从你愿意丢脸的那一刻开始的。

# I Am Not Perfect, But I Have Shown Up

## Growth Begins When You Are Willing to Look Awkward

Recently, you may have seen some of my posts or videos. Sometimes I speak a few sentences in English that are not very fluent. Sometimes I write a short article that still feels immature.

To be honest, even I sometimes feel that they are not very presentable.

I can even imagine someone thinking:

“With this level, he still dares to post?”

“Isn’t this a little too low?”

Yes, I hear those voices.

I simply choose not to stop.

Because I know one thing clearly:

I am not displaying a finished product. I am showing a process.

I have never treated these posts as proof that I have mastered something. On the contrary, they are traces of my learning.

There is a kind of learning that happens through teaching.

When you try to explain something to others, you begin to understand more deeply what you yourself are learning.

So I am not really teaching you. I am pushing myself to grow.

Every time I speak English, even awkwardly, and every time I write, even if it feels like a child’s essay, I am resisting something deeper: the fear of failure, and the fear of embarrassment.

This age is very good at creating perfect images.

Polished faces, perfect lighting, edited lives. Every sentence refined. Every scene designed.

But I increasingly do not want to live in that world.

I want to do something simple, but not easy:

I want to be the same person throughout.

The person you see in a video and the person you meet on the street should be the same person.

No filter. No script. Maybe even a little ordinary.

You may notice that my videos are not professional enough, my English is not standard enough, my expression sometimes gets stuck, and my writing will not win any literary awards.



You would be right.

But I want to ask one question:

If a person must be “good enough” before beginning, when will he ever begin?

So I have chosen a less glamorous road:

to learn little by little in front of others, and to improve step by step.

You could even say it is a little embarrassing.

But if that embarrassment can be exchanged for real growth, I think it is worth it.

I also do not want to build the image of a perfect pastor.

The person on the pulpit and the person in daily life should not belong to two different worlds.

If there is a gap between them, that is not a distance I want to maintain. It is a distance I am trying to close.

So if you see my content and think it is not good enough, too ordinary, or even a little awkward, then what you are actually seeing is what real growth looks like.

This article itself may not be perfect.

But at least it is sincere.

If it can serve any purpose, I hope it is not to make you think I am impressive, but to help you understand one thing:

You do not need to wait until you are perfect before you begin.

Growth does not begin in applause.

It begins the moment you are willing to look awkward.



# 18. 把童年补回来 Recovering the Childhood I Missed

## 一个中年人的重新开始

人到中年，才发现一件很真实的事：不是时间不够用，而是自己越来越不会好好活了。

小时候，我们总想着长大。

长大以后，却开始怀念小时候。

那种怀念，不只是怀念年纪小，也是在怀念一种生命状态：单纯、好奇、敢尝试、会奔跑，对世界还有新鲜感。

### 一、那些想玩却没玩的遗憾

小时候，有太多想做却没有做成的事。

想学滑板，却没有机会。

想练拳击，却觉得太遥远。

想体验科技的世界，却只能停留在想象里。

也曾想成为一个勇敢、自由、充满活力的人。

但现实常常是，我们被条件限制，被环境限制，也被“应该做什么”限制。

于是，那些小小的梦想，被放进一个叫“以后再说”的抽屉里。

可后来你会发现，“以后”其实很少真的自己到来。

如果你不去打开那个抽屉，它就一直在那里，安静地落灰。

### 二、中年的提醒：身体开始说话

到了中年，身体开始说话。

血压高了，血糖高了，胆固醇高了，精力却越来越低。

问题不只是年龄，而是生活方式。

不是因为我们老了，而是因为我们坐得太久，动得太少，也太习惯不动。

年轻时的好动，不是麻烦，是恩典。

中年以后的不动，却慢慢变成代价。

有时候，人不是突然变老，而是在很多个“算了”“改天吧”“以后再说”里面，一点一点失去了活力。

### 三、重新开始：把童年补回来

于是，有一天，你决定重新开始。

去打拳。

去运动。

去尝试新东西。

甚至买一个滑板，哪怕只是试一试。

戴上 VR，去体验一个从未进入过的世界。

这不只是玩。

这是把童年没有活出来的部分，重新活一遍。

当你开始动起来，会发现身体慢慢醒来，心也开始柔软，生活重新有了一点光。

人到中年，不一定要变年轻，但可以重新活泼。

不一定要回到过去，却可以把过去没有活出来的东西，在今天慢慢活出来。

### 四、像孩子一样

主耶稣说：

“我实在告诉你们，你们若不回转，变成小孩子的样式，断不得进天国。”（马太福音 18:3，和合本）

这句话，很多时候我们理解成单纯。

但我想，它也包含一种生命姿态：不复杂，不算计；不被未来压垮；对世界仍然有探索的热情。

小孩子会问，会跑，会试，会跌倒，也会很快站起来。

而我们的问题常常是：想太多，忧虑太多，行动太少。

中年人最需要补回来的，也许不只是童年的玩法，而是童年的勇气。

那种愿意开始、愿意尝试、愿意承认自己还不会的勇气。

### 五、真正的活在当下

活在当下，不是一句口号，而是一种具体选择。

今天动一动。

今天去尝试。

今天去做一件小时候想做却没有做的事。

当你开始行动，生命就开始流动。

很多时候，人不是没有盼望，而是太久没有让身体和心一起醒过来。

六、写给中年的自己

你不需要变年轻。

你只需要重新活过一次。

不是回到过去，而是把过去没活出来的，现在活出来。

中年人的愿望可以很简单：把童年没玩过、想玩过的，慢慢试一遍。

但其实，这不只是玩。

这是让生命重新有温度。

如果要给自己一句最实际的提醒，我想说：

不要等有时间才开始。

很多时候，是你开始了，时间才会被重新打开。

今天，就动起来。

哪怕只是第一步。

# Recovering the Childhood I Missed

## A Middle-Aged Man Begins Again

When a person reaches middle age, he begins to realize something very real: the problem is not always that there is not enough time. Sometimes the problem is that we have forgotten how to live.

When we were children, we always wanted to grow up.

After growing up, we began to miss childhood.

That longing is not only a longing for being young. It is a longing for a certain condition of life: simplicity, curiosity, courage to try, freedom to move, and a fresh sense of wonder toward the world.

### 1. The Regret of Things Never Tried

When I was young, there were many things I wanted to do but never had the chance to do.

I wanted to learn skateboarding, but there was no opportunity.

I wanted to practice boxing, but it felt too far away.

I wanted to experience the world of technology, but it remained only imagination.

I also wanted to become someone brave, free, and full of life.

But reality often limited us. Circumstances limited us. Expectations about what we “should” do also limited us.

So those small dreams were placed into a drawer called “someday.”

But later, you discover that “someday” rarely arrives on its own.

If you never open that drawer, it simply remains there, quietly gathering dust.

### 2. The Reminder of Middle Age: The Body Begins to Speak

In middle age, the body begins to speak.

Blood pressure rises. Blood sugar rises. Cholesterol rises. Energy, however, begins to decline.

The issue is not only age. It is a way of life.

It is not simply that we have grown older. It is that we have sat too long, moved too little, and become too accustomed to not moving.

The restlessness of youth was not a burden. It was grace.

The stillness of middle age, when it becomes immobility, slowly becomes a cost.

Sometimes a person does not grow old all at once. He loses vitality little by little through many small sentences: “Forget it.” “Another day.” “Maybe later.”

### 3. Beginning Again: Recovering What Childhood Left Unlived

Then one day, you decide to begin again.

You go boxing.

You exercise.

You try something new.

You even buy a skateboard, if only to try.

You put on a VR headset and enter a world you have never experienced before.

This is not merely play.

It is living again the part of childhood that was never fully lived.

When you begin to move, your body slowly wakes up. Your heart softens. Life begins to regain a little light.

Middle age does not require us to become young again. But we can become alive again.

We do not need to return to the past. We can bring into the present what the past never had the chance to live.

### 4. Becoming Like a Child

Jesus said:

“Truly I tell you, unless you change and become like little children, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven.” (Matthew 18:3, NIV)

Often, we understand this as simplicity.

But I believe it also includes a posture of life: not overly complicated, not calculating, not crushed by the future, and still eager to explore the world.

Children ask, run, try, fall, and often get back up quickly.

Our problem is often the opposite: too much thinking, too much anxiety, too little action.

What middle-aged people may need to recover is not only childhood play, but childhood courage.

The courage to begin, to try, and to admit that we still do not know how.

### 5. Living in the Present

Living in the present is not a slogan. It is a concrete choice.

Move today.

Try today.

Do one thing today that you wanted to do as a child but never did.

When you begin to act, life begins to flow.

Often, people have not lost hope. They have simply gone too long without letting the body and heart wake up together.

## 6. To My Middle-Aged Self

You do not need to become young again.

You simply need to live again.

Not by returning to the past, but by living now what the past left unlived.

A middle-aged person's desire can be very simple: slowly try the things childhood wanted but never had.

But in truth, this is not merely play.

It is letting life become warm again.

If I were to give myself one practical reminder, I would say:

Do not wait until you have time to begin.

Often, when you begin, time itself begins to open.

Start today.

Even if it is only the first step.

# 19. 为了一篇作业 For One Assignment

**有时候，你不是在完成一件事，而是在完成你自己**

夜已经很深了。

房间里只剩下一盏台灯，电脑屏幕的光有些刺眼。我一边翻书，一边对着屏幕发呆。

英文句子来来回回地读，读懂了，又好像没有完全懂。写了一段，又删掉；查资料，整理，修改，再重写。

时间一点一点过去。抬头一看，已经十二点多了。

再写一会儿吧。

不知不觉，又到了一点。

这一篇作业，看起来不过几页纸，却像一座山。

对别人来说，也许只是写一篇论文；但对我来说，却是一场翻山的过程。

因为我的英语并不好，每一句英文背后，都是先在脑海里用中文想清楚，再一字一句翻译出来。写作不只是表达，更像是在两种语言之间来回搬运思想。

有时候，我会停下来，心里冒出一个声音：

算了吧。

博士不博士的，又有什么重要呢？

已经这个年纪了，何必要这么辛苦？

别人休息的时候，我在读书；别人轻松的时候，我在熬夜。为了一篇作业，连着几天都到深夜。

真的值得吗？

可是，过一会儿，另一个声音又慢慢浮上来：

可是，这不是你一直想要的吗？

是啊。

不是别人逼我读的，是我自己走上这条路的。

不是为了一个头衔，而是因为心里一直有一个愿望：想更深地学习，想更扎实地装备，想让自己的生命和服事更有根基。

再想一想，再过两年，就完成了。

这条路不是没有尽头的。

这份坚持，也不是没有意义的。

有时候，我会想起童年的自己。



那个时候，有很多很多愿望。想成为一个有用的人，想读很多书，想去很多地方，想活出一个不一样的人生。

那时候的梦想很简单，却很纯粹。

只是后来，人在成长的路上，走着走着，就偏了。

有些梦想，被现实冲淡了。

有些愿望，被忙碌淹没了。

有些方向，甚至走到了完全相反的地方。

等到人到中年，再回头看，才发现很多当初看似重要的事情，已经不再重要；而那些曾经被忽略的梦想，反而在心里慢慢发酵。

如果人生是一整天，童年大概是早上七八点，中年已经是下午两三点。

太阳不再初升，但也还没有落下。

这个时候，你会忽然明白一件事：

还来得及。

还来得及把那些早晨的梦想，一点一点拾起来。

所以，那一篇作业，不再只是作业。

它像一块小小的拼图，拼在我人生这幅图画里。

每一个深夜的坚持，每一页反复修改的文字，每一次“写不下去却还是继续写”的挣扎，都在悄悄告诉我：你还在往前走。

也许走得慢，也许走得累，也许走得并不优雅。

但你没有停。

有时候，完成一件事情，并不是为了别人。

不是为了成绩，不是为了评价，也不是为了别人眼中的成功。

而是为了一个更深的原因：

为了不辜负自己心里那个声音。

那个声音，从童年开始，一直没有完全消失。

它会在你疲惫的时候提醒你，在你想放弃的时候拉你一把，在你快要妥协的时候轻轻问一句：

你真的要这样就结束了吗？

那一夜，我还是写完了那一段。

不是因为我突然变得更厉害了，而是因为我不想轻易放弃。

第一年的博士课程快要结束了，只剩下一篇作业。

看起来不多，但走到这里，其实已经不容易。

也许人生就是这样。

不是每一步都光鲜亮丽，不是每一段都充满激情。



很多时候，只是一个普通的夜晚，一盏灯，一台电脑，一个人，在默默完成一件对自己很重要的事。

如果你也正在坚持一件事，很累，很苦，甚至有点想放弃，我想轻轻对你说一句：

再坚持一下。

也许你不是在完成一件事情。

你是在完成你自己。

# For One Assignment

## Sometimes You Are Not Finishing a Task, but Becoming Yourself

It was already very late.

Only one desk lamp remained on in the room, and the light from the computer screen felt a little harsh. I flipped through books and stared at the screen.

I read English sentences again and again. I understood them, and yet not completely. I wrote a paragraph, then deleted it. I searched for materials, organized my thoughts, revised, and rewrote.

Time passed little by little. When I looked up, it was already past midnight.

Just a little longer, I told myself.

Before I realized it, it was one o'clock.

That assignment was only a few pages, but it felt like a mountain.

For someone else, it may have been just another paper. For me, it was a mountain-crossing journey.

My English is not strong. Behind every English sentence, I first have to clarify the thought in Chinese, then slowly carry it across into another language. Writing is not only expression. It feels like transporting thought back and forth between two worlds.

Sometimes I stop, and a voice rises in my heart:

Forget it.

What does a doctorate really matter?

At this age, why make life so hard?

When others rest, I study. When others relax, I stay up late. For one assignment, I go to bed after midnight for several nights in a row.

Is it really worth it?

But after a while, another voice slowly rises:

But isn't this what you have always wanted?

Yes.

No one forced me onto this road. I chose it.

Not for a title, but because there has always been a desire in my heart: to learn more deeply, to be more firmly equipped, and to give my life and ministry deeper roots.

Then I think again: in two more years, this journey will be complete.

This road does have an end.

This perseverance is not meaningless.

Sometimes I think of my childhood self.

Back then, I had many dreams. I wanted to become a useful person, read many books, go to many places, and live a different kind of life.

Those dreams were simple, but pure.

But later, as we grow, we drift.

Some dreams are diluted by reality.

Some desires are buried under busyness.

Some directions even move toward the opposite of what we once hoped for.

Only when a person reaches middle age and looks back does he realize that many things once considered important no longer feel so important, while some neglected dreams have quietly been fermenting in the heart.

If life were a whole day, childhood would be around seven or eight in the morning. Middle age is already two or three in the afternoon.

The sun is no longer rising, but it has not yet set.

At this point, you suddenly understand one thing:

There is still time.

There is still time to pick up those morning dreams, little by little.

So that assignment was no longer merely an assignment.

It became a small piece of a larger picture.

Every late-night effort, every page revised again and again, every struggle to continue when I felt I could not write anymore quietly told me:

You are still moving forward.

Maybe slowly. Maybe tiredly. Maybe not very gracefully.

But you have not stopped.

Sometimes we complete something not for other people.

Not for grades, not for evaluation, not for the success others see.

We do it for a deeper reason:

so we do not betray the voice within us.

That voice has been there since childhood and has never fully disappeared.

It reminds you when you are tired, pulls you back when you want to give up, and quietly asks when you are about to compromise:

Do you really want it to end here?

That night, I finished that paragraph after all.

Not because I suddenly became more capable, but because I did not want to give up too easily.

My first year of doctoral study was nearly finished. Only one assignment remained.

It did not look like much, but reaching that point had not been easy.

Perhaps life is like this.

Not every step is glorious. Not every season is full of passion.

Often, it is simply an ordinary night, a lamp, a computer, and one person quietly finishing something that matters deeply to him.

If you are also holding on to something right now, and it feels tiring, painful, or even tempting to quit, I want to say gently:

Hold on a little longer.

Perhaps you are not merely finishing a task.

You are becoming yourself.

# 20. 生活继续、学习不停 Life Goes On, and Learning Continues

## 一天两千字，也能慢慢走向远方

春天好像还没有真正停留多久，转眼之间，这个春季学期就在五月八日结束了。

说实话，这几个月并不轻松。

课程、论文、讲道、聚会、教会搬迁准备、探访、锻炼、写作、开车往返，很多事情交织在一起。

白天已经很忙，晚上回到书房，还要继续打开电脑，看资料，读文献，改论文。

有时写到深夜，脑子已经疲惫，眼睛也开始发酸。

甚至会忽然冒出一个念头：

为什么还要这么辛苦？

可是安静下来，再回头看看，又会发现：原来自己并没有停下来。

原来神一直在推着我，慢慢往前走。

更有意思的是，春季学期刚刚结束，新的夏季课程很快又要开始。

这两天，我已经收到新课程老师的来信。

课程是《属灵塑造与生命丰盛的实践》。

教授在信中很温和地提醒我们：课程虽然还没有正式开始，但希望大家已经开始准备教材，阅读课程大纲，预备进入新的学习旅程。

看到那封邮件的时候，我忍不住笑了一下。

我才刚刚喘一口气，新的学习已经在门口等着了。

可是不知道为什么，如今的我，竟越来越喜欢这种充实。

因为我慢慢发现：忙碌不一定是重担。

有时候，它反而是一种恩典。

它证明你还在学习，还在成长，还在被塑造，还没有停止前进。

尤其到了这个年龄，我越来越明白：人最怕的，不是慢一点，而是彻底停下来。

有时候，我会坐在书房里，安静地想一件事：

如果每天坚持写一点点，一年以后会怎么样？

不用很多。

哪怕一天只写两千字。

两千字，看起来并不起眼。

可如果一年坚持下来，就会是七十多万字。

想到这里，我忽然觉得，博士论文并不是遥不可及的高山。

它更像一条路。

你每天走一点，总会慢慢靠近。

如今，我的博士论文第一章已经初步完成。

虽然前面还有很长的路：文献综述、神学整合、结构修改，还有许多可能需要推翻重来的地方。

但至少，已经开始了。

而“开始”本身，就是一种光。

这些日子，我越来越发现，人生很多重要的事情，并不是靠一时热血完成的。

真正改变人的，往往是那些看起来很普通的坚持。

有人羡慕别人的成果，却没有看见别人深夜里的孤独。

有人只看见台上的荣耀，却不知道台下多少年的积累。

而论文写作，是最诚实的一件事。

你今天有没有写，电脑知道。

你有没有认真思考，文字知道。

你有没有坚持，时间知道。

博士论文不像讲道，不能完全依靠激情与临场发挥。

它更像一场漫长的耕种。

今天埋一点，明天写一点，后天改一点。

有时，写了几千字，最后全部删掉。

有时，一句话改了十几遍，还是不满意。

有时，明明已经很累，却还想再读一篇文献。

也正是在这样的过程里，人被慢慢塑造。

不仅论文被写出来，连自己也被重新雕刻。

而最奇妙的是，我发现神很多时候并不会一下子把整条路照亮。

祂通常只是给你今天的灯。

够你走今天这一段。

于是，你继续学习，继续祷告，继续写作，继续坚持。

然后有一天，当你再回头，会忽然发现：

那些深夜里的孤独，那些疲惫中的坚持，那些看起来微不足道的“两千字”，都已经慢慢变成生命里的光。

这光，不是突然降下来的。

它是在一个又一个平凡的日子里，一点一点被坚持点亮的。

**Life Goes On, and Learning Continues**  
**Even Two Thousand Words a Day Can Carry You Far**



Spring did not seem to stay for very long. Before I realized it, the spring semester ended on May 8.

To be honest, these past months were not easy.

Courses, papers, sermons, gatherings, preparations for the church move, visits, exercise, writing, and driving back and forth all overlapped.

The days were already full. Yet when I returned to my study at night, I still had to open the computer, read materials, review literature, and revise papers.

Sometimes I wrote late into the night. My mind was tired, and my eyes began to ache.

At times, one question suddenly rose in my heart:

Why am I still working so hard?

But when I became quiet and looked back, I realized that I had not stopped.

God had been gently pushing me forward, little by little.

What is even more interesting is that the spring semester had just ended, and the summer course was already waiting at the door.

In the past few days, I received an email from the professor of the next course.

The course is about spiritual formation and the practice of flourishing.

The professor kindly reminded us that although the course had not officially begun, we should already start preparing the readings, reviewing the syllabus, and getting ready for the next learning journey.

When I saw the email, I could not help smiling.

I had only just taken a breath, and a new season of study was already waiting.

Yet somehow, I have begun to enjoy this kind of fullness.

Because I am slowly discovering that busyness is not always a burden.

Sometimes it is grace.

It proves that you are still learning, still growing, still being shaped, and have not stopped moving forward.

Especially at this stage of life, I increasingly understand that the most frightening thing is not moving slowly. It is stopping completely.

Sometimes I sit quietly in my study and think about one thing:

What would happen if I wrote a little every day for a year?

It does not have to be much.

Even two thousand words a day.



Two thousand words do not seem impressive.

But if continued for a year, they become more than seven hundred thousand words.

When I think about this, my doctoral dissertation no longer feels like an unreachable mountain.

It feels more like a road.

If you walk a little every day, you will slowly draw nearer.

At this point, the first chapter of my dissertation has been roughly completed.

There is still a long road ahead: literature review, theological integration, structural revision, and many places that may need to be rewritten.

But at least it has begun.

And beginning itself is a kind of light.

These days, I increasingly realize that many important things in life are not completed by a moment of passion.

What truly changes a person is often ordinary perseverance.

Some people admire the results of others, but never see their loneliness late at night.

Some only see the honor on the platform, but do not know the years of hidden accumulation underneath.

Writing a dissertation is one of the most honest things.

The computer knows whether you wrote today.

The words know whether you thought carefully.

Time knows whether you persevered.

A doctoral dissertation is not like preaching. It cannot rely entirely on passion or the energy of the moment.

It is more like long cultivation.

Plant a little today. Write a little tomorrow. Revise a little the day after.

Sometimes you write thousands of words and delete them all.

Sometimes you revise one sentence more than ten times and are still not satisfied.

Sometimes you are clearly exhausted, yet still want to read one more article.

But it is precisely through this process that a person is slowly formed.

Not only is the dissertation being written; the person is being reshaped.

What is most wonderful is that I have found God often does not illuminate the whole road at once.

He usually gives the lamp for today.

Enough for this part of the journey.

So you keep learning, keep praying, keep writing, and keep persevering.

Then one day, when you look back, you suddenly discover that the loneliness of late nights, the perseverance in exhaustion, and those seemingly small “two thousand words” have slowly become light in your life.

That light did not fall suddenly from the sky.

It was lit little by little through ordinary days of perseverance.

# 21. 初次用英语向妻子试讲

## Preaching in English to My Wife for the First Time

### 讲台梦想，从家中开始

有些“第一次”，并不轰轰烈烈，却足以让人记一辈子。

这几天，我做了一件在别人看来也许很平常、但对我却很有意义的事：第一次在妻子面前，用英语完整试讲一篇讲章。

讲完以后，我心里有一种说不出的感动，仿佛岁月忽然折叠，把我带回很远很远以前。

十九岁开始出来实习讲道时，听我讲道最多的人，其实就是我的妻子。

那时我们还在谈恋爱。每次外出实习，我多半带着她。她常常坐在下面，安静地听我讲；有时回到住处，我还会重新讲给她听，请她给我反馈。

那时条件很简单，没有录像设备，没有系统的讲台训练课。我常常对着镜子练习讲道，看自己的发音、表情和手势；调整停顿，揣摩语气。

镜子是一位老师，妻子是另一位老师。

她常常给我鼓励，也给我提醒。

回头看，我许多讲台上的成长，背后都有她默默的陪伴。

如今多年过去，从中文讲道到英文讲道，仿佛又走到了一个新的起点。

这次为了博士课程的讲章，我写了英文讲章《Look! The Lamb of God》，然后第一次站在妻子面前试讲。

这不是在课堂上对教授讲，也不是在同学面前练习，而是在最熟悉、也最真实的人面前讲。

说实话，我有点紧张。

因为用母语讲道，你知道自己在说什么；但用第二语言讲道，不只是传递信息，更像是把一个还不够成熟的自己交出去。

讲完以后，我问她：

“你能听懂吗？”

她说：

“大概百分之七十到八十。”

我有点不信。

于是我让她把内容复述一遍。

没想到，她竟然能把讲章的主旨、结构和重点，大致复述出来。

那一刻，我真的很惊讶。

因为这不是敷衍，不是安慰，也不是给我面子。

她是真的听懂了。

这对我来说，是很大的鼓励。

我忽然想起自己过去一个讲道原则：真正好的讲道，不在于高深，而在于让人听得懂。

如果农村没有受过多少教育的老人能听懂，那讲道就讲明白了。

如果普通人能明白，福音就落地了。

而这次，一位仍在努力学习英语的人，能听懂七八成，并能复述出来，我心里忽然多了一份信心：

也许我的英文讲道，不只是完成作业，而是真的开始能传达信息了。

这是迈出的小小一步。

很小，却很真实。

我也忽然意识到，许多突破并不是在万人面前发生的，而是在一个人面前开始的。

不是在讲台上，而是在家里。

不是在掌声中，而是在配偶安静的反馈里。

有时候，神给人的鼓励，不是雷鸣闪电，而是借着身边最亲近的人说一句：

“我听懂了。”

这句话，比很多掌声都珍贵。

它也让我心里生出一个久远的盼望：

盼望有一天，能够站在讲台上，用英语向不同国家、不同文化的人分享福音；

能够用另一种语言，讲同一位基督；

能够让更多人听见那改变生命的信息。

这需要继续努力。

语言要操练，思想要拓展，讲台要磨炼。

但更需要从上头来的恩典。

因为每一步成长，既靠汗水，也靠祝福。

回想十九岁时，对着镜子练习讲道；到今天，对着妻子用英语试讲，我忽然明白：神带人走路，是一步一步的。

镜子前的练习，家中的试讲，也许都在预备更远的道路。

而最让我感恩的是，多年过去，听我讲道最多的人，仍然是她。

从中文到英文，从青年到中年，她依旧在听。

这本身，就是一种恩典。

也许讲台梦想，真的就是从家中开始的。

而我愿意继续走下去。

靠着努力，也靠着那从上头来的祝福。

# Preaching in English to My Wife for the First Time

## A Pulpit Dream Begins at Home

Some “first times” are not dramatic, yet they are memorable for a lifetime.

Recently, I did something that may seem ordinary to others, but was very meaningful to me: for the first time, I preached an entire sermon in English in front of my wife.

After I finished, I felt deeply moved in a way I could not quite describe. It was as if time had folded, carrying me back to a much earlier season of life.

When I began preaching as an intern at nineteen, the person who heard me preach most often was actually my wife.

At that time, we were still dating. Whenever I went out for ministry practice, I often brought her with me. She would sit quietly below and listen. Sometimes, after we returned, I would preach the message again to her and ask for feedback.

Those were simple days. There was no recording equipment and no formal preaching lab. I often practiced in front of a mirror, watching my pronunciation, facial expressions, and gestures, adjusting pauses and tone.

The mirror was one teacher. My wife was another.

She often encouraged me, and she also reminded me.

Looking back, much of my growth in preaching was quietly accompanied by her presence.

Years have passed. Moving from preaching in Chinese to preaching in English feels like arriving at another beginning.

For a doctoral course, I wrote an English sermon titled “Look! The Lamb of God,” and then stood before my wife to preach it for the first time.

This was not preaching to a professor in class, nor practicing in front of classmates. It was preaching before the person who knows me best and sees me most truly.

To be honest, I was nervous.

When you preach in your mother tongue, you know what you are saying. But when you preach in a second language, you are not merely delivering information. You are handing over a version of yourself that is still unfinished.

After I finished, I asked her:

“Could you understand it?”

She said:

“About seventy to eighty percent.”

I was not sure I believed her.

So I asked her to summarize the content.

To my surprise, she was able to restate the main idea, structure, and key points of the sermon.

In that moment, I was truly surprised.

It was not politeness. It was not comfort. It was not giving me face.

She had really understood.

That encouraged me deeply.

I suddenly remembered one of my long-held preaching principles: good preaching is not measured by how profound it sounds, but by whether people can understand it.

If an elderly person in a rural village with little formal education can understand it, then the sermon has been made clear.

If ordinary people can understand, then the Gospel has landed.

This time, someone still learning English could understand seventy to eighty percent and summarize the message. That gave me a new confidence:

perhaps my English preaching is no longer merely completing an assignment. Perhaps it is beginning to communicate a message.

It was a small step.

Very small, but very real.

I also realized that many breakthroughs do not begin before thousands of people. They begin before one person.

Not on a public platform, but at home.

Not in applause, but in the quiet feedback of a spouse.

Sometimes God's encouragement does not come like thunder. It comes through the closest person beside you saying:

"I understood."

That sentence is more precious than much applause.

It also awakened an old hope in my heart:

that one day I may stand on a pulpit and share the Gospel in English with people from different countries and cultures;

that I may speak of the same Christ in another language;

that more people may hear the message that transforms life.

This will require continued effort.



Language must be practiced. Thought must be expanded. Preaching must be refined.

But more than anything, it requires grace from above.

Every step of growth depends both on labor and on blessing.

When I think back to practicing sermons in front of a mirror at nineteen, and then to preaching in English to my wife today, I understand something more clearly: God leads people one step at a time.

Practice before a mirror and preaching at home may both be preparing a road farther ahead.

What I am most grateful for is this: after so many years, the person who has heard me preach the most is still her.

From Chinese to English, from youth to middle age, she is still listening.

That itself is grace.

Perhaps the dream of the pulpit truly begins at home.

And I am willing to keep walking.

By effort, and by the blessing that comes from above.



# 22. 我的讲道集 My Sermon Collection

## 在旷野中寻找活水泉源

夜深的时候，我常常一个人坐在电脑前，重新整理这些年留下来的讲章。

屏幕上的文件夹一层又一层。有些标题已经泛黄，有些日期甚至连自己都快忘记。偶尔打开一篇旧讲章，看到当年的文字、结构、标注和修改痕迹，仿佛一下子回到那些已经远去的岁月。

有时候，一篇讲章后面，是一段忙碌而紧张的服事。

有时候，一篇讲章后面，是一段低谷、等待与挣扎。

还有一些讲章，是在深夜灯光下，一边祷告，一边流泪写成的。

这些文字，对别人而言也许只是讲章；但对我来说，它们更像是人生道路上的脚印。

### 一、从手写笔记开始的岁月

最早的时候，我并不会使用电脑整理资料。

那个年代，也不像今天这样方便，可以随时把文件存到云端、手机、平板或硬盘里。

我所有的讲章，几乎都是手写的。

一本又一本笔记本，密密麻麻地记录着自己的思考、经文、灵修和讲道提纲。有时候是一边翻圣经，一边查资料；有时候是一边默想，一边在纸上反复修改。

纸张被翻得起皱，边角卷起来，钢笔墨水渗到纸背后。

但对我来说，那些笔记本像一圈一圈的年轮，记录着一个年轻传道人怎样在摸索中学习服事。

2001年，我从上海华东神学院毕业。同年8月8日，我正式进入教会，开始专职牧会。

刚进入服事的时候，我才真正发现：原来讲道并不是一件轻松的事。

在神学院里，虽然也学习释经、预备信息，也曾实习讲道，但真正进入教会以后，才知道现实与课堂完全不同。

主日讲道、周间查经、青年聚会、节期信息、探访分享，一周接着一周，一场接着一场。

那时候最大的压力，不是“讲”，而是“预备”。

因为你会忽然发现：自己里面储备得太少，而需要输出的却太多。

那几年，我常常有一种被石头压住胸口的感觉。尤其每到周末，压力会特别明显。

甚至，我常常做同一个梦。

梦里，我已经站在讲台上，下面坐满了人。轮到我分享的时候，我忽然发现自己没有带讲章。

于是开始慌乱地翻找。桌子上找，包里找，圣经里找，到处都找不到。

越找越紧张，越紧张越醒不过来。

这个梦，持续了很多年。

## 二、母亲给我的那个答案

有一天，我回母亲家吃饭。

吃饭的时候，我终于忍不住对母亲说：

“这条路太难了。单单预备讲章，就已经让我喘不过气来。”

然后，我把自己反复做的那个梦告诉了她。

母亲听完以后，并没有立刻安慰我。她只是很安静地说了一段话。

她说：

“你现在，就像旷野里的夏甲。她身边只有一皮袋水，而那袋水很快就会喝完。所以她害怕、着急、哭泣，因为她不知道接下来怎么办。

但后来，神使她的眼睛明亮，她就看见了一口水井。

当她找到水源以后，她就不再只依靠那一皮袋有限的水。”

母亲看着我说：

“你今天也是一样。不要只看自己手里还有多少水。你要学习仰望，求神赐给你一双明亮的眼睛，去发现那个活水的泉源。”

直到今天，我依然记得那天的场景。

那顿饭很普通；那句话却改变了我后来的许多年。

因为我忽然明白：真正的讲道，不是靠人的库存，而是不断回到泉源。

讲道人若只依靠自己，迟早会枯干；但若不断回到那活水之源，就总会重新得力。

《创世记》说：“神使夏甲的眼睛明亮，她就看见一口水井，便去将皮袋盛满了水，给童子喝。”（创世记 21:19，和合本）

从那以后，我那个重复多年的噩梦，慢慢消失了。

不是因为我忽然变得很会讲道，而是因为我开始知道：我不是泉源，我只是一个打水的人。

## 三、那些没有保存下来的岁月

后来，时代慢慢变化。

我开始有了电脑，也开始学习用电子设备整理资料。再后来，又有了 iPad、云端和硬盘。

但很长一段时间里，我依然不习惯完全电子化。

很多重要内容，仍然习惯写在纸上。因为我总觉得，手写的时候，思想会更慢，心也更安静。

后来因为环境变化与人生转折，许多过去的资料，并没有完整保留下来。

有些笔记本遗失了；有些旧讲章没有带出来；还有一些资料，因为年代久远，再也找不到。

每次想到这些，我都会有一点遗憾。

因为那些文字，不只是资料，更是一段生命。

它们记录过年轻时的热情，也记录过压力中的挣扎；记录过初入服事时的笨拙，也记录过后来逐渐成熟的脚步。

来到美国以后，我开始重新整理自己的讲章。

有一天，我打开电脑里的文件夹，又翻出云端和硬盘中的资料，忽然发现：这些年，竟然已经积累了三百多篇讲章。

那一刻，我自己也有些惊讶。

原来，岁月真的会留下痕迹。

四、整理讲道集，其实是在整理人生

这一次整理第一卷，我收录了五十篇讲章。

有关于十字架的，有关于恩典的，有关于苦难与盼望的，也有关于教会、敬拜、家庭与使命的。

当我重新阅读这些讲章时，我发现：许多讲章，其实已经不仅仅是在讲给别人听。

很多时候，那些信息，首先是讲给我自己听的。

有些讲章，是在压力中写的；有些讲章，是在等待中写的；还有一些，是在人生低谷中写成的。

有时候，一边预备，一边流泪；有时候，一边讲，一边被提醒。

我越来越觉得：讲道并不只是“说话”，而是一个人生命真实的流露。

一个没有经历过安慰的人，很难讲出真正安慰人的信息；一个没有流过泪的人，也很难真正理解受伤的人。

所以后来我慢慢发现：最重要的，不是讲章有多华丽，而是里面有没有真实。

五、我始终带着的一份惭愧

整理这些讲章的时候，我心里也一直带着一种惭愧。

很多年以前，我们预备讲章时，常常会参考许多前辈牧者、神学家和属灵作者的信息。有些内容受到他们很深的影响；有些结构、例证和思想，也建立在前人的基础上。

但过去并不像今天这样重视规范引用。很多时候，参考了资料，却没有完整注明出处。

因此，这些讲章虽然整理成册，但我始终更愿意把它们当作个人性的整理与保存。

它们不是为了证明什么，也不是为了展示什么。

它们只是记录：一个普通讲道人，在漫长岁月里的学习、挣扎、成长与恩典。

六、讲章会过去，但话语仍然长存

这些年，我越来越感受到：

人的声音会过去。

人的名字也会慢慢被遗忘。

但真正能留下来的，永远不是某一个讲道人，而是那能够安慰人、照亮人、更新人的真理。

有时候，一篇讲章讲完以后，听的人也许很快忘记讲员是谁。

但如果其中有一句话，能够在人低谷的时候带来力量；能够在黑夜里带来一点光；能够让一个疲惫的人重新得着盼望，那就已经足够了。

所以今天，当我重新整理这些讲章的时候，心里最大的感受不是骄傲，而是感恩。

感恩一路上的保守。

感恩许多人的陪伴。

感恩那些低谷没有把我压垮。

也感恩那一口从未干涸的活水泉源。

七、写在最后

也许未来，我还会继续整理第二卷、第三卷。

有些讲章已经很旧；有些文字甚至显得稚嫩。

但我舍不得删除。

因为那里面，有一个年轻传道人最真实的样子。

如今再回头看，我越来越明白：真正支撑一个讲道人走下去的，不是口才，不是知识，甚至也不只是经验。

而是在许多个孤单、疲惫与压力的夜晚，仍然愿意重新回到泉源旁边。

我也终于明白母亲当年那句话：

一皮袋水，总会用完；但泉源不会。

愿未来的日子里，我依然能够保持一颗安静、敬畏而谦卑的心，继续学习，继续分享，继续在岁月中寻找那不停止流动的活水。

也愿这些讲章，不仅仅停留在纸张与文件夹里，更能够成为一些人生命旅程中的陪伴与安慰。

愿一切荣耀，都归于那位赐下活水泉源的主。

# My Sermon Collection

## Finding the Spring of Living Water in the Wilderness

Late at night, I often sit alone in front of my computer, organizing the sermons I have written over the years.

Folder after folder appears on the screen. Some titles feel old and distant. Some dates are nearly forgotten even by me. When I open an old sermon and see the words, structure, markings, and revisions from those days, I feel as if I have been carried back into years long past.

Sometimes behind a sermon was a busy and demanding season of ministry.

Sometimes behind a sermon was a season of lowliness, waiting, and struggle.

Some sermons were written late at night, under the light of a desk lamp, with prayer and tears.

To others, these may simply be sermons. To me, they are footprints along the road of my life.

### 1. The Years of Handwritten Notes

In the beginning, I did not know how to organize materials on a computer.

Those years were not like today. We could not easily store documents in the cloud, on phones, tablets, or hard drives.

Almost all of my sermons were handwritten.

Notebook after notebook was filled with reflections, Scripture notes, devotional thoughts, and sermon outlines. Sometimes I wrote while turning the pages of the Bible and searching through materials. Sometimes I wrote while meditating quietly, revising the same lines again and again on paper.

The pages became worn. The corners curled. Ink seeped through to the back of the paper.

But to me, those notebooks were like rings of a tree, recording how a young preacher slowly learned to serve.

In 2001, I graduated from East China Theological Seminary in Shanghai. On August 8 of the same year, I entered full-time pastoral ministry.

When I first entered ministry, I quickly discovered that preaching was not easy.

In seminary, we had studied biblical interpretation, prepared messages, and practiced preaching. But after entering the life of the church, I learned that reality was very different from the classroom.

Sunday sermons, weekday Bible studies, youth meetings, seasonal messages, pastoral visits, and fellowship sharing came one after another, week after week.

The greatest pressure was not speaking.

The greatest pressure was preparation.

I suddenly realized that what I carried inside felt too small, while the needs around me were too many.

During those years, I often felt as if a stone were pressing on my chest. The pressure became especially strong before weekends.

I even had the same dream again and again.

In the dream, I was already standing at the pulpit, facing a full congregation. When it was time for me to preach, I suddenly realized that I had forgotten my sermon notes.

Then I began searching in panic. I looked on the table, in my bag, inside my Bible, everywhere. But I could not find them.

The more I searched, the more anxious I became.

That dream followed me for many years.

## 2. The Answer My Mother Gave Me

One day, I went to my mother's home for dinner.

During the meal, I finally told her how overwhelmed I felt.

"This road is too hard," I said. "Preparing sermons alone already makes me feel as if I can hardly breathe."

Then I told her about the repeated dream.

After listening, my mother did not rush to comfort me. She simply spoke quietly.

She said:

"You are like Hagar in the wilderness. She had only one skin of water, and that water would soon run out. So she became afraid, anxious, and full of tears, because she did not know what would happen next.

But later, God opened her eyes, and she saw a well of water.

Once she found the source, she no longer depended only on that one limited skin of water."

Then my mother looked at me and said:

"You are the same today. Do not only look at how much water remains in your hands. Learn to look upward, and ask God to give you clear eyes to discover the spring of living water."

I still remember that scene.

The meal was ordinary. But those words changed many of the years that followed.

I suddenly understood that true preaching does not come from a person's stored supply. It comes from continually returning to the source.



If a preacher depends only on himself, he will eventually run dry. But if he keeps returning to the spring of living water, he will receive strength again and again.

Genesis says, “Then God opened her eyes and she saw a well of water.” (Genesis 21:19, NIV)

After that, the nightmare that had repeated for years slowly disappeared.

Not because I suddenly became a gifted preacher, but because I began to understand:

I am not the spring.

I am only someone drawing water.

### 3. The Years That Were Not Preserved

Later, the times slowly changed.

I began using a computer and learning to organize materials digitally. Then came the iPad, cloud storage, and hard drives.

Still, for a long time, I was not used to becoming fully digital.

I continued writing many important things by hand, because I always felt that when I wrote by hand, my thoughts slowed down and my heart became quieter.

Later, because of changes in circumstances and turns in life, many earlier materials were not preserved completely.

Some notebooks were lost. Some old sermon notes were left behind. Some materials, because of the passing of time, can no longer be found.

Whenever I think about this, I feel a little regret.

Those writings were not merely materials. They were pieces of life.

They recorded youthful zeal and struggles under pressure. They recorded the awkwardness of my early ministry and the footsteps of gradual growth.

After coming to America, I began organizing my sermons again.

One day, as I opened folders on my computer and searched through cloud storage and hard drives, I discovered that over the years I had accumulated more than three hundred sermons.

Even I was surprised.

Time really does leave traces.

### 4. Organizing Sermons Is Also Organizing Life

For the first volume of this sermon collection, I selected fifty sermons.



Some are about the cross. Some are about grace. Some are about suffering and hope. Others are about the church, worship, family, and mission.

As I reread these sermons, I discovered that many of them were not only spoken to others.

Often, they were first spoken to me.

Some sermons were written under pressure. Some were written while waiting. Others were written in seasons of personal lowliness and pain.

Sometimes I prepared with tears. Sometimes, as I preached, the message corrected me first.

More and more, I have come to believe that preaching is not merely speaking. It is the honest overflow of a life.

A person who has never received comfort will struggle to speak true comfort. A person who has never wept will struggle to understand those who are wounded.

So I slowly discovered that the most important thing is not whether a sermon sounds impressive.

The most important thing is whether there is truth within it.

## 5. A Humble Regret I Still Carry

As I organized these sermons, I also carried a sense of humble regret.

Many years ago, when preparing sermons, we often learned from older pastors, theologians, and spiritual writers. Some of my content was deeply influenced by them. Some structures, illustrations, and ideas were built on what others had already given.

In those earlier years, we did not pay as much attention to proper citation as we do today. Many materials were used without complete documentation.

For that reason, even though these sermons are being gathered into a volume, I still prefer to see them as a personal record and preservation.

They are not meant to prove anything. They are not meant to display anything.

They simply record the learning, struggle, growth, and grace of an ordinary preacher through many years of ministry.

## 6. Sermons Pass Away, but Truth Remains

Over the years, I have increasingly felt this:

Human voices pass away.

Human names are slowly forgotten.

What truly remains is not a particular preacher, but the truth that comforts, illumines, and renews.

Sometimes after a sermon is preached, people may soon forget who the speaker was.

But if one sentence gives strength to someone in a low place, if one line brings a little light into the night, if one message helps a weary soul receive hope again, that is already enough.

So today, as I organize these sermons again, the deepest feeling in my heart is not pride.

It is gratitude.

Gratitude for God's preservation along the way.

Gratitude for the people who walked with me.

Gratitude that the low seasons did not crush me.

And gratitude for the spring of living water that has never run dry.

## 7. Final Reflections

Perhaps in the future, I will continue organizing a second and third volume.

Some sermons are already old. Some words even feel immature.

But I do not want to delete them.

Because within those pages is the most honest image of a young preacher learning to serve.

Looking back now, I understand more clearly that what sustains a preacher is not eloquence, knowledge, or even experience alone.

It is the willingness, in many lonely, weary, and pressured nights, to return again to the source.

I finally understand what my mother meant all those years ago:

A skin of water will eventually run out.

But the spring will not.

In the years ahead, may I continue with a quiet, reverent, and humble heart: learning, sharing, and seeking the living water that never stops flowing.

And may these sermons not remain merely on paper or in folders, but become companionship and comfort for others on their journey.

May all glory belong to the Lord who gives the spring of living water.

# 23. 我理想中的七十二岁 My Ideal Seventy-Two

## 不是退场，而是更深地结果子

这次参加牧人夫妻退修会，有一个画面一直留在我心里，挥之不去。

主旨讲员 Dr. Jim Lo 七十二岁，站在台上讲道时，声音洪亮清晰，思路敏捷，神采飞扬。

那不是一种靠技巧维持的表达，而是一种生命沉淀后的流露。话语有重量，也有温度；有激情，也有深度。

一个人到了这个年龄，还能活得这样活泼、有力量，实在令人羡慕。

更让我触动的是妻子的一句话。

她看着讲台上的罗博士，轻轻对我说：

“我看到他站在那里，好像看到你七十二岁时的样子。”

这句话让我愣了一下，也让我沉思很久。

说实话，人到了中年，很少会认真想自己七十二岁的模样。

忙着眼前的服事，忙着今天的责任，常常顾不上想远方。

可是那一刻，这句话像一粒种子落进心里：

我希望自己七十二岁的时候，会是怎样的人？

我理想中的状态，不是拥有多少头衔，不是讲过多少道，不是完成多少事工，而是到了那个年纪，生命依然鲜活。

灵里不老。

眼里有光。

心里有火。

站在那里，不只是讲知识，而是在分享一生与主同行的故事。

我想，真正理想的人生状态，不在于在哪个岗位，而在于无论身处哪里，都保持一种属天的秩序。

第一，与主的关系依旧亲密。

如果七十二岁还能站在台上有力量，不只是因为身体保养得好，更是因为里面那口井还在涌流。

人与主的关系若是新鲜，人就不会枯干。

我盼望自己到那一天，不是靠过去的经历活着，而是每天仍有新的领受、新的祷告、新的感动。

像老树长青。

像深井出水。

像晚霞更美。

第二，生命经过岁月，变得柔和而有力量。

罗博士的讲道带着一点五旬节背景的激情，也有卫斯理传统的火热，两者融合得很自然。

那种风格背后，其实不是技巧，而是人生。

一个人走过风浪，还能保持热情，这是恩典。

一个人经历复杂，还能活得单纯，这是操练。

我想，理想中的老年，不是老成，而是成熟；不是锋芒尽失，而是锋芒被恩典磨圆。

第三，到老仍能影响人。

不是因为还在做事，而是因为自己成为别人盼望的一幅图画。

这次退修会，对我来说，Dr. Lo 某种意义上像一幅未来画像。

他让我看到，原来年老可以这样优雅；原来服事可以这样长青；原来热情不必随着年龄退场。

这让我开始想：若主许可，我七十二岁还能不能站在讲台上，滔滔不绝地讲述祂的作为？

还能不能把跌跌撞撞的人生，总结成可以鼓励后来者的话语？

我盼望可以。

甚至不仅七十二岁，若主许可，八十二岁也如此。

讲道不是工作，而是一种生命姿态。

服事不是职位，而是呼召的延续。

退休，也许只是从一种岗位退下，不是从使命退下。

想到这里，我忽然觉得，人应当提前活成自己理想中的老年。

若希望七十二岁仍有火，今天就不要冷淡。

若希望那时有智慧，今天就认真学习。

若希望那时还能鼓励人，今天就先成为安慰人的人。

未来，不是突然长出来的，是今天一点一点活出来的。

有人说，人老了会收缩。

但我愿意相信，在恩典里，人老了可以扩展。

眼界更宽，心更柔软，信心更稳。

像一棵树，年轻时向上生长，年老时向下扎根。

这，也许就是我理想中的状态。

不是功成名就，不是被人记住，而是七十二岁的时候，仍然能爱主，能服事，能讲道，能做梦，也能让人从我身上看见盼望。

若真有那么一天，愿我也能像那晚讲台上的罗博士一样，站在那里，声音清楚，灵里火热，从容微笑，把一生走过的恩典，娓娓道来。

那大概，就是我心里理想的晚景。

也是我今天开始学习活出的方向。

愿我们都不是等老了才寻找理想，而是在今天，就活成理想的开始。

# **My Ideal Seventy-Two**

## **Not Stepping Away, but Bearing Deeper Fruit**

During this pastors' couples retreat, one image stayed with me and would not leave.

The keynote speaker, Dr. Jim Lo, was seventy-two years old. When he stood on the platform to preach, his voice was strong and clear, his thinking sharp, and his spirit full of life.

This was not a performance sustained by technique. It was the overflow of a life that had been deeply formed. His words carried weight and warmth, passion and depth.

To reach that age and still live with such vitality and strength is something I deeply admire.

What moved me even more was something my wife said.

Looking at Dr. Lo on the platform, she said softly to me:

“When I see him standing there, it is as if I can see what you might look like at seventy-two.”

That sentence startled me, and it stayed with me for a long time.

To be honest, people in middle age rarely think seriously about what they will be like at seventy-two.

We are busy with today's ministry, today's responsibilities, and today's needs. We often do not have time to think about the distant future.

But in that moment, her words fell into my heart like a seed:

What kind of person do I hope to be when I am seventy-two?

My ideal state is not about how many titles I have, how many sermons I have preached, or how many ministries I have completed. It is that, at that age, life would still be alive within me.

Young in spirit.

Light in the eyes.

Fire in the heart.

Standing there, not merely teaching knowledge, but sharing the story of a lifetime of walking with the Lord.

I think the truly ideal state of life is not defined by a position. It is the ability, wherever one stands, to live with a heavenly order within.

First, the relationship with the Lord remains close.

If a person can still stand on a platform at seventy-two with strength, it is not only because the body has been well cared for. It is because the well within is still flowing.

When a person's relationship with the Lord remains fresh, the soul does not dry up.

I hope that when I reach that day, I will not be living only on past experiences, but will still have fresh receiving, fresh prayers, and fresh stirrings from God.

Like an old tree still green.

Like a deep well still giving water.

Like the evening sky becoming more beautiful.

Second, life becomes gentle and strong through the years.

Dr. Lo's preaching carried the passion of a Pentecostal background and the warmth of the Wesleyan tradition, blended in a very natural way.

Behind that style was not technique, but life.

For a person to pass through storms and still remain passionate is grace.

For a person to experience complexity and still remain simple is formation.

I think ideal old age is not merely being seasoned, but mature; not losing all sharpness, but having the edges rounded by grace.

Third, one can still influence others in old age.

Not merely by continuing to do things, but by becoming a picture of hope for others.

At this retreat, Dr. Lo became, in a sense, a portrait of the future for me.

He showed me that old age can be graceful, ministry can remain green, and passion does not have to retire with age.

It made me wonder: if the Lord allows, will I still be able to stand on a platform at seventy-two and speak with joy about His works?

Will I still be able to turn a stumbling, uneven life into words that encourage those who come after me?

I hope so.

Not only at seventy-two, but even at eighty-two, if the Lord permits.

Preaching is not merely a job. It is a posture of life.

Ministry is not merely a position. It is the continuation of a calling.

Retirement may mean stepping down from one role, but it does not mean stepping down from mission.

When I thought of this, I suddenly felt that a person should begin now to live toward the old age he hopes for.

If I hope to have fire at seventy-two, I must not grow cold today.

If I hope to have wisdom then, I must study seriously today.



If I hope to encourage others then, I must first become someone who comforts others today.

The future does not appear suddenly. It is lived into, little by little, today.

Some people say that when people grow old, they shrink.

But I choose to believe that, in grace, people can expand as they age.

Their vision can become broader, their hearts softer, and their faith steadier.

Like a tree: in youth it grows upward; in old age it sends roots deeper.

Perhaps this is the state I long for.

Not fame.

Not being remembered by many.

But at seventy-two, still loving the Lord, still serving, still preaching, still dreaming, and still allowing others to see hope through my life.

If that day truly comes, may I be like Dr. Lo that evening: standing there, voice clear, spirit burning, smiling calmly, and telling the story of grace that has carried me through a lifetime.

That, perhaps, is the old age I long for.

And it is also the direction I must begin living toward today.

May we not wait until we are old to search for the ideal life.

May we begin living its firstfruits today.



# 24. 查社安金的分数，查出了人生功课

## Checking My Social Security Credits, Finding a Lesson for Life

### 有些误会，不是危机，而是提醒你重新对账

今天发生一件小事，让我忍不住笑了一下，也想深了一层。

忽然想到，自己来美国已经八年，服事也将要进入第五年，报税也报了六年。心里想，按照美国 Social Security Administration 的规则，攒够一定积分，将来退休就有社安金。每年最多四分，我算来算去，觉得自己怎么也该有点成绩了。

结果一查，零分。

不是三十几，不是十几，连一分都没有。

那一刻，我的心情很微妙，像一个学生满怀信心查成绩，结果页面显示：暂无记录。

我差点想问电脑：

“弟兄，你是不是对我有误会？”

后来预约去社安局核查，结果最早排到六月。

美国办事有时很像属灵操练，专门训练人的忍耐。

这件事让我忽然想到：人生里很多焦虑，其实都从误会开始。

有时是别人误会我们。

有时是我们误会别人。

更常见的是，我们误会了现实。

以为自己积攒很多，结果发现账本可能有问题。

以为自己很稳妥，忽然发现还要重新核对。

以为一切都在掌控中，其实还有许多地方需要厘清。

但误会不一定是坏事。

有时候，误会像闹钟。

它不是来毁掉你，而是提醒你去查账。

查社安积分，也让我想到查生命的账户。

我们忙忙碌碌，其实也在积累：

爱积了多少？

忍耐积了多少？

信心积了多少？

对永恒的投资积了多少？

还是不知不觉，账户空空？

保罗说，有人的工程是草木禾秸，有人的是金银宝石，经火一试，就显明出来。

这不也是一种属灵审计吗？

幽默一点讲：社安局查退休分数，天上也许在查生命分量。

只是后者更重要。

今天这场“零分惊魂”，反倒提醒我：

不要只担心美国的退休积分够不够，更要问，永恒里到底存留多少分量。

如果生活中遇见误解，不要急着生气。

先查一查：

是不是系统延迟？

是不是自己理解错了？

是不是天父借这个误会，在提醒我什么？

很多误会，最后不是危机，而是转机。

有时不是人生归零，只是提醒你重新对账。

所以，我六月要去查社安分数。

而今天，我也想提醒自己：

也去查查生命的账户。

看看那些经过试炼之后，还能存留多少。

因为真正重要的，不只是退休账户有没有积分，而是我们这一生，有没有留下能存到永恒里的分量。

说到底，社安金可以慢慢查。

生命账，更要早点查。

不要等最后才发现：

原来最该积累的，忘了存。

# Checking My Social Security Credits, Finding a Lesson for Life

## Some Misunderstandings Are Not Crises, but Reminders to Reconcile the Account

Something small happened today that made me laugh, and then made me think more deeply.

I suddenly realized that I have been in America for eight years, have served here for nearly five years, and have filed taxes for six years. I thought that, according to the rules of the Social Security Administration, if a person earns enough credits, he can receive Social Security benefits after retirement. Since one can earn up to four credits a year, I calculated in my mind and assumed I should have at least some “results” by now.

Then I checked.

Zero credits.

Not thirty-something. Not ten-something. Not even one.

My feeling in that moment was hard to describe. It was like a student checking grades with confidence, only to see the page say: no record found.

I almost wanted to ask the computer:

“Brother, is there some misunderstanding between us?”

Later, I made an appointment with the Social Security office to verify the issue, but the earliest available time was in June.

Sometimes the way things work in America feels like spiritual formation. It trains patience very thoroughly.

This little incident made me think: much of our anxiety in life begins with misunderstanding.

Sometimes others misunderstand us.

Sometimes we misunderstand others.

More often, we misunderstand reality.

We think we have accumulated a lot, only to discover that the account may have a problem.

We think everything is secure, only to find that it must be checked again.

We think everything is under control, but there is still much that needs to be clarified.

But misunderstanding is not always a bad thing.

Sometimes a misunderstanding is like an alarm clock.

It does not come to destroy you. It comes to tell you to check the account.

Checking my Social Security credits also made me think about checking the account of life.

As we live busily, we are also accumulating something:

How much love have I accumulated?

How much patience?

How much faith?

How much investment in eternity?

Or have I somehow remained empty without realizing it?

Paul says that some people build with wood, hay, or straw, while others build with gold, silver, and costly stones. When fire tests the work, it will be revealed.

Is this not also a kind of spiritual audit?

To say it humorously: the Social Security office checks retirement credits; heaven may be checking the weight of life.

The latter matters more.

Today's "zero-credit scare" reminded me of something important:

Do not only worry about whether I have enough retirement credits in America. Ask also how much will remain in eternity.

When misunderstandings happen in life, do not rush to anger.

First check:

Is the system delayed?

Did I understand something incorrectly?

Is the Father using this misunderstanding to remind me of something?

Many misunderstandings are not crises. They are turning points.

Sometimes life has not returned to zero. It is simply asking you to reconcile the account.

So in June, I will go check my Social Security credits.

But today, I also want to remind myself:

check the account of life.

See what remains after testing.

Because what truly matters is not only whether a retirement account has credits, but whether this life has stored up anything that can remain in eternity.

In the end, Social Security can be checked slowly.

The account of life should be checked early.

Do not wait until the end to discover:

the very thing that should have been stored up was never deposited.

# 25. 我是“油腻大叔” I Am a “Greasy Uncle”

## 中年不是敌人，失去幽默才是

人这一生，最怕的不是变老。

最怕的是，你还没准备好，别人已经帮你改了称呼。

以前，别人叫我“小伙子”，我觉得自己青春无限。

后来，别人叫我“哥”，我开始有点警觉。

再后来，有人开始叫我“叔”，我心里就微微一震：

完了，人生进入下一阶段了。

而今天，我的人生正式进入了“有力”大叔时代。

事情是这样的。

今天，我正安安静静地躺在床上，享受一个中年男人难得的午休。

妻子忽然站在旁边，看着我的枕头，发出一声意味深长的感叹：

“哎呀，你真是个油腻大叔。”

我一愣。

心想，这是夸我呢，还是在进行某种人身攻击？

结果她继续说：

“你看你睡过的枕头，那个油啊。如果把你枕头里的油收集起来，炒菜都不用买油了。”

我当场沉默。

一个男人，最怕空气突然安静。

我还没来得及反驳，她又指着沙发说：

“还有这个皮沙发，你每天靠过以后，我都要帮你擦。你这个男人，怎么能这么有力？”

我终于明白了。

原来她口中的“有力”，不是有能力，也不是有力量，而是有油力。



中年男人最大的秘密，终究还是藏不住了。

年轻的时候，脸上出油，叫青春。

现在脸上出油，叫岁月。

以前照镜子，是“哇，好帅”。

现在照镜子，是“哇，好亮”。

尤其夏天。

别人的脸，是清爽。

中年男人的脸，是反光。

有时候晚上开车，我甚至怀疑自己不用开远光灯，因为额头已经自带高光。

但男人嘛，最重要的是心态。

于是我不服气地反击她：

“你以前不是说我是奶油小生吗？怎么现在突然变成有力大叔了？”

妻子倒也很会安慰人。

她一本正经地说：

“男人嘛，就是应该有力。”

“有力不代表老，有力也不代表邋遢。那是一种成熟男人的魅力。”

我一听，忽然觉得很有道理。

是啊。

年轻男孩，是清秀。

中年男人，是厚重。

年轻时靠颜值。

中年后靠气场。

年轻人像奶茶。

中年人像老火汤。

虽然表面开始出油，但里面开始有味道了。

后来我越想越觉得，中年男人这件事，其实很有哲学。



男人太精致，容易像玻璃杯。

男人稍微粗一点，反而像老铁锅。

铁锅虽然不闪亮，但越用越香。

真正的中年男人，身上一定有一些岁月留下来的痕迹：

有一点疲惫，有一点发福，有一点油，还有一点看透人生后的幽默。

因为生活已经把他从“小鲜肉”，慢慢炖成了“红烧肉”。

以前，我很介意别人叫我“哥”。

总觉得是不是嫌我老了。

现在好了。

直接升级为“大叔”。

再过几年，我估计路上的小朋友都会开始叫我“大爷您好”。

等那一天来了，我可能也不会太难过。

因为人生本来就是这样。

小时候，我们拼命想长大。

长大后，我们拼命想年轻。

可真正成熟以后才发现：年龄不是敌人。

真正可怕的是，人老了，心却越来越苦；头发少了，笑容也少了。

所以，与其焦虑变老，不如优雅地接受自己进入“有力时代”。

枕头有油，说明还活着。

沙发反光，说明还天天回家。

肚子变大，说明这些年没少吃苦，也没少吃饭。

人生到了这个阶段，不一定要做奶油小生。

但至少可以做一个有趣、有爱、有担当的“有力大叔”。

# I Am a “Greasy Uncle”

## Middle Age Is Not the Enemy; Losing Humor Is

In life, the most frightening thing is not getting older.

It is when others change your title before you are ready.

In the past, when people called me “young man,” I felt endlessly youthful.

Later, when people called me “brother,” I began to feel slightly alert.

Then, when people started calling me “uncle,” my heart trembled a little:

It is over. Life has entered the next stage.

And today, my life officially entered the age of the “greasy uncle.”

Here is what happened.

I was lying quietly on the bed, enjoying a rare middle-aged nap.

My wife suddenly stood beside me, looked at my pillow, and sighed meaningfully:

“Wow, you really are a greasy uncle.”

I froze.

Was this a compliment, or was it some kind of personal attack?

Then she continued:

“Look at the pillow after you sleep on it. The oil is unbelievable. If we collected the oil from your pillow, we might not need to buy cooking oil.”

I fell silent.

For a man, few things are more frightening than sudden silence in the room.

Before I could defend myself, she pointed to the leather sofa.

“And this sofa too. Every time you sit there, I have to wipe it afterward. How can one man be so oily?”

I finally understood.

What she meant was not “powerful.” She meant oily.

The greatest secret of a middle-aged man cannot remain hidden forever.

When you are young, oil on the face is called youth.

Now, oil on the face is called age.

In the past, when I looked in the mirror, I thought, “Wow, handsome.”

Now I look in the mirror and think, “Wow, shiny.”

Especially in summer.

Other people’s faces look fresh.

A middle-aged man’s face reflects light.

Sometimes when I drive at night, I wonder if I even need the high beams, because my forehead already comes with its own highlight.

But for a man, mindset matters most.

So I pushed back:

“Didn’t you used to say I was a charming young man? How did I suddenly become a greasy uncle?”

My wife knows how to comfort a person.

She said very seriously:

“A man should have weight.”

“It does not mean old. It does not mean sloppy. It is the charm of a mature man.”

When I heard this, I suddenly felt it made sense.

Yes.

Young men are clean and delicate.

Middle-aged men are weighty.

In youth, we rely on appearance.

In middle age, we rely on presence.

Young people are like milk tea.

Middle-aged people are like a slow-cooked soup.

The surface may begin to shine, but something deeper has begun to develop flavor.

The more I thought about it, the more I felt that middle age contains real philosophy.

If a man is too refined, he can become like a glass cup.

If he is a little rough, he becomes more like an old iron pan.

An iron pan may not shine, but the more it is used, the richer it becomes.

A real middle-aged man carries traces of time:

a little tiredness, a little weight, a little oil, and a little humor after seeing enough of life.

Life has slowly cooked him from “fresh meat” into something with deeper flavor.

In the past, I cared when people called me “brother.”

I wondered if they thought I was old.

Now I have been upgraded directly to “uncle.”

In a few years, children on the street may start saying, “Good morning, sir.”

When that day comes, perhaps I will not be too sad.

Because life is simply like this.

When we are children, we try hard to grow up.

After we grow up, we try hard to stay young.

But when we truly mature, we discover that age is not the enemy.

What is truly frightening is becoming older while the heart becomes bitter, having less hair and fewer smiles.

So instead of fearing age, I may as well accept this new season with grace and humor.

An oily pillow means I am still alive.

A shiny sofa means I still come home every day.

A bigger belly means that over the years, I have suffered some things, and I have also eaten well.

At this stage of life, I do not need to be a charming young man.

But at least I can become a middle-aged man with humor, love, and responsibility.

# 26. 不要轻易说放弃 Don't Give Up Too Soon

## 人生很多转机，都发生在再坚持一分钟之后

在很多人的成长过程中，我们都听过类似的话：

“路难要早脱鞋，命苦要早休息。”

这些话听起来像是经验之谈，其实背后隐藏着一种思维方式：事情一难，就尽快退出。

这逻辑并不完全错误。

在人生某些处境中，及时止损确实是一种智慧。

但问题在于，当这种思维被泛化时，它就不再是智慧，而会变成一种习惯性退缩的心理结构。

一、很多失败，不是能力不够，而是放弃太早

现实中，我们常常高估天赋，却低估坚持。

很多人不是输在起点，而是输在临门前一步。

再多读十分钟，也许就明白了一个难点。

再练习一次，也许就突破了一个瓶颈。

再坚持一天，也许就跨过了一个阶段。

但遗憾的是，很多人选择在“差一点”的地方停下来。

不是事情真的无法继续，而是人先选择了离开。

坚持的价值，不在于时间本身有多长，而在于你是否走到了那个临界点。

二、学习的突破，常常发生在最想放弃的时候

在学习中，我们都有类似经历。

当你感觉完全学不进去的时候，往往正是突破来临的前夜。

因为大脑正在重组信息，认知正在从混乱转向清晰，能力正在从不会过渡到会。

但这个过程往往最痛苦。

很多人就在这里选择放弃，于是错过了那个本该属于自己的成长节点。

成长从来都不是完全线性的。

很多时候，它是跨越式的。

而跨越之前，常常伴随着挣扎。

三、关系中的轻易放弃，代价更沉重

不只是学习。

在婚姻、家庭和亲密关系中，轻易放弃的代价更沉重。

有些人因为性格不合，就选择结束关系。

因为沟通困难，就选择逃避。

因为一次冲突，就做出永久决定。

但当时间过去，经历更多比较之后，他们才发现：

原来曾经拥有的，反而是更好的。

于是后悔、叹息、懊恼，却已经无法回到过去。

问题往往不是关系本身不行，而是没有经过足够的磨合与成长。

真正成熟的关系，不是没有冲突，而是在冲突中仍然选择留下来面对。

四、坚持与放弃，都需要智慧

当然，我们也必须承认，并不是所有事情都值得坚持。

有些路，确实需要转弯。

有些方向，确实需要调整。

关键在于，你是经过判断后的选择，还是因为困难而退缩？

两者看起来相似，本质却完全不同。

前者是主动的、清醒的。

后者是被动的、情绪化的。

真正的智慧，不是盲目坚持，也不是习惯放弃，而是在该坚持的时候不退缩，在该转弯的时候不固执。

五、人生很多失去，发生在差一点的时候

回头看我们的人生，会发现一个残酷却真实的规律：

很多失去，不是因为你完全没有机会，而是因为你提前退出了。

你没有输给别人。

你只是输给了那个“再多坚持一下”的时刻。

有时候，决定人生高度的，不是你做了多少，而是你在最困难的时候有没有留下来。

六、再坚持一分钟，也许就是分水岭

“不要轻易说放弃”，不是一句简单的励志口号，而是一种对生命负责的态度。

因为你永远不知道，下一分钟，是徒劳，还是突破。

但有一件事可以确定：

如果你现在放弃，那个可能的突破，一定不会发生。

所以，在你想要放弃的时候，尝试再坚持一分钟。

很多人的转机，就发生在那一分钟之后。



# Don't Give Up Too Soon

## Many Turning Points Come One Minute After You Want to Quit

As we grow up, many of us hear sayings like this:

“If the road is hard, take off your shoes early. If life is bitter, rest early.”

Such words sound practical. But behind them is a certain mindset: when things become difficult, withdraw as soon as possible.

This logic is not entirely wrong.

In some situations, cutting losses in time is indeed wisdom.

The problem is that when this mindset becomes a default response, it stops being wisdom and becomes a habit of retreat.

### 1. Many Failures Happen Not Because of Lack of Ability, but Because of Giving Up Too Soon

In real life, we often overestimate talent and underestimate persistence.

Many people do not lose at the starting line. They lose one step before the breakthrough.

Read ten more minutes, and you may understand the difficult point.

Practice one more time, and you may break through a bottleneck.

Hold on one more day, and you may cross into a new stage.

Sadly, many people stop at the place called “almost.”

It is not always that the task cannot continue. Sometimes the person leaves too early.

The value of persistence is not simply the length of time. It is whether you reach the critical point.

### 2. Breakthroughs in Learning Often Come When You Most Want to Quit

In learning, many of us have had this experience.

When you feel that you cannot absorb anything anymore, you may actually be standing right before a breakthrough.

Your mind is reorganizing information. Your understanding is moving from confusion toward clarity. Your ability is shifting from inability toward competence.

But this process often feels painful.

Many people quit here, and therefore lose a growth point that could have belonged to them.

Growth is rarely perfectly linear.

Often, it happens in leaps.



And before the leap, there is usually struggle.

### 3. Giving Up Too Easily in Relationships Carries a Heavier Cost

This is true not only in learning.

In marriage, family, and close relationships, giving up too easily can carry an even heavier cost.

Some people end a relationship because personalities differ.

They escape because communication is difficult.

They make a permanent decision because of one conflict.

But after time passes, and after more comparison, they realize:

what they once had was actually better.

Then regret, sighing, and sorrow come, but the past cannot be recovered.

Often, the problem was not that the relationship itself was impossible. It was that the relationship had not gone through enough growth and adjustment.

A mature relationship is not one without conflict. It is one in which people still choose to stay and face the conflict together.

### 4. Both Persistence and Letting Go Require Wisdom

Of course, we must also admit that not everything is worth holding on to.

Some paths truly need to change.

Some directions truly need to be adjusted.

The key question is this: are you making a decision after discernment, or are you retreating because of difficulty?

The two may look similar, but they are very different.

The first is active and clear-minded.

The second is passive and emotional.

True wisdom is neither blind persistence nor habitual surrender. It means not retreating when you should persist, and not being stubborn when you should turn.

### 5. Many Losses Happen at the Point of “Almost”

When we look back on life, we discover a painful but true pattern:

many losses happen not because we had no opportunity at all, but because we exited too early.

You did not lose to someone else.

You lost to the moment when you needed to hold on a little longer.

Sometimes what determines the height of a life is not how much you have done, but whether you remain when things are most difficult.

#### 6. One More Minute May Become the Turning Point

“Don’t give up too soon” is not merely an inspirational slogan. It is an attitude of responsibility toward life.

You never know whether the next minute will be fruitless or a breakthrough.

But one thing is certain:

if you give up now, the possible breakthrough will never happen.

So when you want to quit, try staying one more minute.

Many turning points in life happen just after that minute.

# 27. 背水一战 A Battle With No Way Back

## 路不是等出来的，是走出来的

有一个时刻，不属于平顺的岁月，也不属于充足的选择。

当一切条件都还不成熟，资源也不充足，外界的评估并不看好时，你仍然必须做出决定。

这，就是背水一战的时刻。

我们正在经历这样的阶段。

一个承载多年聚会与记忆的空间，逐步退出历史舞台；一个新的方向摆在面前，同时伴随着现实压力：资金紧张、条件有限、路径未完全清晰。

甚至，在某些外部评估中，我们被归入“低活跃”的群体之列。

这些声音不一定带着恶意，却足以让人犹豫。

但真正的问题不是别人如何定义我们，而是我们如何看待自己所走的路。

一、当一切都不具备的时候，要不要开始？

人天然倾向于等待。

等条件更好一点，等资源再多一点，等环境更稳定一点。

但现实是，真正重要的开始，常常不是在万事俱备时发生。

如果一件事必须等到所有条件都完美才开始，它可能永远不会开始。

成长，本来就发生在不完全中。

突破，本来就诞生在限制里。

当我们面对新的方向时，看到的不只是资金缺口，也不只是现实压力，而是一个更深的问题：

我们是否愿意在不确定中，仍然选择前行？

二、背水一战不是冲动，而是看清楚之后的决定

“背水一战”常被理解为情绪化的拼搏。

但真正的背水一战，从来不是盲目。

它的意思是：看清现实的困难，承认资源的有限，理解外界的判断，却仍然做出向前的选择。

这不是忽视风险，而是承担风险。

这不是过度自信，而是信念坚定。

我们不是不知道前路有压力，而是在知道的情况下，仍然选择承受。

因为有些路，不是因为容易才走，而是因为值得才走。

三、至死而后生：一条反直觉却真实的路

有一种规律，看起来反直觉，却反复被印证：

先放手，才有新的得着。

先破碎，才有重建的可能。

先走到极限，才看见转机。

如果一切都停留在安全范围内，就很难进入更新的状态。

同样，一个群体若始终只停留在可控范围里，也很难真正扩展。

建堂或搬迁，不只是空间的改变，更是生命姿态的转变。

它意味着从依附走向承担，从临时走向稳定，从被动走向主动。

这其中必然有代价。

但正是这些代价，构成了成长的道路。

四、关键不在环境，而在那一步

很多时候，人以为问题都在外面：

环境不够好，条件不够成熟，资源不足。

但更核心的问题往往是：

我是否愿意先迈出那一步？

因为有些改变，不是在准备完成之后发生，而是在行动开始之后发生。

不是先有结果，人才行动；而是先有行动，才渐渐看见结果。

当人停留在岸边分析水流，水不会改变。

当人真正踏入水中，一切才开始不同。

那一步看似很小，却决定整个方向。

五、前进总要付代价

前进从来不是免费的。

任何真正有分量的推进，都伴随着某种放下。

也许是放下对安全的依赖，放下对稳定的执着，放下对掌控的需要，甚至放下自己给自己设定的边界。

代价并不可怕。

没有代价，才可怕。

因为没有代价的前进，往往也没有真正的改变。

当我们愿意为一个方向付代价时，那个方向才真正成为我们的方向。

## 六、在不被看好的时候，重新定义价值

外界的评价，有时基于数据，有时基于经验，有时只是基于表面的观察。

但一个群体真正的价值，从来不是由短期表现决定的。

历史上许多关键转折，都发生在不被看好的阶段。

所以问题不是我们现在看起来是否强大，而是我们是否在走一条正确且值得坚持的路。

如果方向是对的，目前的不足，就只是过程的一部分。

## 七、背水一战，是一种面向未来的姿态

“背水一战”，本质上不是战术，而是一种姿态。

是不再退后的姿态。

是不再观望的姿态。

是把未来交给行动的姿态。

当一群人走到这一步时，就不再只是等待环境决定节奏，而是开始用行动回应环境。

这不是鲁莽，而是成熟之后的果断。

路，很多时候并不是事先完全显明的。

路是在行动中被走出来的。

当我们站在原地时，一切看起来都不可能。

当我们真正开始向前时，可能性才逐渐展开。

所谓背水一战，不是因为没选择，而是因为我们选择不再后退。

当我们迈出那一步，环境也许不会立刻改变，但方向已经改变；结果也许还没有显现，但道路已经开始打开。

未来不属于一直观望的人，而属于愿意向前的人。

# A Battle With No Way Back

## The Road Is Not Waited For; It Is Walked Into Being

There are moments that do not belong to smooth seasons or sufficient options.

When conditions are not yet mature, resources are limited, and outside evaluations are not encouraging, you still have to make a decision.

This is the moment of a battle with no way back.

We are living through such a season.

A place that carried years of gatherings and memories is gradually passing into history. A new direction stands before us, but it comes with real pressure: limited funds, limited conditions, and a path that is not yet fully clear.

Even in some external evaluations, we have been described as a low-activity group.

Such voices may not be malicious, but they are enough to make people hesitate.

Yet the real question is not how others define us. The real question is how we understand the road we are walking.

### 1. Should We Begin When Not Everything Is Ready?

Human beings naturally tend to wait.

Wait until conditions are better. Wait until resources increase. Wait until the environment becomes more stable.

But in reality, meaningful beginnings often do not happen when everything is ready.

If something must wait until all conditions are perfect, it may never begin.

Growth happens in incompleteness.

Breakthrough is born within limitation.

When we face a new direction, what we see is not only a financial gap or practical pressure. We face a deeper question:

Are we willing to move forward even in uncertainty?

### 2. A Battle With No Way Back Is Not Impulse, but a Decision Made With Clarity

This phrase is often understood as emotional striving.

But a true battle with no way back is never blind.

It means seeing the difficulties clearly, acknowledging limited resources, understanding outside evaluations, and still choosing to move forward.

This is not ignoring risk. It is accepting responsibility for risk.



This is not overconfidence. It is conviction.

We are not unaware of the pressure ahead. We know it, and still choose to bear it.

Some roads are not taken because they are easy, but because they are worth taking.

### 3. Life After Loss: A Counterintuitive but Real Path

There is a pattern that often seems counterintuitive, yet is confirmed again and again:

Only after letting go can something new be received.

Only after breaking can rebuilding begin.

Only after reaching the edge can a turning point appear.

If everything remains within the safe zone, renewal rarely happens.

Likewise, if a community remains only within what is controllable, it may never truly expand.

Building or moving is not merely a change of space. It is a change in posture.

It means moving from dependence to responsibility, from temporary arrangements to stability, from passivity to initiative.

Such a transition always carries a cost.

But these costs are part of the road of growth.

### 4. The Turning Point Is Not the Environment, but the Step

Many times, we assume the problem is outside us:

the environment is not good enough, the conditions are not mature, the resources are insufficient.

But the deeper question is often this:

Am I willing to take the first step?

Some changes do not happen after preparation is complete. They begin after action starts.

Results do not always come before action. Often, action comes first, and results gradually appear.

Standing on the shore and analyzing the water changes nothing.

Stepping into the water changes everything.

That step may seem small, but it determines the direction.

### 5. Moving Forward Always Costs Something



Progress is never free.

Every meaningful advance involves some kind of release.

Perhaps we must release dependence on safety, attachment to stability, the need for control, or even the boundaries we have set for ourselves.

Cost is not frightening.

No cost is more frightening.

Because progress without cost often brings no real change.

When we are willing to pay a price for a direction, that direction truly becomes ours.

## 6. Redefining Value When Others Are Not Optimistic

External evaluations may be based on data, experience, or surface observation.

But the true value of a community is never determined by short-term appearance.

Many turning points in history happened during seasons when people were not optimistic.

So the question is not whether we look strong right now.

The question is whether we are walking a road that is right and worth continuing.

If the direction is right, present limitations are only part of the process.

## 7. A Battle With No Way Back Is a Posture Toward the Future

At its heart, this is not a strategy. It is a posture.

A posture of no longer retreating.

A posture of no longer merely watching.

A posture of entrusting the future to action.

When a group reaches this point, it no longer waits for conditions to set the pace. It begins to respond to conditions through action.

This is not recklessness. It is decisiveness after maturity.

The road is often not fully visible in advance.

Often, the road is formed by walking.

When we stand still, everything appears impossible.

When we truly begin to move, possibilities slowly unfold.

A battle with no way back is not the absence of choice. It is the choice not to retreat.

When we take that step, the environment may not change immediately, but the direction has already changed. The result may not yet be visible, but the road has already begun to open.

The future does not belong to those who only watch.

It belongs to those who are willing to move forward.

# 28. 在理性与信心之间

## Between Reason and Faith

### 走一条不后悔的人生之路

在人生的道路上，我们常常站在一个看不见的十字路口。

一边是理性，一边是信心。

理性告诉我们：要计算成本，评估风险，认清现实。

它像一位谨慎的会计，提醒我们不要轻举妄动，不要做超出能力范围的决定。

而信心在另一边轻声呼唤：要向前，要尝试，要相信未来仍有可能。

它像一位充满勇气的探路者，推动我们走出舒适区，迈向未知。

问题是，我们该听谁的？

一、只有理性的人，往往停在原地

如果一个人完全依赖理性决定，他的人生看起来安全，却很可能缺乏突破。

理性会让你看到：

这件事成功率不高。

那条路风险复杂。

这个机会还不够稳定。

于是，你选择不动。

短期看来，这是一种明智。

但从长远来看，它可能变成一种安静的停滞。

很多人一生没有经历过重大失败，但也从未经历真正的成长。

因为成长，往往发生在理性无法完全掌控的地方。

二、只有信心的人，容易不断碰壁

但如果一个人完全依赖感觉和冲动，忽略理性的判断，也会走向另一个极端。

他可能会说：

“我相信一定会成功！”

却没有准备。

“我觉得这是对的！”

却没有验证。

结果往往是不断尝试，不断受挫；不断行动，却缺乏方向。

这样的人外表勇敢，本质上却缺乏稳定根基。

失败之后，不仅要承受现实损失，也要面对别人的质疑和批评。

### 三、成熟的人，让理性服事信心

真正成熟的生命，不是在理性和信心之间二选一，而是让两者进入一种有秩序的关系。

理性，不是用来限制信心的，而是用来校正信心的方向。

信心，不是用来否定理性的，而是用来突破理性的边界。

简单说：

理性负责怎么看。

信心负责敢不敢走。

一个人可以用理性分析风险，却仍然选择迈出那一步。

不是因为看不见风险，而是因为看见了，仍然愿意承担。

这才是成熟的勇气。

### 四、人生的关键决定，往往不是完全理性的

你会发现，人生中许多重要决定，例如选择一个方向、开始一段关系、承担一份责任、改变人生轨迹，很少是完全理性的。

因为如果等到百分之百确定，也许永远不会开始。

真正推动人前进的，往往是一种带着理性的信心。

它不是盲目，而是在有限的认知中，仍然愿意前行。

### 五、在不确定中前进，是一种能力

这个世界本身就充满不确定。

没有任何一个决定是百分之百安全的，也没有任何一条路完全没有风险。

因此，问题不再是：“有没有风险？”

而是：“我是否有足够的内在力量，去承担这个风险？”

理性帮助我们减少不必要的损失。

信心帮助我们不被恐惧困住。

两者结合，才能让人既不鲁莽，也不退缩。

六、走一条有张力的人生

真正有深度的人生，不是极端的，而是有张力的。

在理性中保持清醒。

在信心中保持前行。

当你面对选择时，可以问自己三个问题：

理性告诉我什么？

我是否已经尽力看清现实？

即便如此，我是否仍愿意向前？

如果答案是肯定的，那就勇敢走吧。

因为人生不是等到完全确定才开始，而是在不完全确定中，一步一步走出来的。

# Between Reason and Faith

## Walking a Life Without Regret

On the road of life, we often stand at an invisible crossroads.

On one side is reason. On the other side is faith.

Reason tells us to calculate costs, evaluate risks, and face reality clearly.

It is like a careful accountant, warning us not to act rashly or make decisions beyond our capacity.

Faith whispers from the other side: move forward, try, and believe that the future still holds possibility.

It is like a courageous explorer, urging us out of comfort and into the unknown.

The question is: which voice should we listen to?

### 1. A Life Guided Only by Reason Often Remains Still

If a person depends entirely on reason, life may look safe, but it may lack breakthrough.

Reason will show you:

the chance of success is not high.

that path carries complicated risks.

this opportunity is not stable enough.

So you choose not to move.

In the short term, this may appear wise.

But over time, it can become quiet stagnation.

Many people never experience major failure, but they also never experience real growth.

Growth often happens in places reason cannot fully control.

### 2. A Life Guided Only by Faith Easily Runs Into Walls

But if a person depends entirely on feeling and impulse while ignoring careful judgment, he moves toward another extreme.

He may say:

“I believe this will succeed!”

but has made no preparation.

“I feel this is right!”

but has not tested it.

The result is often repeated attempts and repeated setbacks; much action, but little direction.

Such a person may look courageous, but lacks a stable foundation.

After failure, he must bear not only practical loss, but also the questions and criticism of others.

### 3. Mature People Let Reason Serve Faith

True maturity does not choose either reason or faith. It places them in proper order.

Reason is not meant to limit faith, but to clarify its direction.

Faith is not meant to deny reason, but to move beyond its boundaries.

Simply put:

Reason helps us see.

Faith helps us walk.

A person can analyze risks rationally and still choose to take the step.

Not because the risks are invisible, but because the risks have been seen and accepted.

This is mature courage.

### 4. Life's Most Important Decisions Are Rarely Completely Rational

Many important decisions in life, such as choosing a direction, beginning a relationship, taking responsibility, or changing the course of life, are rarely made by pure logic alone.

If we wait for one hundred percent certainty, we may never begin.

What truly moves a person forward is often faith grounded in reason.

It is not blindness. It is the willingness to move forward with limited understanding.

### 5. Moving Forward in Uncertainty Is an Ability

The world itself is full of uncertainty.

No decision is completely safe, and no path is entirely without risk.

So the real question is no longer, "Is there risk?"

The question is, "Do I have the inner strength to bear this risk?"

Reason helps us reduce unnecessary loss.



Faith keeps us from being trapped by fear.

Together, they help us avoid both recklessness and retreat.

## 6. Living a Life With Tension

A meaningful life is not an extreme life. It is a life with tension.

Remain clear-minded in reason.

Keep moving forward in faith.

When facing a decision, ask yourself three questions:

What does reason tell me?

Have I done my best to see reality clearly?

Even so, am I still willing to move forward?

If the answer is yes, then walk courageously.

Life does not begin only when everything is certain.

It is walked out, step by step, in uncertainty.



# 29. 蓄势待发. Poised to Rise

## 隐藏不是停滞，而是更深的预备

大斋节的四十天，是一段安静而深刻的旅程。

不是外在的热闹，而是内里的收缩；不是向外的奔跑，而是向内的归回。

在这四十天里，我们教会一班人一起禁食、祷告、默想。

身体在减轻，灵魂却在加重。

我自己也经历了一种很具体、很真实的改变：体重从 177 磅降到 163 磅。

这不仅仅是数字的变化，更是一种节奏的调整，一种生命的重新排序。

一、减少，是为了腾出空间

每天早上不再吃早餐，家里也不再准备早餐，甚至连馒头都不再做了。

厨房安静了，胃安静了，人也慢慢安静下来。

你会发现，当“吃”这件事情被暂时拿走的时候，原来我们有那么多时间、注意力和欲望，可以重新被整理。

可以用来祷告，用来思想，用来与神对话。

有时候，生命的问题不是缺少，而是太多。

减少，不是亏损，而是腾出空间，让更重要的东西进入。

二、隐藏，是为了更深的积蓄

这四十天，好像什么都没有发生。

没有热闹的活动，没有明显的成果。

但正如竹子一样，看似没有生长，其实在地下拼命扎根。

这正是属灵生命的规律：

更深的隐藏，带来更稳的根基。

更少的外显，塑造更强的内里。

正如面团发酵的时候，它不是在表现，而是在变化。

你看不到它的努力，却会在最后看见它发起来。

三、发起来，是时候了

大斋节一结束，家里的节奏立刻改变了。

妻子开始重新准备早餐，而且一次做了一大批馒头。

那一刻很有意思。

四十天没有出现的東西，突然大量出现。

馒头一个个发起来，又大又饱满。

我忽然明白：这不只是早餐。

这是一个属灵的比喻。

蓄势已久，现在要发起来了。

四、蹲下，是为了跳得更高

很多人误解“停下来”的意义，以为那是退步。

其实不是。

人蹲下，是为了更好地跳起来。

人跪下，是为了更有力量地站立。

人安静，是为了更有能力地行动。

属灵生命从来不是一直向前冲，而是有节奏地收、蓄、发。

大斋节，是收和蓄。

复活节之后，就是发。

五、蓄势待发的时刻

现在，就是这样的时刻。

不是重新开始，而是带着四十天的积累重新出发。

你里面的祷告，你里面的眼泪，你里面的思考，都没有白费。

就像那一锅馒头，在看不见的时间里，已经完成了最关键的变化。

现在只差一件事：

火一开，蒸汽一上，生命就显出来。

更好的隐藏，是为了更好的显露。

更深的学习，是为了更有力的服事。

今天不是结束，而是启动。

不是恢复，而是释放。

愿我们都在这个时刻，蓄势待发，真正发起来。

# Poised to Rise

## Hiddenness Is Not Stagnation, but Deeper Preparation

The forty days of Lent are a quiet and profound journey.

Not outward excitement, but inward gathering. Not running outward, but returning inward.

During these forty days, a group from our church fasted, prayed, and meditated together.

Our bodies became lighter, but our souls grew heavier with substance.

I also experienced a very concrete change: my weight dropped from 177 pounds to 163 pounds.

This was not merely a change in numbers. It was an adjustment of rhythm, a reordering of life.

### 1. Reduction Makes Room

Every morning, I stopped eating breakfast. Our home stopped preparing breakfast, and even steamed buns were no longer made.

The kitchen grew quiet. The stomach grew quiet. Slowly, the person also became quiet.

You begin to realize that when eating is temporarily removed, so much time, attention, and desire can be reordered.

They can be turned toward prayer, reflection, and conversation with God.

Sometimes the problem in life is not lack, but excess.

Reduction is not loss. It is making room for what truly matters to enter.

### 2. Hiddenness Builds Depth

During these forty days, it seemed as if nothing happened.

No lively activity. No obvious result.

But like bamboo, what appears not to grow above ground may be desperately rooting below.

This is the rhythm of spiritual life:

deeper hiddenness brings a firmer foundation.

less outward display forms stronger inner life.

It is like dough during fermentation. It is not performing; it is changing.

You cannot see its effort, but in the end you will see it rise.

### 3. Now It Is Time to Rise

As soon as Lent ended, the rhythm at home changed immediately.

My wife began preparing breakfast again, and this time she made a large batch of steamed buns.

That moment was striking.

What had disappeared for forty days suddenly appeared in abundance.

One steamed bun after another had risen, full and round.

I suddenly understood: this was not only breakfast.

It was a spiritual metaphor.

What had been building for a long time was now ready to rise.

#### 4. Bending Down Is for Leaping Higher

Many people misunderstand the meaning of stopping. They assume it is regression.

But it is not.

A person bends down in order to jump higher.

A person kneels in order to stand stronger.

A person becomes quiet in order to act with greater power.

Spiritual life is not constant forward rushing. It has a rhythm of gathering, building, and releasing.

Lent is the season of gathering and building.

After Easter comes release.

#### 5. The Moment of Readiness

This is such a moment.

It is not simply starting over. It is setting out again with forty days of accumulation within.

Your prayers, your tears, your reflections have not been wasted.

Like a pot of dough, the most important change has already happened in the unseen time.

Only one thing remains:

turn on the heat, let the steam rise, and life will be revealed.

Better hiddenness leads to greater revelation.

Deeper learning leads to stronger service.

Today is not an ending. It is an ignition.

Not recovery, but release.

May we all, in this moment, be poised to rise, and truly rise.

# 30. 旷野开道路，沙漠开江河

## A Way in the Wilderness, Rivers in the Desert

### 只要不失去信心，旅途都是风景

人生的常态，不是一路顺利，而是在夹缝中前行。

我们常以为，理想的人生是一条笔直、宽阔、平坦的路。

但真实的生命，常常更像在旷野中行走：有压力，有限制，有突如其来的阻碍，也有看不清方向的时候。

有时你会发现，路走着走着变窄了；方向走着走着模糊了；甚至走到一个地步，好像无路可走。

正是在这样的时刻，我们才真正明白那句话的重量：

“看哪，我要做一件新事；如今要发现，你们岂不知道吗？我必在旷野开道路，在沙漠开江河。”（以赛亚书 43:19，和合本）

这不是对顺境的描述，而是对绝境中的应许。

一、我们看到的是尽头，神看见的是转弯

人之所以容易绝望，往往不是因为真的没有路，而是因为我们只看见眼前的尽头，却看不见隐藏的转机。

古人说，车到山前必有路，船到桥头自然直。

这些话并不一定是盲目乐观，而是人生经验中的一种提醒：很多“走不下去的地方”，其实只是“还没有走过去”。

站在当下，你以为这是终点。

但当你继续走过去，才发现那不过是一个转弯。

很多时候，人的眼睛只能看见墙，神却已经预备了门。

二、四面受敌，却不被困住

保罗这样描述生命中的张力：

“我们四面受敌，却不被困住；心里作难，却不至失望；遭逼迫，却不被丢弃；打倒了，却不至死亡。”（哥林多后书 4:8-9，和合本）

这不是环境立刻改变，而是解释方式被更新。

同样的处境，可以有两种理解：“我被困住了”，或者“我暂时被围住，但仍有出路”。



区别不一定在环境，而在内在的信心。

信心不是否认困难，而是在困难中仍然相信：这不是终局。

三、真正的力量，是在压力中仍能平静

一个成熟的生命，不是没有压力，而是在压力中仍能保持稳定。

在压力中仍能平静，在忙碌中仍能从容，在失败中仍能微笑，在逼迫中仍能站立。

这不是天生的乐观，而是一种被塑造出来的内在秩序。

这种力量，来自对那位掌权者的信任，也来自对生命意义更深的把握。

当一个人知道自己不是孤立的，困境不是随机的，生命也不是失控的，他就可以在混乱中保持一种超越环境的安定。

四、很多出路，是借着人临到的

“旷野开道路”，不总是神秘而突然的奇迹。

很多时候，出路是这样出现的：一个及时出现的人，一句关键的话，一个意想不到的机会。

回头看自己的人生，我们会发现许多关键节点，并不是自己独自走出来的，而是被人扶了一把，被一句话点醒，被一个机会带了出来。

于是我们才明白，“天无绝人之路”有时意味着：在你最需要的时候，神会借着人，把路带你面前。

而我们自己，也被呼召成为别人生命中的那一条路。

五、真正的转机，常常从内心开始

很多人以为，环境改变了，人生才会好转。

但更真实的情况是：内心改变了，环境才开始被重新理解。

在绝望中仍有盼望。

在冷漠中仍有关怀。

在困境中仍有出路。

在死亡中仍有生命。

这不是对外在条件的保证，而是内在生命的宣告。

真正的出路，往往先出现在心里，然后才逐渐显现在现实中。

六、只要不失去信心，旅途都是风景

人生确实处处有难处。

但同样，人生处处也有惊喜。



关键不在于你有没有遇到困难，而在于你在困难中是否仍然保有信心。

信心，让你不在黑暗中停下。

信心，让你继续向前。

信心，让你看见原本看不见的路。

所以，当你觉得无路可走的时候，不要急着下结论。

也许你正站在“旷野开道路”的起点。

也许你正站在“沙漠开江河”的前夜。

只要不失去信心，你走过的每一步，终将成为风景。

# A Way in the Wilderness, Rivers in the Desert

## As Long as Faith Remains, the Journey Becomes Scenery

The normal pattern of life is not smoothness, but moving forward through narrow places.

We often imagine that an ideal life is a straight, wide, and level road.

But real life often feels more like walking through the wilderness: pressure, limitation, sudden obstacles, and seasons when the direction is unclear.

Sometimes the road becomes narrower as you walk. Sometimes the direction grows blurry. Sometimes you reach a place where it feels as if there is no way forward.

It is precisely in such moments that we begin to understand the weight of this promise:

“See, I am doing a new thing! Now it springs up; do you not perceive it? I am making a way in the wilderness and streams in the wasteland.” (Isaiah 43:19, NIV)

This is not a description of comfort. It is a promise in desperation.

### 1. We See an Ending; God Sees a Turn

People often fall into despair not because there is truly no road, but because they can only see the end before them and cannot yet see the hidden turn.

Ancient wisdom says that when the cart reaches the mountain, there will be a road; when the boat reaches the bridge, it will straighten itself out.

These words are not necessarily blind optimism. They remind us that many places that seem impossible to pass are simply places we have not yet walked through.

Standing in the present, you may think this is the end.

But when you keep walking, you discover it was only a turn.

Often, human eyes see only a wall, while God has already prepared a door.

### 2. Hard Pressed, but Not Crushed

Paul describes the tension of life this way:

“We are hard pressed on every side, but not crushed; perplexed, but not in despair.” (2 Corinthians 4:8, NIV)

This does not mean the environment changes immediately. It means the way we interpret the environment is renewed.

The same situation can be understood in two ways: “I am trapped,” or “I am surrounded for now, but there is still a way out.”

The difference is not always in the circumstance, but in the faith within.

Faith does not deny difficulty. It believes, even within difficulty, that this is not the end.

### 3. True Strength Is Calmness Under Pressure

A mature life is not a life without pressure, but one that remains steady under pressure.

Calm under strain.

Unhurried in busyness.

Able to smile in failure.

Able to stand under opposition.

This is not natural optimism. It is an inner order that has been formed over time.

Such strength comes from trusting the One who reigns, and from grasping the deeper meaning of life.

When a person knows he is not alone, that hardship is not random, and that life is not out of control, he can remain steady in the middle of confusion.

### 4. Many Ways Out Come Through People

“A way in the wilderness” is not always a mysterious and sudden miracle.

Often, the way appears through a person who arrives at the right time, a key sentence, or an unexpected opportunity.

Looking back, we often discover that at important turning points we did not walk out alone. Someone helped us, awakened us with a word, or opened a door for us.

Then we understand that when there seems to be no way, God may bring the way to us through people.

And we ourselves are also called to become a way for someone else.

### 5. The Real Turning Point Often Begins Within

Many people think life will improve only after circumstances change.

But often, when the heart changes, circumstances begin to be understood differently.

Hope remains in despair.

Care remains in coldness.

A way remains in difficulty.

Life remains even in the shadow of death.

This is not a guarantee of outward ease. It is a declaration of inward life.

The real way out often appears first in the heart, and then gradually becomes visible in reality.

## 6. As Long as Faith Remains, the Journey Becomes Scenery

Life truly has difficulties everywhere.

But life also has surprises everywhere.

The key question is not whether you encounter hardship, but whether you still carry faith within hardship.

Faith keeps you from stopping in the dark.

Faith keeps you moving forward.

Faith helps you see the road you could not see before.

So when you feel there is no way forward, do not rush to a conclusion.

Perhaps you are standing at the beginning of “a way in the wilderness.”

Perhaps you are standing on the eve of “streams in the wasteland.”

As long as faith remains, every step you have walked will one day become scenery.

# 第三辑：关系里的修复

## 31. 家丑不可外扬？ Should Family Shame Stay Hidden?

### 沉默背后的病态逻辑

在许多文化中，“家丑不可外扬”几乎被看作一种美德。它听起来像是体面、克制、顾全大局，也像是在维护关系。

但问题是，任何长期不被反思的观念，都可能从“智慧”变成一种压迫。

这句话背后的潜台词常常是：问题可以存在，但不能说出来；痛苦可以承受，但不能表达；错误可以继续，但不能被揭露。

于是，一个原本看似维护秩序的观念，最后却可能变成保护问题本身的工具。

我们需要分清两件事：遮盖与掩盖。

遮盖，是出于爱，为了给人悔改、修复和改变的空间。掩盖，则往往出于恐惧、逃避和面子。

当“家丑不可外扬”成为默认规则时，它常常不再是为了爱，而是为了避免丢脸，避免被评价，避免原有结构受到挑战。结果是，问题被保护了，人却被牺牲了。

沉默的代价，是关系的慢性溃烂。

一个长期压抑真相的家庭或群体，不会因此更稳定，只会变得更扭曲。人在这样的环境里，会慢慢学会伪装、压抑和不信任。

表面上仍然和谐，里面却越来越疏离；真实的情绪被压进心底，最后变成愤怒、冷漠或绝望；当真话不能说出来，关系也就不再真实。

真正的问题，往往不是“外扬”，而是“无法处理”。

很多人害怕问题被别人知道，其实更深的恐惧是：我们没有能力面对它、处理它、修复它。于是最简单的选择就是不说、不碰、不面对。

但问题不会因为沉默而消失，只会因为沉默而变得更复杂。

成熟的家庭或群体，并不是没有问题，而是有能力面对问题、处理问题，并在真相中寻求修复。

当然，这并不是鼓励人毫无边界地公开一切，也不是鼓励情绪化地到处控诉。不是所有事情都需要公开，但所有真正的问题都需要被面对。

健康的方式，是在适当的范围内沟通，在可信任的关系中表达，在合适的结构里处理。

真正的成熟，不是什么都不说，而是知道在哪里说、向谁说、怎样说。

“家丑不可外扬”的危险在于，它常常把面子看得比真实更重要。但一个没有真实的关系，再体面，也只是表演。

真正健康的关系，是可以面对问题而不惧怕崩塌，可以承认错误而不失去尊严，可以表达痛苦而不被羞辱。

因为真正稳固的关系，不是建立在“没有问题”之上，而是建立在“我们可以一起面对问题”之上。

沉默不一定是美德。若一种观念让人越来越紧张，让关系越来越虚假，让问题越来越无法解决，它就不再是智慧，而是一种需要被更新的模式。

“家丑不可外扬”在某些情境中也许有它的提醒：说话要有边界，处理问题要有智慧。但当它成为普遍原则时，它往往会变成问题的保护伞、真相的封印、关系的毒素。

真正的出路，不是随意外扬，也不是继续隐藏，而是在真理与爱中，让问题被看见、被处理、被更新。

# Should Family Shame Stay Hidden?

## The Unhealthy Logic Behind Silence

In many cultures, the saying “family shame should not be exposed in public” is almost treated as a virtue. It sounds respectable. It sounds restrained. It sounds like a way to preserve harmony and protect relationships.

But any idea that goes unexamined for too long can quietly turn from wisdom into oppression.

Behind this saying, there are often unspoken assumptions: problems may exist, but they must not be named; pain may be endured, but it must not be expressed; wrongdoing may continue, but it must not be exposed.

What appears to preserve order may, in the end, protect the problem itself.

We need to distinguish between covering and concealing.

Covering comes from love. It creates space for repentance, healing, and change. Concealing often comes from fear, avoidance, and the desire to save face.

When “family shame should not be exposed” becomes the default rule, it is often no longer about love. It is about fear: fear of losing face, fear of being judged, fear that the existing structure may be challenged.

In the end, the problem is protected, while people are sacrificed.

The cost of silence is the slow decay of relationships.

A family or community that continually suppresses the truth does not become more stable. It becomes more distorted. In such an environment, people gradually learn to pretend, to suppress, and to distrust.

On the surface, there may still be harmony, but underneath there is distance. Real emotions are pushed down until they turn into anger, coldness, or despair. When truth cannot be spoken, relationships can no longer remain genuine.

The real issue is often not exposure, but the inability to deal with what has happened.

Many people are afraid that others may find out about the problem. But the deeper fear is this: we do not know how to face it, process it, or repair it. So the easiest choice is silence. Do not speak of it. Do not touch it. Do not face it.

But problems do not disappear because of silence. They only become more complicated.

A mature family or community is not one without problems. It is one that has the courage and capacity to face problems, deal with them, and seek restoration in truth.

Of course, this is not a call to expose everything without boundaries. Nor is it an invitation to emotional accusation. Not everything needs to be made public, but every real problem needs a proper place to be faced.

A healthy response includes honest conversation within appropriate boundaries, expression within trustworthy relationships, and resolution within a proper structure.



Maturity is not saying nothing. Maturity is knowing where to speak, whom to speak to, and how to speak.

The danger of “family shame should not be exposed” is that it often values appearance more than truth. But a relationship without truth, no matter how respectable it looks, is only a performance.

A truly healthy relationship can face problems without collapsing. It can admit wrongs without losing dignity. It can express pain without shame.

Strong relationships are not built on the absence of problems. They are built on the willingness to face problems together.

Silence is not always a virtue. If an idea makes people more anxious, relationships more false, and problems harder to resolve, then it is no longer wisdom. It is a pattern that needs to be renewed.

The saying may contain a reminder in certain situations: speak with boundaries and handle problems with wisdom. But when it becomes a universal rule, it often becomes a shield for problems, a seal over truth, and a poison within relationships.

The way forward is neither careless exposure nor continued hiding. The way forward is to let the problem be seen, addressed, and renewed in truth and love.



# 32. 我的情人节 My Valentine's Day

不只是玫瑰，更是盟约

今天是 2 月 14 日。

据传，在公元 268 年，罗马皇帝克劳狄二世认为未婚男子更适合从军，于是禁止年轻人结婚。当时有一位教会牧者瓦伦丁，因着圣经对婚姻的尊重与祝福，秘密为年轻男女主持婚礼。

他认为，婚姻不是皇权可以随意取缔的制度，而是神所设立的恩典。

他的行为最终触怒皇帝，被收监，并于次年 2 月 14 日殉道。后来教会以这一天纪念他。再后来，这个纪念日逐渐演变成 Saint Valentine's Day，中文译作“情人节”。

坦白说，我对这个翻译一直有点保留。

“情人”这个词，在华人语境里，总让人容易联想到短暂、激情，甚至游离于盟约之外的关系。而婚姻，却是盟约，是一生一世的相守，是在光明中立下的承诺。

婚姻不该被简化成一个节日的浪漫。

然而，我也承认，在一个软弱的世界里，我们的婚姻确实需要不断被提醒、被修复、被更新。

如果一个节日能提醒我重新思想“爱妻子，如同基督爱教会”，那这个节日就有价值。

今天一早，我学年轻人。

我给妻子发信息：“情人节快乐，我永远的小情人！”

她很冷静地回了一句：“嗯。”

于是我决定做点惊天动地的事情。我对她说：“我要给你发个两万人民币的红包。”

她立刻回复：“你哪有那么多钱？”

这句话扎心又真实。她知道我账户里有多少钱。我们夫妻之间没有财务秘密，只有财务现实。

我说：“我尽我力量发一个。”

最后我发了一个 1314 元。

1314，在中国文化里象征“一生一世”。

她收到后很开心，说：“这个数，跟我想的一样。”

你看，婚姻有时不是惊天动地，而是彼此懂得。

年轻时，我们追求数额；成熟后，我们珍惜意义。

很多人说，情人节是商家的胜利。

花、巧克力、餐厅订位、红酒、朋友圈晒图，似乎都在提醒人：爱需要被消费。

但我越来越发现，真正决定婚姻质量的，不是节日消费，而是日常投入。

婚姻最大的危机，往往不是大风暴，而是小裂缝；不是背叛，而是冷淡；不是争吵，而是沉默。

瓦伦丁为婚姻付出生命，是因为他相信婚姻是神圣的。

而我们今天要付出的，不是殉道，而是舍己。

舍掉一点脾气，舍掉一点自我中心，舍掉一点“我都为你做这么多了”的计算。

基督的爱不是账本式的爱。

祂的爱，是主动的、牺牲的、持续的。

当我发 1314 的时候，我心里也在问自己：我是否愿意真正活出“一生一世”？

红包可以一次到账，盟约却要每日兑现。

作为牧者，我见过太多婚姻的高山低谷。

热恋时山盟海誓，现实中柴米油盐。

婚姻不是激情的延续，而是恩典的操练。

如果你今天是单身，不必焦虑。爱不是节日制造的。

如果你今天已婚，不必攀比。婚姻不是朋友圈展示的。

如果你的婚姻正在经历困难，也不要绝望。裂痕不是终点，而是修复的起点。

情人节提醒我：爱不是感觉，爱是决定；爱不是冲动，爱是委身；爱不是短暂的浪漫，爱是长期的忠诚。

今天，我给妻子发了 1314。

但更重要的是，我在心里再次立志：愿我一生爱她，如同基督爱教会。

如果明年我还能发 1314，那是恩典。

如果明年我账户余额更少，我也要发一个 131.4。

因为数字会变，盟约不变。这，才是我的情人节。

# My Valentine's Day

## More Than Roses, It Is a Covenant

Today is February 14.

Tradition tells us that in A.D. 268, the Roman emperor Claudius II believed unmarried men made better soldiers, so he forbade young men from marrying. A Christian pastor named Valentine, convinced by Scripture that marriage was a sacred gift from God, secretly officiated weddings for young couples.

He believed marriage was not a social arrangement that imperial power could cancel at will. It was a grace established by God.

His actions angered the emperor. He was imprisoned and eventually executed on February 14 of the following year. The church later commemorated him on this day. Over time, that remembrance became Saint Valentine's Day.

In Chinese, it is commonly translated as "Lovers' Day."

To be honest, I have always had some reservations about that translation.

In Chinese culture, the word "lover" can easily suggest something temporary, emotional, or even outside the covenant of marriage. Marriage, however, is covenant. It is a lifelong commitment, a promise made in the light.

Marriage should not be reduced to one day of romance.

And yet, I also admit that in a weak and broken world, our marriages need reminders. They need to be renewed, repaired, and called back to love.

If a holiday can remind me to think again about the command, "Husbands, love your wives, as Christ loved the church," then that holiday has meaning.

This morning, I tried to be young again.

I sent my wife a message: "Happy Valentine's Day, my forever little lover!"

She replied calmly: "Mm."

So I decided to do something dramatic.

I told her, "I'm going to send you a red envelope of 20,000 RMB."

She immediately replied, "You don't have that much money."

Her words were sharp and true. She knows exactly how much is in my account. In our marriage, there are no financial secrets, only financial realities.

I said, "I'll send what I can."

In the end, I sent 1,314 RMB.

In Chinese culture, 1314 is a homophone for “a lifetime.”

When she received it, she was happy and said, “That is exactly the number I was thinking of.”

You see, marriage is often not about grand gestures. It is about being understood.

When we are young, we pursue amount. As we mature, we cherish meaning.

Many people say Valentine’s Day is a victory for merchants.

Flowers, chocolates, restaurant reservations, wine, and carefully arranged social media posts all seem to suggest that love must be consumed.

But I have increasingly discovered that the quality of a marriage is not determined by holiday spending. It is built through daily investment.

The greatest threats to marriage are often not dramatic storms, but small cracks. Not betrayal, but indifference. Not arguments, but silence.

Valentine gave his life because he believed marriage was sacred.

Today, most of us are not asked to die for marriage. We are asked to deny ourselves.

To give up a little temper. A little self-centeredness. A little mental accounting of “how much I have done for you.”

Christ’s love is not ledger-based love.

His love is active, sacrificial, and enduring.

When I sent 1,314, I also asked myself: Am I truly willing to live out “a lifetime”?

A red envelope can arrive instantly. A covenant must be honored daily.

As a pastor, I have seen many mountains and valleys in marriage.

Romance makes vows easily. Daily life tests them through rice, bills, work, and fatigue.

Marriage is not the continuation of passion. It is the discipline of grace.

If you are single today, do not be anxious. Love is not manufactured by a date on the calendar.

If you are married today, do not compare. Marriage is not a display for social media.

If your marriage is struggling, do not despair. A crack is not necessarily the end. It can become the beginning of repair.

Valentine’s Day reminds me: love is not merely a feeling; it is a decision. Love is not impulse; it is commitment. Love is not a brief romance; it is long-term faithfulness.

Today, I sent my wife 1,314.

But more importantly, I renewed this prayer in my heart: may I love her all my life, as Christ loves the church.

If next year I can send 1,314 again, that will be grace.

If next year my account balance is lower, I will still send 131.4.

Numbers may change.

Covenant does not.

That is my Valentine's Day.

# 33. 情商在线： 灵巧如蛇， 驯良如鸽。 Emotional Intelligence With a Soul

## 当社交技巧成为属灵成熟的一部分

在这个讲效率、讲流量、讲表达的时代，“情商在线”几乎成了社交里的通行证。

有人说，一个人若情商高，走到哪里都如沐春风；情商低，哪怕满腹经纶，也常常把关系弄得像车祸现场。

情商，通常指一个人在与人交往中，对情绪的觉察、理解与调节能力，以及处理关系的技巧与分寸。

它不只是会说话，更是会读懂气氛；不只是能表达，更是能体谅；不只是聪明，更是有温度。

但问题也随之而来：情商是不是圆滑？是不是讨好？是不是“见人说人话”？

如果情商只是技巧，而没有内在的根基，那不过是一层包装纸，风一吹就破。

### 一、知识与智慧：头脑与心灵的分野

在牧养与陪谈中，我常常遇见一种现象：有的人知识很多，情绪却很乱；道理明白，关系却破裂。

这说明，知识与智慧并不等同。

知识，是对事物的认知，是“知道”。

智慧，是对人、对事、对环境的相处之道，是“怎么做”。

知识像地图，告诉你哪里是山、哪里是海。

智慧像向导，告诉你什么时候上山，什么时候绕路。

知识可以在考试中得分，智慧却是在关系里得分。

圣经说：“敬畏耶和华是智慧的开端；认识至圣者便是聪明。”（箴言 9:10，和合本）

这句话的重点不在恐惧，而在敬畏。

敬畏，是对真理的尊重，对神的顺服，也是对自我有限的承认。

当一个人承认自己不是宇宙的中心，智慧就开始萌芽。

情商若没有敬畏作根基，很容易滑向自我中心，甚至成为操控他人的工具。

有了敬畏，情商才不会只是社交技巧，而会成为服事人的能力。

## 二、灵巧与驯良：外圆内方的属灵哲学

主耶稣曾说：“我差你们去，如同羊进入狼群；所以你们要灵巧像蛇，驯良像鸽子。”（马太福音 10:16，和合本）

这句话若只读前半句，会让人紧张；若只读后半句，又似乎太天真。

蛇与鸽子，像是两种完全不同的形象。

我常用中国古代铜钱来理解这节经文。

铜钱外圆内方。

外面的“圆”，代表处世圆融；中间的“方”，代表内心有原则。

外圆，像蛇的灵巧。

在人群中行走，要懂得分寸，懂得场合，懂得语气。

什么时候说，什么时候停；什么时候安慰，什么时候沉默。

这是情商。

内方，像鸽子的驯良。

内心有一条不能妥协的线，有真理的根基，有良心的坚持。

这是品格。

若只有方，没有圆，容易刚硬；若只有圆，没有方，容易失去方向。

真正情商在线的人，不是没有原则，而是懂得用合宜的方式表达原则；不是没有立场，而是能在爱中坚持立场。

## 三、教牧关怀中的情商：不是技巧，而是温度

在教会事奉中，我越来越发现，情商不是锦上添花，而是不可或缺。

有人来倾诉，不一定要先听神学论文。

有人跌倒，不一定要马上被纠正。

有人软弱，不一定要立刻被分析原因。

很多时候，人需要的不是答案，而是陪伴；不是教训，而是理解。

情商在线的牧者，会在对方情绪最高的时候，先降低自己的音量；在对方最脆弱的时候，收起锋利的逻辑；在对方最困惑的时候，不急着给结论。

情商并不取消真理，而是为真理铺路。

没有温度的真理像冰块，有温度的真理像阳光。



真理若没有爱，容易伤人。

爱若没有真理，容易失去方向。

真正成熟的生命，是把真理和爱放在一起活出来。

#### 四、如何让情商真正在线

第一，学会倾听。

听完对方的话，再听听自己的心。

很多冲突，不是因为意见不同，而是因为人没有被听见。

第二，延迟反应。

情绪上来时，先深呼吸。

把“立即回击”改成“稍后回应”。

这是成熟的标志。

第三，内心归正。

情商不是演戏，而是生命的流露。

若内心焦躁，再高的技巧也会露馅。

第四，以敬畏为本。

当人把神放在中心，就不会把自己放在宝座。

情商因此有了方向。

结语：在线的不只是情商，而是生命

情商在线，不是为了赢得掌声，而是为了守住关系；不是为了左右逢源，而是为了在复杂的世界里，仍然活出温柔与坚定。

愿我们都成为外圆内方的人：

在世界里圆润，在真理里坚实；在人群中温和，在内心里坚定。

当智慧以敬畏为开端，情商便不再只是社交技巧，而成为生命成熟的标志。



# Emotional Intelligence With a Soul

## Shrewd as Serpents, Innocent as Doves

In today's world of speed, influence, and constant expression, being emotionally intelligent has almost become a social passport.

People admire those who can navigate conversations gracefully, ease tension, and make others feel seen and valued. By contrast, a person with low emotional intelligence may possess much knowledge, yet still damage relationships without realizing it.

Emotional intelligence generally refers to the ability to recognize, understand, and manage emotions, both one's own and those of others. It also includes the wisdom to handle relationships with tact, empathy, and proper measure.

It is not merely eloquence. It is emotional discernment.

It is not merely expression. It is consideration.

It is not only intelligence. It is warmth.

But we must ask an important question: Is emotional intelligence simply being smooth? Is it people-pleasing? Is it saying whatever others want to hear?

If it is only technique without moral grounding, it becomes performance rather than authenticity.

### 1. Knowledge and Wisdom: Mind and Heart

In pastoral care and conversation, I often encounter a common reality: some people have much knowledge, but chaotic emotions; they understand many truths, yet their relationships remain broken.

This shows that knowledge and wisdom are not the same.

Knowledge concerns information. It answers, "What is this?"

Wisdom concerns life and relationship. It asks, "How should I live?"

Knowledge is like a map. It tells you where the mountains and seas are.

Wisdom is like a guide. It tells you when to climb and when to take another road.

Knowledge can score well on exams. Wisdom is tested in relationships.

Scripture says, "The fear of the LORD is the beginning of wisdom, and knowledge of the Holy One is understanding." (Proverbs 9:10, NIV)

The point is not terror, but reverence.

Reverence is respect for truth, submission before God, and the admission of our own limits.

When a person recognizes that he is not the center of the universe, wisdom begins to grow.

Emotional intelligence without reverence can easily become self-serving or even manipulative.

With reverence, emotional intelligence becomes not merely a social skill, but an ability to serve others.

## 2. Shrewd and Innocent: Round Outside, Square Inside

Jesus said, “I am sending you out like sheep among wolves. Therefore be as shrewd as snakes and as innocent as doves.” (Matthew 10:16, NIV)

If we read only the first half, we may feel tense. If we read only the second half, it may sound naive.

Snakes and doves seem like two very different images.

I often explain this verse through the image of ancient Chinese copper coins: round on the outside, square in the center.

The round exterior represents relational tact. The square center represents inner principle.

The roundness is like the shrewdness of the snake.

As we move among people, we need to understand timing, setting, tone, and measure: when to speak, when to stop, when to comfort, and when to remain silent.

This is emotional intelligence.

The square center is like the innocence of the dove.

Inside, there must be a line that cannot be crossed, a foundation in truth, and a conscience that remains awake.

This is character.

If we have only the square without the round, we become rigid.

If we have only the round without the square, we lose direction.

True emotional intelligence does not abandon principle. It expresses principle in a fitting way.

It does not lose conviction. It holds conviction in love.

## 3. Emotional Intelligence in Pastoral Care

In church ministry, I have increasingly realized that emotional intelligence is not optional. It is essential.

People who come to share their pain do not always need a theological lecture first.

People who have fallen do not always need immediate correction.

People who are weak do not always need instant analysis.

Often, people need presence before answers, and understanding before instruction.

A pastor with emotional intelligence lowers his own volume when another person's emotions are high.

He puts away sharp logic when someone is most vulnerable.

He does not rush to conclusions when someone is confused.

Emotional intelligence does not cancel truth. It prepares the way for truth.

Truth without warmth can feel like ice.

Truth with compassion can become sunlight.

Truth without love can wound.

Love without truth can lose direction.

A mature life holds truth and love together.

#### 4. How to Keep Emotional Intelligence “Online”

First, learn to listen.

After listening to another person’s words, listen also to your own heart.

Many conflicts do not happen because people disagree, but because people do not feel heard.

Second, delay your reaction.

When emotions rise, take a breath.

Replace immediate retaliation with a later response.

This is a mark of maturity.

Third, realign the inner life.

Emotional intelligence is not acting. It is the overflow of life.

If the heart is restless, even the best technique will eventually show cracks.

Fourth, root everything in reverence.

When God is at the center, the self does not need to sit on the throne.

Emotional intelligence then receives direction.

#### Conclusion: More Than Emotional Intelligence

To have emotional intelligence is not about winning applause. It is about stewarding relationships faithfully.

It is not about pleasing everyone. It is about living with gentleness and firmness in a complex world.

May we become people who are round outside and square inside:

gracious in the world, grounded in truth;

gentle among people, steady within.

When wisdom begins with reverence, emotional intelligence becomes more than a strategy. It becomes a sign of a mature life.

# 34. 一个“屁”引发的思考和讨论

## A Thought Sparked by a Fart

### 真实的关系，允许人不必一直绷着

人到中年，越来越发现，许多深刻的人生哲学，不一定诞生在讲台上、书房里，也可能诞生在吹风机嗡嗡作响的时候。

那天下午，我给妻子吹头发。

这个习惯，大概从结婚开始就有了。她长发，我负责吹干，二十几年如一日，倒也成了婚姻里一个小小的仪式。

正吹着，忽然，“噗”的一声。

一个响亮而自然的声音，从我身体深处冲破束缚而出。

妻子回头瞪我一眼，说：

“你到了显老的年纪了，连一个屁都管不住。恋爱的时候，你敢在我面前这样肆无忌惮吗？”

这句话把我问住了。

恋爱的时候，人连咳嗽都压着。

结婚以后，人连放屁都公开了。

这究竟是衰老，还是关系成熟？

我认真回答她：

“不是显老，是放松。家本来就是一个可以放心放松，甚至可以放心放屁的地方。”

她笑了。

我灵感突发，当场赋诗一首：

屁乃人生之气，哪有不放之理；  
放者扬眉吐气，闻者垂头叹息。

她笑得前仰后合，我也笑得连吹风机都快拿不稳。

但玩笑之外，我忽然真有一点思考。

一个屁，其实不是小事。

从医学说，这是正常的生理现象。

从哲学说，这是生命仍在运行的证明。

人活着，肠胃在运动，就会产气；有气而不排，反而才麻烦。

现代医学还有一个很有意思的概念，叫脑肠轴。意思是，大脑和肠胃彼此对话。

肠胃好不好，会影响情绪、睡眠和专注；压力大了，胃也会先抗议。

难怪有人说，想法堵住了会焦虑，肠道堵住了会胀气。两种堵，都不好。

我半开玩笑跟妻子说：

“也许我刚才那个屁，不只是气体释放，是脑肠轴的交响乐。”

她白了我一眼。

后来她还真的去查了一下，回来认真说：

“原来屁还有这么大学问。”

然后补了一句：

“怪不得你肠胃比我好，脑子也比我好。”

我赶紧谦虚：

“过奖过奖，脑子未必，只是偶尔排气比较有思想。”

细想，婚姻其实也有点像这样。

恋爱时，人人都包装自己，像精装修样板房。

婚后，才真正开始通风。

一个人若在你面前敢打哈欠、敢素颜、敢流泪，甚至敢露出一点小体面，大概说明他把你当家人。

爱不只是玫瑰和诗。

爱也是有人看见你的真实，闻见你的生活气息，却没有离开。

这不容易。

真正亲密，不是彼此完美，而是彼此真实。

教会牧养也是如此。

许多人来到教会，总想表现得自己没有問題。

其实属灵成长往往从“排气”开始：把里面积压的委屈、焦虑、罪疚和压力，在神面前诚实倒出来。

大卫许多诗篇，不就是灵魂的倾诉吗？

压抑太久，人会生病。

倾诉出来，灵魂反倒轻省。

有时候，一个屁提醒我：生命不是靠绷着，而是靠通畅。

身体如此，关系如此，灵魂也是如此。

人到中年，会发现许多高深道理，常藏在日常琐事里。

一碗饭，一声叹息，一个屁，都可能成为神学课堂。

活着，就是气息流通。

婚姻，就是允许真实。

智慧，就是从小事看大道。

信仰，就是让里面不堵。

我们一生争来争去，最后追求的，不就是胃口好一点，脑子清一点，关系松一点，心里通一点吗？

如此，便是福。

那天下午的一个屁，至少证明两件事：

第一，我的肠道还在工作。

第二，我的婚姻还很真实。

这已经很值得感恩了。



# A Thought Sparked by a Fart

## Real Relationships Let Us Stop Holding Everything In

As I enter middle age, I increasingly discover that profound life philosophy is not always born on a pulpit or in a study. Sometimes it is born while a hair dryer is humming.

That afternoon, I was drying my wife's hair.

This has been our habit since we got married. She has long hair, and I dry it for her. After more than twenty years, it has become a small ritual in our marriage.

As I was drying her hair, suddenly, there was a sound.

It came from deep within me, naturally and unmistakably.

My wife turned and glared at me:

“You are getting old. You cannot even control a fart anymore. When we were dating, would you ever have dared to do this in front of me?”

Her question stopped me.

When people are dating, they even suppress a cough.

After marriage, even a fart becomes public.

Is this aging, or is this relational maturity?

I answered seriously:

“It is not aging. It is relaxation. Home is the place where a person can relax, even enough to fart in peace.”

She laughed.

Then inspiration struck, and I composed a little poem on the spot:

A fart is the breath of human life; why should it not be released?

The one who releases feels relieved; the one who smells it hangs the head.

She laughed hard, and I laughed so much I almost dropped the hair dryer.

But beyond the joke, I began to think.

A fart is not such a small thing.

Medically speaking, it is a normal bodily function.

Philosophically speaking, it proves that life is still working.



If a person is alive and the digestive system is active, gas will form. If gas cannot be released, that is when trouble comes.

Modern medicine even speaks of the gut-brain axis, the connection between the brain and the digestive system.

The condition of the gut can affect mood, sleep, and focus. When stress rises, the stomach often protests first.

No wonder people say that blocked thoughts cause anxiety, and blocked intestines cause bloating. Neither kind of blockage is good.

I half-jokingly told my wife:

“Maybe what just happened was not merely gas release. It was a symphony of the gut-brain axis.”

She rolled her eyes.

Later, she actually looked it up and came back saying seriously:

“I did not know there was so much knowledge behind this.”

Then she added:

“No wonder your digestion is better than mine, and your brain is better too.”

I quickly replied humbly:

“That may be too much praise. My brain may not be better. I just occasionally release gas with more thought.”

When I think about it, marriage is a little like this.

When people are dating, everyone packages themselves like a model home.

After marriage, real ventilation begins.

If someone can yawn in front of you, appear without makeup, cry, and reveal something unpolished, perhaps it means that person sees you as family.

Love is not only roses and poetry.

Love is also when someone sees your real life and does not leave.

That is not easy.

True intimacy is not mutual perfection. It is mutual reality.

Pastoral care in the church is similar.

Many people come to church wanting to appear as if they have no problems.

But spiritual growth often begins when what has been held inside is released: grievances, anxiety, guilt, and pressure are brought honestly before God.

Are not many of David's psalms the honest breathing out of the soul?

When things are suppressed too long, people become sick.

When they are spoken before God, the soul becomes lighter.

Sometimes one ordinary fart reminds me that life is not sustained by constant tension, but by healthy flow.

This is true of the body, relationships, and the soul.

In middle age, I find that many deep truths hide in ordinary things.

A meal, a sigh, even a fart can become a classroom for theology.

To be alive is to let breath move.

To be married is to allow reality.

To be wise is to see large truths in small things.

To have faith is to let what is blocked within be opened before God.

After all our striving, what are we really seeking? A better appetite, a clearer mind, looser relationships, and a freer heart.

That, too, is blessing.

That afternoon's fart proved at least two things:

First, my digestive system is still working.

Second, my marriage is still real.

For that, I am grateful.

# 35. 人的软肋

## 在光明中被看见，在真实中被修复

人这一生，最难面对的，往往不是外在的风浪，而是内在的软肋。

所谓软肋，不一定是显而易见的缺陷，反而常常隐藏得很深。

它可能是一句容易被触动的话，一种难以释怀的情绪，一段不愿回忆的经历，或者一种无人知晓的恐惧。

外人看到的，可能是你的坚定。

唯有你自己知道，在哪些地方，轻轻一碰，仍会隐隐作痛。

真正的成熟，并不是假装自己没有软肋，而是愿意看见它，承认它，并在光中修复它。

### 一、软肋不是羞耻，而是提醒

人若完全没有软肋，未必是强大，也可能是麻木。

软肋的存在，本身并不是羞耻，而是一种提醒：提醒我们仍然有限，仍然需要成长。

有的人，一生都在遮掩自己的软肋。

用忙碌填补空虚，用强硬掩饰脆弱，用沉默掩盖不安。

久而久之，软肋并没有消失，反而在看不见的地方慢慢生根，成为操纵情绪与判断的暗流。

真正的生命，是敢于面对自己：不粉饰，不逃避，不自欺。

当一个人能够平静地说：“是的，我这里还不够成熟”，那一刻，他已经开始走向成熟。

### 二、不为名，不为利，让软肋失去控制力

许多软肋，其实与名和利紧密相连。

人之所以敏感，是因为在意评价。

人之所以动摇，是因为在意得失。

若一个人的价值建立在他人的认可之上，别人的一句话就可以成为他的软肋。

若一个人的安全感建立在外在拥有之上，环境的一点变化就足以震动他的内心。

真正的自由，不是环境完全稳定，而是内在有清楚的定向。

当一个人逐渐学会不以掌声定义荣耀，不以失去定义失败，不以地位定义自己，不以拥有证明价值，他的软肋就开始失去控制力。

因为再没有什么外在东西，可以轻易牵着他走。

### 三、光明正大：让生命在光中站立

人若活在遮蔽里，软肋就会被放大。

人若活在光中，软肋反而会被医治。

所谓光明正大，不是完美无缺，而是坦率、诚实、不隐藏。

一个内心清明的人，不需要用外在包装来维持自己。

他不夸大，也不遮掩。

他知道自己是谁，也知道自已尚未成为谁。

这种生命状态，带着一种安静的力量：不张扬，却坚定；不锋芒毕露，却有重量。

### 四、柔软中的刚强

真正的刚强，并不意味着没有软肋。

真正的刚强，是即使有软肋，也不被软肋定义。

一个人可以温柔，却不放弃原则。

可以谦卑，却不失去底线。

可以安静，却不失去立场。

这种刚强，不是情绪上的强硬，而是原则上的坚定。

它不是来自血气，而是来自根深蒂固的信念。

正因为知道自己所依靠的不是外在，所以面对压力时，仍然能够站立。

### 五、把软肋变成成长的入口

软肋若只是被发现，却没有被处理，最终仍会成为生命的破口。

但如果一个人愿意在软肋被触动的时候，不逃避，不合理化，而是主动修复，那么软肋就不再只是弱点，也会成为成长的入口。

每一次被触动，都是一次提醒：

这里，还需要更新。

这里，还可以更成熟。

真正智慧的人，不是避免所有触碰，而是善用每一次触碰。

### 六、谦卑地在不完全中前行

一个人越成长，越急于证明自己。

他知道，真正的价值不需要喧哗，真正的力量不需要表演。

因此，他不急于回应所有误解，也不急于争取所有支持。

他更在意的是：自己是否真实，是否正直，是否正在被神修剪和更新。

这种谦卑并不软弱，反而是一种更深的稳定。

人的软肋，不是终点，而是一扇门。

门的这一边，是脆弱与不安。

门的那一边，是成熟与自由。

关键不在于有没有软肋，而在于我们是否愿意走过这道门。

当一个人不再被名利驱动，不再被评价左右，能够在光中坦然、在真理中站立，即使软肋仍然存在，也不再主导他。

因为曾经的破口，可以成为被修复的地方。

而力量，常常就是从那里悄悄进入生命。

# The Tender Places of the Human Heart

## Seen in the Light, Restored in Truth

The hardest thing to face in life is often not the storm outside us, but the tender place within us.

Such a tender place is not always an obvious weakness. Often, it is deeply hidden.

It may be a word that easily triggers us, an emotion we cannot release, a memory we do not want to revisit, or a fear no one else knows.

Others may see our strength.

Only we know where a light touch still hurts.

Maturity is not pretending we have no tender places. It is the willingness to see them, acknowledge them, and allow them to be restored in the light.

### 1. Weakness Is Not Shame, but a Signal

If a person has no vulnerable place at all, it may not mean strength. It may mean numbness.

The existence of weakness is not shameful. It is a signal, reminding us that we are still limited and still need growth.

Some people spend their whole lives hiding their tender places.

They use busyness to cover emptiness, toughness to conceal vulnerability, and silence to hide anxiety.

Over time, the tender place does not disappear. It quietly takes root beneath the surface and begins to shape emotions and judgment.

True life begins when a person dares to face himself without decoration, avoidance, or self-deception.

When someone can calmly say, “Yes, this part of me is not yet mature,” that person has already begun to grow.

### 2. Beyond Reputation and Gain

Many vulnerable places are closely tied to reputation and gain.

We are sensitive because we care about evaluation.

We are shaken because we care about loss.

If a person’s worth is built on the approval of others, then one sentence from another person can become a wound.

If a person’s security is built on external possessions, then even a small change in circumstances can shake the heart.

True freedom does not come from a perfectly stable environment. It comes from a clear inner direction.

When a person learns not to define glory by applause, failure by loss, identity by position, or worth by possession, his tender places begin to lose their power to control him.

There is no longer anything outside him that can easily lead him around.

### 3. Standing in the Light

When a person lives in hiding, weakness grows larger.

When a person lives in the light, weakness can be healed.

Living openly does not mean being flawless. It means being honest, clear, and unhidden.

A person with a clear heart does not need external packaging to maintain identity.

He does not exaggerate, and he does not conceal.

He knows who he is, and he also knows who he has not yet become.

Such a life carries quiet strength: not loud, but firm; not aggressive, but weighty.

### 4. Strength Within Gentleness

True strength does not mean having no vulnerable places.

True strength means not being defined by them.

A person can be gentle without abandoning principle.

He can be humble without losing boundaries.

He can be quiet without losing his position.

This strength is not emotional hardness, but principled firmness.

It does not come from impulse, but from deeply rooted conviction.

Because he knows his foundation is not external, he can stand under pressure.

### 5. Turning Weakness Into an Entrance for Growth

If a tender place is discovered but never addressed, it remains a fracture in the soul.

But if a person chooses, when triggered, not to escape or justify, but to repair, then the tender place becomes more than weakness. It becomes an entrance for growth.

Every trigger becomes a reminder:

This place still needs renewal.

This place can become more mature.

The wise person does not avoid every touch. He learns from every touch.



## 6. Walking Humbly in Incompleteness

The more a person grows, the less urgent he becomes to prove himself.

He knows that true worth does not need noise, and true strength does not need performance.

So he does not rush to answer every misunderstanding or win every approval.

He cares more about whether he is true, whether he is upright, and whether he is still being pruned and renewed by God.

This humility is not weakness. It is a deeper stability.

The tender place of the human heart is not the end. It is a door.

On one side of the door are vulnerability and anxiety.

On the other side are maturity and freedom.

The question is not whether we have tender places, but whether we are willing to walk through the door.

When a person is no longer driven by reputation or gain, no longer controlled by evaluation, and can stand honestly in the light and in truth, even if tender places remain, they no longer rule him.

What was once a wound can become a place of restoration.

And often, strength enters quietly through that very place.



# 36. 说话要算数. Let Your Word Carry Weight

## 宁可吃亏，也不失信的人生

在一个随口而说的时代，守信显得格外沉重。

我们现在说话越来越容易，承诺却越来越轻。

一句“改天吧”，常常是一种温柔的拒绝。

一句“我一定来”，可能只是礼貌性的表达。

语言变得轻巧，承诺却逐渐失去重量。

正是在这样的时代，“说话要算数”反而显得更加珍贵。

因为当大多数人习惯于模糊表达时，依然坚持信实的人，就成为少数而稳固的存在。

一、信实的本质，不是能力，而是品格

很多人把守信当作一种能力。

但实际上，守信更是一种品格选择。

因为在没有代价的时候守信，并不困难。

真正的考验，是当守信需要付出代价时，仍然选择守信。

诗篇说：

“他发了誓，虽然自己吃亏，也不更改。”（诗篇 15:4，和合本）

这句话揭示了信实的核心：

守信不是在顺利时坚持，而是在吃亏时不改变。

一个人真正的品格，不是在无代价的时候显明，而是在有代价的时候被证明。

二、从君子一言到现代松动

古人说：“君子一言，驷马难追。”

也有人说：“一口唾沫一口钉。”

这些话强调的，不只是语言的力量，更是人格的重量。

在传统社会中，一个人的话，就是他的信用；一个人的承诺，就是他的名誉。

但在今天，承诺可以轻易撤回，关系可以随时中断，责任可以不断转移。

于是人与人之间的信任，变得越来越脆弱。

而信任一旦被损耗，整个社会的运行成本就会上升。

因为每一件事，都需要被反复验证。

三、宁可吃亏，不是愚昧，而是选择

有人会说：

“如果守信让自己吃亏，那不是太傻了吗？”

但这里需要澄清一个关键点：

守信不是没有代价，而是愿意承担代价。

这不是愚昧，而是一种更深的理性。

你可能在一件事上吃亏，却在长期中建立了信任。

你可能失去一次利益，却赢得持续的声誉。

信用，是一种长期资产。

不守信，表面上占了便宜，实际上却在不断消耗自己的人格资本。

四、少承诺，重兑现

守信如此重要，并不意味着我们什么都要答应。

真正成熟的表达，不是多承诺，而是少承诺、重兑现。

主耶稣说：

“你们的话，是，就说是；不是，就说不是。”（马太福音 5:37，和合本）

这句话的重点，是清楚而真实。

不讨好。

不圆滑。

不为了让场面好看而说出自己做不到的话。

很多失信，并不是因为恶意，而是因为不好意思拒绝，想维系关系，想显得热情。

于是爽快答应，却无法兑现。

与其事后失信，不如一开始就诚实。

## 五、守信的人，是关系中的稳定之锚

在一个充满不确定的世界里，人最渴望的不是完美，而是可靠。

一个守信的人，他说的话可以被相信，他答应的事可以被依赖，他出现的地方让人安心。

这样的人，就像关系中的支柱。

不一定最亮眼，却是最坚固。

而一个不守信的人，即使能力再强，也难以建立真正深厚的关系。

因为人终究会记得：你说过的话，到底有没有重量。

## 六、让你的话有重量

“说话要算数”，不是一句简单的道德要求，而是一种生命姿态。

它的意思是：

我尊重自己的言语。

我承担自己的承诺。

我用一致性建立信任。

在这个轻易承诺、也轻易失信的时代，愿我们成为这样的人：

话不多，但真实。

承诺不轻，但兑现。

因为最终，人记得的，不是你说了多少话，而是你说的话有多少是真的。

# Let Your Word Carry Weight

## A Life That Keeps Faith, Even at a Cost

In an age of casual words, faithfulness feels especially weighty.

Today, speaking has become easier, but promises have become lighter.

“Another day” often means a gentle no.

“I will definitely come” may be only a polite expression.

Words have become light, and promises have gradually lost weight.

That is exactly why keeping one’s word has become so precious.

When many people become accustomed to vague speech, a person who remains faithful becomes a rare and steady presence.

### 1. Integrity Is Not a Skill, but a Choice of Character

Many people treat promise-keeping as a skill.

But in reality, faithfulness is a choice of character.

It is not difficult to keep a promise when there is no cost.

The real test comes when keeping a promise requires sacrifice.

The psalmist describes one “who keeps an oath even when it hurts, and does not change their mind.” (Psalm 15:4, NIV)

This reveals the heart of faithfulness:

keeping one’s word is not only consistency in convenience, but consistency at a cost.

A person’s true character is not revealed when nothing is at stake. It is proved when something must be paid.

### 2. From Weighty Words to Modern Flexibility

Ancient wisdom said that once a gentleman gives his word, even four horses cannot pull it back.

Another saying compared a spoken word to a nail driven in.

These sayings emphasized not only the power of language, but the weight of character.

In traditional society, a person’s word was his credit. His promise was his reputation.

But today, promises can be withdrawn easily, relationships can be interrupted at any time, and responsibility can be shifted repeatedly.

Trust between people has become increasingly fragile.

When trust is weakened, the cost of society rises.

Everything must be verified again and again.

### 3. Choosing Loss Is Not Foolishness

Some may say:

“If keeping a promise causes me loss, isn’t that foolish?”

But one key point must be clarified:

faithfulness is not cost-free. It is the willingness to bear the cost.

This is not foolishness. It is a deeper kind of wisdom.

You may lose in one situation, but over time you build trust.

You may lose one benefit, but gain lasting credibility.

Credit is a long-term asset.

Unfaithfulness may appear to gain advantage on the surface, but it continually consumes the capital of character.

### 4. Promise Less, Fulfill More

The importance of keeping promises does not mean we should say yes to everything.

Mature speech does not make many promises. It makes fewer promises and fulfills them seriously.

Jesus said:

“All you need to say is simply ‘Yes’ or ‘No.’” (Matthew 5:37, NIV)

The point is clarity and truthfulness.

Do not flatter.

Do not smooth things over falsely.

Do not say what you cannot do merely to make the moment look pleasant.

Many broken promises do not begin with malice. They begin with the embarrassment of saying no, the desire to maintain relationships, or the wish to appear enthusiastic.

So we agree quickly, and later cannot deliver.

It is better to be honest at the beginning than to break trust afterward.

### 5. A Trustworthy Person Becomes an Anchor

In an uncertain world, people do not most deeply long for perfection. They long for reliability.

A trustworthy person can be believed when he speaks. What he promises can be depended on. His presence brings peace.

Such a person becomes a pillar in relationships.

He may not be the most impressive, but he is solid.

Someone who does not keep promises, even if highly capable, will struggle to build truly deep relationships.

In the end, people remember whether your words carried weight.

## 6. Let Your Words Have Weight

Keeping your word is not merely a moral rule. It is a posture of life.

It means:

I respect my own words.

I take responsibility for my promises.

I build trust through consistency.

In an age of easy promises and easy betrayals, may we become people like this:

Few words, but true.

Careful promises, faithfully fulfilled.

Because in the end, people will not remember how many words you spoke.

They will remember how many of them were true.